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72nd BPSC Prelims Batch

Modern History English Notes

The Advent of European Powers in India

Historical Context

Following the death of Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb in 1707, the decline of the Mughal Empire created a power vacuum in the Indian subcontinent. Regional states declared independence, but no single power could hold the country together. This fragmentation set the stage for a quadrilateral struggle among European trading companies—often allied with local princely states—to establish a trade monopoly. The British East India Company ultimately emerged victorious, transitioning from a trading enterprise to a colonial power.

India's trade relations with Europe trace back to ancient times, notably the Sangam Age, evidenced by Roman gold and artifacts discovered in India. During the medieval period, goods flowed via multiple routes:

- **Land Routes:** The Silk Route (via the Amu Darya River, Caspian Sea, and Black Sea).
- **Sea Routes:** Across the Arabian Sea and the Mediterranean.
- **The Middlemen:** Italian merchants dominated this trade, leveraging their control over the Mediterranean to maintain a lucrative monopoly.

The Catalyst for Exploration

The search for direct sea routes to India was driven by major geopolitical and cultural shifts in the 15th century:

- **The Fall of Constantinople (1453):** The Ottoman Empire captured Constantinople, placing traditional East–West trade routes under Turkish control. Western European nations desperately sought new maritime routes to avoid Ottoman hostility and bypass Arab and Venetian monopolies.
- **The Renaissance & Innovations:** The 15th and 16th centuries brought state-sponsored geographical exploration, enabled by advances in shipbuilding, maritime navigation, and the invention of the mariner's compass.
- **Precedents of British Enterprise:** English maritime confidence grew following Sir Francis Drake's circumnavigation of the globe in 1580 and the decisive English victory over the Spanish Armada in 1588.
- **Papal Bull (1454):** Pope Nicholas V granted Prince Henry of Portugal the right to explore the East, including India. A subsequent bull by Pope Alexander VI further solidified Portugal's eastern trade monopoly.
- **Treaty of Tordesillas (1494):** Portugal and Spain divided the non-Christian world along an imaginary Atlantic line. Portugal gained exclusive rights to territories east of this line, officially encompassing India.

Notable Early Discoveries

Explorer	Discovery / Event	Year
Bartholomew Diaz	Discovered the Cape of Good Hope	1488
Christopher Columbus	Accidentally found the Americas while searching for India	1492
Vasco da Gama	First European to reach India by sea	1498
Captain James Cook	Discovered Australia	—

Explorer	Discovery / Event	Year
Abel Tasman	Discovered New Zealand and Tasmania	—

Order of Arrival in India: Portuguese → Dutch → English → Danes → French

The Portuguese

The Portuguese were the **first Europeans to arrive in India and the last to leave**. Goa was liberated in 1961 under Governor-General Manuel António Vassalo e Silva.

Early Explorations & Establishments

- **Vasco da Gama:** Guided by Gujarati merchant Abdul Majid, he sailed around the Cape of Good Hope and reached Calicut (Kerala) in **May 1498**. Welcomed by the Hindu ruler, the Zamorin. Despite Arab opposition, he secured trading rights. Spices brought back yielded a **60x profit** in Europe. He visited India three times (1498, 1502, 1524) and died in Cochin in 1524.
- **Pedro Álvares Cabral (1500):** Commanded the second expedition. After his Calicut factory was attacked, he retaliated by seizing Arab ships and bombarding Calicut. He later negotiated favourable treaties with Cochin and Cannanore.
- **Fort Emmanuel (1503):** The first European fort in India, built by the Portuguese in Cochin — 137 years before any British fort. The second factory was established in Cannanore in 1505.

Prominent Viceroys

Viceroy	Tenure	Key Actions
Francisco de Almeida	1505–1509	First Viceroy. Launched the 'Blue Water Policy' for maritime supremacy. After a naval defeat at the Battle of Chaul in 1508 (where his son died), he retaliated by crushing the combined fleets of Gujarat, Egypt, and Turkey at the Battle of Diu in 1509 ."
Afonso de Albuquerque	1509–1515	Real founder of Portuguese power in the East. Captured Goa (1510), Malacca (1511), and Hormuz (1515). Banned Sati in Goa; encouraged intermarriage with Indians. Secured permission from Vijayanagara ruler Krishna Deva Raya to build a fort at Bhatkal.
Nino da Cunha	1529–1538	Shifted capital from Cochin to Goa (1530). Expanded into Hooghly (Bengal); acquired Bassein (1534) and Diu (1535).

Administration, Influence & Decline

- **Cartaz-Armada System:** A naval licensing framework to monopolize Indian Ocean trade. Even Mughal Emperor Akbar had to purchase a Cartaz to safeguard his ships.
- **Columbian Exchange & Agriculture:** The Portuguese introduced the printing press, Gothic architecture, and shipbuilding techniques. They also introduced tobacco, potatoes, tomatoes, red chilies, papaya, pineapple, guava, and cashew to India.

- **Mughal Relations:** Initially cordial — Jesuit missionaries were sent to Akbar's court in 1580. Relations soured due to Portuguese piracy. In 1632, Shah Jahan drove them out of Hooghly.
- **Decline:** Religious intolerance, Maratha/Mughal opposition, and the British rise crippled their power. In 1661, Bombay was gifted to the British as a dowry when Princess Catherine of Braganza married King Charles II. Portugal eventually shifted focus to Brazil.

The Dutch

- **Arrival:** In 1596, Cornelis de Houtman became the first Dutch citizen to reach Sumatra via the Cape of Good Hope.
- **VOC (1602):** The Dutch East India Company — Vereenigde Oostindische Compagnie — was established by a charter from the Dutch parliament.
- **Trade:** Initially focused on the Indonesian archipelago (Spice Islands), the Dutch later included cotton textiles in their Indian trade. They are credited with making Indian textiles a primary export commodity. Primary exports: indigo, saltpetre, and cotton textiles. Commercial model: Cartel system.

Dutch Factories in India

Location	Year	Note
Masulipatnam (Eastern Coast)	1605	First Dutch factory in India
Nagapatnam	—	Later Dutch headquarters in India
Surat	1616	
Pipli	1627	
Chinsurah, Bengal	1653	
Batavia (Jakarta), Indonesia	1619	Dutch HQ in Asia (founded by Dutch)
Malacca	1641	Wrested from the Portuguese
Sri Lanka	1658	Wrested from the Portuguese

Anglo-Dutch Rivalry & Decline

- **Amboyna Massacre (1623):** Dutch authorities in Indonesia beheaded ten English merchants, severely escalating Anglo-Dutch tensions.
- **Battle of Colachel (1741):** Martanda Varma of Travancore defeated the Dutch, ending their political influence in Kerala. The captured Dutch commander, Eustachius De Lannoy, was retained and successfully modernized Travancore's armed forces.
- **Battle of Bedara / Hooghly / Chinsurah (Nov 25, 1759):** Final collapse of Dutch power in India — decisively crushed by the British during the Seven Years' War.
- **Systemic Weakness:** The VOC was strictly state-controlled, lacking operational autonomy. Its naval power was fundamentally inferior to the British Royal Navy.

The British East India Company (EIC)

- **Foundation (1599):** A group of merchants known as the 'Merchant Adventurers' formed the 'Governor and Company of Merchants of London Trading into the East Indies'.

- **Royal Charter (December 31, 1600):** Queen Elizabeth I granted the company a 15-year monopoly on trade with the East. Made indefinite by King James I in 1609.

Chronology of British Expansion

Year	Event
Aug 1608	Captain William Hawkins (commander of the ship <i>Hector</i>) arrived in Surat in August 1608 and visited the Mughal court of Emperor Jahangir in Agra in 1609. Although initially granted permission to establish a factory in Surat, the <i>farman</i> (imperial decree) was revoked under pressure from the Portuguese. (<i>Note: Hawkins was highly proficient in Persian</i>).
1611	• Captain Middleton obtains the permission of the Mughal governor of Surat to trade there. • First British factory in South India established at Masulipatnam.
1612	Captain Thomas Best defeats the Portuguese fleet at Swally (near Surat), shattering their naval monopoly.
1613	Jahangir grants the British permission to establish their first permanent factory at Surat.
1615	Sir Thomas Roe, ambassador of King James I, arrives at Jahangir's court; secures broad trading privileges across the Mughal Empire.
1632	Sultan of Golconda issues the 'Golden Farman' — British may trade freely in his kingdom.
1633	First British factory in East India established at Balasore, Odisha.
1639	Francis Day leases Madras from the King of Chandragiri; builds Fort St. George — replaces Masulipatnam as English HQ in South India.
1651	British receive permission to trade in Hooghly, Bengal.
1668	British Crown leases Bombay to EIC for an annual rent of £10.
1686	British sack Hooghly; conflict with Mughals. Aurangzeb pardons them after Rs. 1.5 lakh compensation.
1687	Bombay replaces Surat as headquarters of the Western Presidency.
1698	EIC acquires zamindari of three villages — Sutanuti, Kalikata, and Govindpur. Job Charnock merges them to found Calcutta. Fort William constructed; Charles Eyre appointed first President.
1700	Calcutta declared first Presidency city; capital of British India until 1911.
1717	Emperor Farrukhsiyar (cured by Company surgeon William Hamilton) issues the 'Magna Carta' farman — duty-free trade in Bengal for Rs. 3,000/year; EIC coins legalized across the Mughal Empire. (Delegation led by John Surman.)

Staple exports from Bengal (mid-18th century): Cotton, silk, saltpetre, and opium.

The Danes

- **Arrival:** The Danish East India Company arrived in 1616.

- **Settlements:** Tranquebar, Tamil Nadu (1620) and Serampore, Bengal (1676).
- **Focus:** Missionary activities rather than commercial or political ambitions.
- **Exit:** Failing to build a sustainable commercial empire, they sold all Indian settlements to the British in 1845 and departed.

The French

- **French East India Company (1664):** Founded by Jean-Baptiste Colbert during the reign of King Louis XIV. Unlike the British EIC, it was a state-owned enterprise heavily dependent on government funding.
- **First Factory (1668):** François Caron established the first French factory at Surat. A second was set up at Masulipatnam in 1669.
- **Pondicherry (1673):** François Martin acquired a village from the Subedar of Valikondapuram, Sher Khan Lodi of Bijapur. This settlement became Pondicherry, where the French built Fort Louis.
- **Chandernagore (1673):** With permission of Nawab of Bengal Shaista Khan, the French established a factory at Chandernagore (Fort Orleans).
- **Pondicherry lost & returned:** The Dutch captured Pondicherry in 1693; it was later returned under the Treaty of Ryswick.
- **Reorganisation (1720–1742):** The French Company was reorganised under Governors Lenoir and Dumas for further expansion.
- **Territorial Expansion:** Mauritius (1721), Mahe on the Malabar Coast (1725), and Karaikal (1739).
- **Imperial Ambitions — Dupleix:** Post-1742, Governor Joseph François Dupleix initiated a policy of interfering in the internal disputes of Indian princely states. The tactics formulated by Dupleix later served as a blueprint for the British conquest of India.
- **Carnatic Wars:** This political maneuvering led to three Carnatic Wars (fought on the Coromandel coast and its hinterland). The British emerged victorious in all three.

Key Historical Personalities

Personality	Power	Notable Contribution / Fact
Vasco da Gama	Portuguese	First navigator to reach India via the Cape of Good Hope (May 1498). Visited India 3 times; died in Cochin (1524).
Pedro Álvares Cabral	Portuguese	Led the second Portuguese expedition to India (1500).
Francisco de Almeida	Portuguese	First Viceroy (1505–1509); architect of the 'Blue Water Policy'.
Afonso de Albuquerque	Portuguese	Captured Goa (1510); real founder of Portuguese power in the East.
Cornelis de Houtman	Dutch	First Dutch citizen to reach Sumatra via Cape of Good Hope (1596).
Eustachius De Lannoy	Dutch	Defeated Dutch commander who modernized the armed forces of the Kingdom of Travancore.
Captain William Hawkins	British	First British envoy to Emperor Jahangir's court (1608–1609).
Captain Thomas Best	British	Defeated the Portuguese fleet at Swally (1612).

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Personality	Power	Notable Contribution / Fact
Sir Thomas Roe	British	Ambassador of King James I; secured broad trading privileges (1615).
Francis Day	British	Founded Madras and built Fort St. George (1639).
Gerald Aungier	British	Founder and architect of modern Bombay.
Job Charnock	British	Founded Calcutta by merging three villages.
Sir Charles Eyre	British	First President of Fort William (Calcutta).
John Surman	British	Led the 1717 delegation that secured the 'Magna Carta' farman from Farrukhsiyar.
Dr. William Hamilton	British	Company surgeon who cured Emperor Farrukhsiyar, enabling the 1717 farman.
François Caron	French	Established the first French factory in India at Surat (1668).
François Martin	French	First French Governor; founder of Pondicherry.
Jean-Baptiste Colbert	French	Founded the French East India Company (1664) under King Louis XIV.
Joseph François Dupleix	French	Governor who pioneered interference in Indian princely politics; his tactics became the blueprint for British conquest.

Quick Reference — European Companies & Key Dates

Power	Company Name	Founded	First Factory in India	Year
Portuguese	Estado da India	1505	Cochin (Fort Emmanuel)	1503
Dutch	VOC (Vereenigde Oostindische Compagnie)	1602	Masulipatnam	1605
British	East India Company (EIC)	1600	Surat (permanent)	1613
Danes	Danish East India Company	1616	Tranquebar	1620
French	Compagnie des Indes Orientales	1664	Surat	1668

The British Conquest of India

India's immense wealth and thriving trade networks drew successive European powers — the Portuguese, Dutch, British, Danes, and French — all seeking profit through trade. Initially, they operated as licensed merchants, obtaining trade concessions from Indian rulers in exchange for payments.

Over time, these powers expanded beyond commerce, exploiting the rivalry and disunity among Indian kingdoms to gain political influence. The 18th century marked a turning point, as the decline of the Mughal Empire left India fragmented and vulnerable to external control.

A prolonged struggle followed among the Portuguese, Dutch, British, and French for dominance in trade and territory. Ultimately, the British emerged victorious, outmanoeuvring their rivals through superior strategy and persistence. After eliminating European competition, the British focused on Indian states, subduing them in stages — Bengal, Mysore, the Marathas, and the Sikh Empire — using warfare, diplomacy, and alliances. By the time of the Revolt of 1857, they had established control over most of the Indian subcontinent.

Anglo-French Struggle — The Carnatic Wars (1746–1763)

While the Portuguese and Dutch companies had already been eliminated from commercial and political competition, the Danish company departed from India by selling all its assets to the British East India Company in 1845. Only the British and French remained as dominant trading powers. Commercial rivalry and political ambition between the two companies made conflict inevitable. Three wars — the Carnatic Wars — decided the outcome. Britain ultimately prevailed.

First Carnatic War (1746–1748)

- **Also known as:** The Battle of St. Thome.
- **Background:** A direct extension of the War of the Austrian Succession being fought between France and Britain in Europe.
- **Immediate Cause:** A British officer, Captain Barnett, seized several French ships, triggering direct hostilities.
- **Siege of Madras (1746):** Dupleix, Governor of Pondicherry, captured Madras with the assistance of the French Governor of Mauritius, La Bourdonnais.
- **Battle of St. Thome:** Fought on the banks of the Adyar River between French forces under Captain Paradise and the Nawab's army sent by Anwar-ud-din (led by Mahfuz Khan); despite being outnumbered, the French decisively defeated the 10,000-strong army using superior artillery and tactics, marking the growing superiority of European military organisation and artillery.
- **British Counterattack:** Led by Admiral Boscawen and Robert Clive, the British regained Madras under Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle in 1748.
- **Significance:** No immediate territorial change, but the war exposed the vulnerability of Indian kingdoms — a small, well-organised European force could defeat a numerically far superior Indian army. French influence over South Indian states grew considerably.
- **Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748):** Ended the war in line with the European peace settlement. Madras was restored to the British; Louisbourg in America was returned to the French. Both sides remained equal after this first round.

Second Carnatic War (1749–1754)

- **Background:** The declining grip of Mughal central authority created succession disputes in both Hyderabad and the Carnatic — giving the French and British an opportunity to meddle in Indian politics and expand their footprint.

After Nizam-ul-Mulk's (the founder of Hyderabad) death in 1748, a succession dispute erupted between his son Nasir Jung and grandson Muzaffar Jung. Simultaneously, Chanda Sahib — released by the Marathas after seven years of captivity — challenged the Carnatic throne held by Anwaruddin.

- **Rival Alliances:** The French backed Chanda Sahib and Muzaffar Jung; the British supported Anwaruddin and Nasir Jung.
- **Battle of Ambur (1749):** French-backed Chanda Sahib defeated and killed Nawab Anwar-ud-din. His son Muhammad Ali took refuge in Trichinopoly.
- **French Gains:** After Nasir Jung's death in 1750, Muzaffar Jung became the Nizam of Hyderabad. In gratitude, he granted the territories of Masulipatnam and Pondicherry to Dupleix and appointed him honorary governor of the Mughal territories stretching from the Krishna River to Kanyakumari.
- After Muzaffar Jung's death, Bussy installed Salabat Jung (the third son of Nizam-ul-Mulk) on the throne. In return, the new Nizam granted the French the Andhra region known as the Northern Circars — comprising four districts: Mustafanagar, Ellore, Rajahmundry, and Chicacole.
- The general of Tanjore treacherously killed Chanda Sahib, and when the French attacked Trichinopoly, they were repulsed by the British.
- **Treaty of Pondicherry (1754):** Dupleix was recalled to France and appointed Godeheu as the new Governor of Pondicherry; Godeheu signed a ceasefire with the British. Muhammad Ali Khan Wallajah was confirmed as Nawab of Carnatic. Both sides pledged non-interference in disputes of Indian rulers.

Third Carnatic War (1758–1763)

- **Background:** An extension of the Seven Years' War (1756 to 1763) between Austria (supported by France) and Prussia (supported by Britain). The global conflict directly impacted relations between the two powers in India.
- **Immediate Cause:** The French government appointed Count de Lally with full civil and military powers; in 1758 he captured Fort St. David but failed to take Tanjore, and his major strategic mistake was recalling Bussy from Hyderabad, which weakened French influence in the Deccan.
- **Battle of Wandiwash (January 22, 1760):** Decisive British victory under Sir Eyre Coote. Bussy was taken prisoner. The British captured Pondicherry (1761), Mahe, and Gingee.
- **Treaty of Paris (1763):** France was compelled to return captured British territories; in turn, the British returned French factories in India. Critically, France could no longer fortify its settlements or maintain soldiers there — they could function only as commercial centres, not military bases. French ambitions for a political empire in India were permanently ended.

Why the British Succeeded and the French Failed

Factor	British East India Company	French East India Company
Company Structure	Independent, non-governmental; free from direct state control; able to act swiftly and retain profits	State-owned enterprise; dependent on government funding; bureaucratic and slow to respond
Economic Base	Had access to Bengal, Bombay, Madras, and Central India — a broad and wealthy trade network	Confined primarily to South India — a far narrower and weaker economic base

Factor	British East India Company	French East India Company
Military & Leadership	Well-disciplined army under strong, consistent leaders (Clive, Eyre Coote)	Poor strategic decisions: Dupleix recalled; Godeheu and La Bourdonnais lacked foresight; Lally recklessly aggressive
Political Stability	Britain enjoyed stable governance during this period	France was moving toward revolution and internal turmoil, undermining war effort
Local Alliances	French officials in Chandernagore failed to support Nawab Siraj-ud-Daulah, handing Bengal to the British	Critically lost the Bengal opportunity through inaction

British Conquest of Bengal

Bengal Before the Conquest

- **Wealthy Province:** Bengal was among the richest provinces of the Mughal Empire, known for exporting saltpetre, rice, indigo, and textiles to Europe.
- **Strategic Importance for EIC:** Since the 1630s, the East India Company sourced around 60% of its Asian imports from Bengal.
- **Growing Calcutta:** Calcutta's population grew from ~15,000 (1706) to ~100,000 (1750), reflecting the city's expanding commercial importance.

Ruler	Tenure	Key Note
Murshid Quli Khan	1700–1727	Established Bengal's administrative foundation; created conditions for British trade. Shifted capital from Dhaka to Maksudabad.
Shujauddin	1727–1739	Son-in-law and successor of Murshid Quli Khan.
Sarfaraz Khan	1739–1740	Deposed by Alivardi Khan.
Alivardi Khan	1740–1756	Repelled Maratha invasions; allowed British to fortify Fort William; grew wary of growing European influence; stopped paying tribute to the Mughal Emperor.
Siraj-ud-Daulah	1756–1757	Inherited a politically unstable Bengal; faced internal dissent and escalating conflict with the British.

Siraj-ud-Daulah's Challenges

- **Internal Dissent:** Faced opposition from powerful court factions — Shaukat Jung, Mir Jafar, Jagat Seth, and Omichand — all of whom opposed him.
- **Economic Tensions with EIC:** The British systematically misused the trading privileges granted by Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman (exempting the Company from customs duties on payment of Rs. 3,000 annually), using passes for private trade and causing significant revenue loss for the Nawab.
- **Fortification of Fort William:** Siraj viewed the British strengthening of Fort William as a direct military threat to his sovereignty.
- **Black Hole Incident (June 1756):** British captives were allegedly confined in a small dungeon — 146 locked in, only 23 surviving (as recorded by Holwell). This episode, presented by the British, further escalated hostilities.

- **Capture of Calcutta (June 1756):** Siraj captured Calcutta (Fort William), renamed it Alinagar, and appointed Manik Chand as custodian. Manik Chand accepted a bribe and returned the fort to the British.
- **Treaty of Alinagar (February 1757):** After Clive's success at Chandannagar, Siraj was compelled to sign — granting the British the right to fortify Calcutta and mint coins, and promising compensation for war losses.

Battle of Plassey — June 23, 1757

The Battle of Plassey is among the most decisive engagements in Indian history — it determined the fate of the subcontinent for the next two centuries.

- **The Conspiracy:** Encouraged by Siraj's weakened authority, the British forged a secret alliance with Mir Jafar (Commander-in-Chief), Rai Durlabh (Diwan), Jagat Seth, and others. Key conspirators also included Shaukat Jung, Ghasiti Begum, Manik Chand, Khadim Khan, and Aminchand. Robert Clive, with naval support from Admiral Watson, led the Company's operations that culminated in the Battle of Plassey.
- **The Battle:** On June 23, 1757, the Company army under Robert Clive faced Siraj's forces. Mir Jafar gave deliberately misleading advice, causing Siraj to postpone engagement by a day. When battle began, the armies of the traitors withdrew without fighting. Siraj's loyal commanders Mir Madan and Mohanlal were killed.
- **Nature of Victory:** Plassey was not an open military contest — it was a betrayal orchestrated as a battle. The British victory was fundamentally a result of Company diplomacy, especially Clive's.
- **Aftermath:** Siraj fled to Murshidabad, where he was assassinated by Muhammad Beg on orders of Mir Jafar's son Miran.

Results & Importance of Plassey

- **Political Transformation:** The Company emerged as a political power and assumed the role of 'kingmaker' in Bengal.
- **Economic Windfall:** The victory gave the British unrestricted access to Bengal's immense treasury — this financial strength directly powered their military expansion across India.
- **Territorial Gains:** New Nawab Mir Jafar granted the zamindari of 24 Parganas to the Company and extended rights for duty-free trade in Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa.

Mir Jafar, Mir Qasim & the Road to Buxar

- **Mir Jafar (Nawab, 1757–1760):** After the Battle of Plassey, Clive made Mir Jafar the Nawab of Bengal; he granted the Zamindari of 24 Parganas to the British but failed to satisfy them.
- As a result, Mir Jafar was removed and his son-in-law Mir Qasim was installed as the new Nawab of Bengal.
- **Mir Qasim's Agreement:** To secure the Nawabship, Mir Qasim signed an agreement with acting Governor Holwell, transferring the zamindaris of Burdwan, Midnapore, and Chittagong to the Company.
- **Mir Qasim's Reforms:** To assert independence, he shifted the capital from Murshidabad to Munger; reorganised the military on European lines; set up a cannon and gun factory; curbed financial corruption; and attempted to restrict misuse of the Dastak (trade passes).
- **Conflict — Abolition of Internal Duties (1763):** In 1763, Mir Qasim abolished all internal trade duties in Bengal, thereby removing the special trading privileges enjoyed by the British. He further imposed a uniform tax, known as *Khizri Jama*, on all traders to ensure equality in commerce. This measure adversely affected the British interests, leading them to declare war in July 1763, after which Mir Jafar was reinstated as the Nawab of Bengal.
- **Alliance Against the British:** After being expelled from Bengal, Mir Qasim sought refuge with the Nawab of Awadh, Shuja-ud-Daulah. The Mughal Emperor, Shah Alam II, who was already residing in Awadh, also joined this

alliance. The combined forces of Mir Qasim, the Nawab of Awadh, and the Mughal Emperor confronted the British in the decisive Battle of Buxar.

Battle of Buxar — October 22, 1764

- The British army was led by Hector Munro, while the forces of Mir Qasim were commanded by Gurgin Khan.
- Outcome:** The combined forces of Shuja-ud-Daulah, Mir Qasim, and Shah Alam II were decisively defeated. Shah Alam II surrendered to the British, while Shuja-ud-Daulah capitulated after brief resistance. Mir Qasim fled to Delhi, where he died in 1777.
- Significance:** Unlike the Battle of Plassey, which was won largely through betrayal, the Battle of Buxar was a primarily a military victory without internal treachery.

Treaty of Allahabad (1765)

Robert Clive, during his second tenure as Governor of Bengal, concluded the Treaty of Allahabad in two parts:

First Treaty of Allahabad — August 12, 1765 (Clive ↔ Shah Alam II)

- The Company secured the *Diwani* (revenue rights) of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa from Shah Alam II in return for an annual pension of ₹26 lakh to the Mughal Emperor.
- The Company agreed to pay ₹53 lakh in lieu of undertaking *Nizamat* functions, including military defence, policing, and administration of justice in these provinces.
- The districts of Kara and Allahabad were taken from the Nawab of Awadh and assigned to Shah Alam II, who consented to reside at Allahabad under the protection of the Company.

Second Treaty of Allahabad — August 16, 1765 (Clive ↔ Nawab of Awadh, Shuja-ud-Daulah)

- Awadh territories, except Allahabad and Kara, were restored to Shuja-ud-Daulah, who agreed to pay ₹50 lakh as war indemnity and to maintain a British force at his expense for defence.
- The Company secured duty-free trade in Awadh and granted Balwant Singh full possession of his estate under British protection, while he remained nominally subordinate to the Nawab of Awadh.

Dual Government in Bengal (1765–1772)

- After the Battle of Buxar, the East India Company acquired the *Diwani* (revenue administration and civil justice) from Shah Alam II, while the *Nizamat* (police, criminal justice, and nominal authority) formally remained with the Nawab, reducing him to a largely ceremonial position. In practice, real power rested with the Company.
- The Company administered revenue through Indian deputies (Naib-Diwans): Muhammad Reza Khan in Bengal, Shitab Rai in Bihar, and Rai Durlabh in Orissa. This arrangement created a separation between authority and responsibility—the Company controlled resources without assuming administrative accountability.

The system proved ineffective, failing to maintain law and order or regulate the economy of Bengal. Administrative disorder, exploitation in revenue collection, and economic decline followed, contributing to severe distress. Recognizing its failure, Warren Hastings abolished the Dual Government in 1772 and established direct Company administration

British Governors of Bengal

Governor of Bengal	Tenure
Robert Clive	1757–60 and 1765–67
Henry Vansittart	1760–65
Harry Verelst	1767–69

Governor of Bengal	Tenure
John Cartier	1769–72

Conquest of Mysore — Anglo-Mysore Wars (1767–1799)

Mysore Before British Intervention

- **Wodeyar Dynasty:** The Wodeyar dynasty ruled Mysore from 1612. By the mid-18th century, power shifted to Haider Ali, a brilliant military tactician who became the *de facto* ruler in 1761. Mysore's rise, its control over the lucrative Malabar Coast trade, and its proximity to the French threatened British interests, leading to four major conflicts.

The Four Anglo-Mysore Wars

War & Year	Governor-General / British Leader	Cause / Key Events	Treaty & Outcome
First (1767–1769)	Harry Verelst	British allied with Marathas & Nizam against Haider. Haider diplomatically flipped the alliance and allied with the Nizam to attack the Nawab of Arcot. The war lasted approximately 1.5 years with no decisive outcome, culminating in Haider's march on Madras itself — causing panic among the British.	Treaty of Madras (1769): Mutual return of conquered lands. British promised to help Haider if he was attacked.
Second (1780–1784)	Warren Hastings (Eyre Coote led forces)	Immediate Causes: The British failed to help Haider Ali when the Marathas attacked him in 1771 (violating the 1769 Treaty of Madras). • The Mahe Issue: The British attempted to capture the French port of Mahe, which was crucial for Haider's military supplies and under his direct protection. The Grand Alliance & Initial Success: Haider Ali forged a powerful anti-British coalition with the Marathas and the Nizam. He successfully invaded the Carnatic, captured Arcot, and severely defeated British Colonel Baillie. British Counter-Diplomacy: Governor-General Warren Hastings dispatched veteran commander	Treaty of Mangalore (1784): Signed by Tipu Sultan. Both the parties gave back the territories they had taken from each other.

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War & Year	Governor-General / British Leader	Cause / Key Events	Treaty & Outcome
		Sir Eyre Coote. Coote skillfully used diplomacy to detach Mahadaji Sindhia (Marathas) and the Nizam from Haider's alliance. Battle of Porto Novo (1781): Sir Eyre Coote defeated Haider Ali, halting Mysore's momentum, though British territorial gains remained limited. Change of Command (Dec 1782): Haider Ali died of cancer in the middle of the war. His son, Tipu Sultan, immediately took command and continued the struggle.	
Third (1790–1792)	Lord Cornwallis	Immediate Cause: Tipu Sultan attacked Travancore (a British ally) over a border dispute. The British used this as a primary excuse for war, alongside accusations that Tipu was conspiring with the French. The Triple Alliance: Governor-General Lord Cornwallis formed a massive coalition, bringing the Nizam of Hyderabad and the Marathas onto the British side against Tipu. Course of War: Cornwallis personally led the campaign. After capturing Vellore and Bangalore, the combined allied forces laid a massive siege to Tipu's capital, Srirangapatna (Seringapatam), in 1792, forcing Tipu to surrender.	Treaty of Seringapatam (1792): Tipu lost half his kingdom, paid ₹3 crore indemnity, and gave two sons as hostages.
Fourth (1799)	Lord Wellesley	Cause: The British, under Lord Wellesley, grew apprehensive of Tipu Sultan's continued diplomatic contacts with France and his efforts to seek external support, including correspondence with Napoleon Bonaparte. Course: The war commenced on April 17, 1799. British forces, aided by the Marathas and the Nizam of Hyderabad, advanced against Mysore and laid	No Treaty (Tipu died in battle). Wodeyar dynasty restored under Krishnaraja III.

War & Year	Governor-General / British Leader	Cause / Key Events	Treaty & Outcome
		siege to Srirangapatna, where Tipu offered determined resistance but was ultimately defeated. Death of Tipu (May 4, 1799): Tipu Sultan was killed while defending his capital, Srirangapatna, bringing the war to a decisive close.	Subsidiary Alliance imposed.

Haider Ali (1721–1782)

- **Rise to Power:** Started as a horseman; became the *de facto* ruler of Mysore in 1761.
- **Military:** Introduced Western training methods to his army with French assistance. Subdued the Poligars (military chiefs) of South India.
- **Important Battle:** Defeated by British General Sir Eyre Coote at the **Battle of Porto Novo** (1781) during the Second War. Died of cancer in 1782.

Tipu Sultan (1750–1799) - "Tiger of Mysore"

- **Military & Tech:** Known as the **pioneer of rocket technology** in India; wrote a military manual on their use.
- **Navy:** Set up a Board of Admiralty (1796) and built dockyards at Mangalore, Wajedabad, and Molidabad.
- **Economy:** Introduced **sericulture** (silk farming) to Mysore.
- **French Connection:** Planted the '**Tree of Liberty**' at his capital, Seringapatam.
 - Joined the French **Jacobin Club** and called himself "Citizen Tipu."
- **Death:** Killed in action on May 4, 1799, defending Seringapatam.

The Subsidiary Alliance (Introduced 1798)

- **Introduced By:** Lord Wellesley.
- **First Signatory:** The Nizam of Hyderabad.
- **Core Conditions for Indian Rulers:**
 - Must pay a subsidy to maintain a British army within their territory.
 - Must host a British Resident at their court.
 - Cannot employ Europeans without British permission.
 - Cannot declare war or make foreign alliances without British consent.
- **Impact on Mysore:** After Tipu's death in 1799, the British installed a minor from the old Wodeyar dynasty (Krishnaraja III) and immediately forced him to sign this alliance, reduced Mysore to a dependent ally under British control.

The Anglo-Maratha Struggle (1775–1819)

The Anglo-Maratha conflicts spanned approximately 45 years, culminating in the complete establishment of British paramountcy in India. The underlying cause of Maratha defeat was their persistent internal disunity, which provided the British East India Company ample opportunity to intervene in succession disputes.

Pre-War Context: Following the disastrous Third Battle of Panipat (1761), Peshwa Madhav Rao I temporarily restored Maratha prestige. However, his premature death in 1772 plunged the empire into chaos. A succession crisis erupted

when Raghunath Rao (Raghoba) assassinated his nephew, Narayan Rao, to seize the Peshwaship, prompting the Maratha chiefs (*Barabhai*, led by Nana Phadnavis) to rebel and install Narayan Rao's infant son as the rightful Peshwa.

First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–1782)

- **Immediate Cause:** Driven by ambition, Raghunath Rao sought British military assistance to secure the Peshwaship, signing the **Treaty of Surat (1775)** with the Bombay Presidency in exchange for ceding Salsette and Bassein.
- **Course of Conflict:** The Calcutta Council initially rejected the Surat agreement, signing the **Treaty of Purandar (1776)** with the Pune Darbar instead. However, hostilities resumed. Despite superior British artillery, Maratha commander **Mahadaji Sindhia** utilized brilliant scorched-earth tactics, forcing a humiliating British surrender at Wadgaon.
- **Conclusion:** Governor-General **Warren Hastings** rejected the Wadgaon surrender and dispatched reinforcements. After a decisive campaign, the war concluded with the **Treaty of Salbai (1782)**, mediated by Mahadaji Sindhia.
- **Outcome:** The Treaty of Salbai guaranteed **20 years of peace**. The British retained Salsette, and the Marathas agreed to exclude other European powers from their courts.

Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803–1805)

- **Immediate Cause:** Internal civil war. After being defeated by Jaswant Rao Holkar at the Battle of Hadapsar (1802), the defeated Peshwa Baji Rao II fled to the British and signed the **Treaty of Bassein (Dec 1802)**.
- **The Turning Point:** The Treaty of Bassein was effectively a **Subsidiary Alliance**. It reduced the Peshwa to a British vassal. Proud Maratha chiefs (Bhonsle and Sindhia) viewed this as a surrender of national independence and declared war.
- **Course of Conflict:** Under Governor-General **Lord Wellesley**, the British launched a two-pronged attack (Arthur Wellesley in the Deccan, General Lake in the North), swiftly crushing the disjointed Maratha armies and capturing Delhi and Agra.

Resulting Treaties: The defeated Maratha clans were forced to sign individual treaties, severely stripping them of territory and sovereignty.

Treaty of Deogaon (1803) with Bhonsle;

Treaty of Surji-Anjangaon (1803) with Sindhia;

Treaty of Rajpurghat (1806) with Holkar.

Third Anglo-Maratha War (1816–1819)

- **Immediate Cause:** Governor-General **Lord Hastings's** aggressive campaign against the **Pindaris**. The Maratha chiefs, deeply resenting the loss of their sovereignty, used this campaign as a final, desperate pretext to unite and throw off the British yoke.

NOTE - Pindaris: Unpaid soldiers who served in the Maratha army and were rewarded with a share of plunder. Their practice began during Baji Rao I's era.

- **Course of Conflict:** The war began when Peshwa Baji Rao II attacked the British Residency in Poona. The British decisively defeated the Peshwa at Khirki, Bhonsle at Sitabuldi, and Holkar at Mahidpur, leading to:

Treaty of Poona (June 1817) with the Peshwa.

Treaty of Gwalior (November 1817) with Scindia.

Treaty of Mandsaur (January 1818) with Holkar

- **Outcome:** The Maratha Confederacy was utterly dissolved.
 - The historical **office of the Peshwa was abolished**.

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- Baji Rao II was pensioned off and **exiled to Bithur** (near Kanpur).
- A minor descendant of Shivaji (Pratap Singh) was installed as the nominal ruler of the tiny state of Satara to placate local sentiments.

The Anglo-Maratha Wars at a Glance

War Phase	Duration	British Governor-General	Resulting Milestone
First War	1775–1782	Warren Hastings	Treaty of Salbai (20 years of peace)
Second War	1803–1805	Lord Wellesley	Treaty of Bassein (Subsidiary Alliance)
Third War	1817–1819	Lord Hastings (Moirā)	Abolition of the Peshwaship

List of Maratha Treaties

Year	Name of Treaty	Signatories / Factions Involved
1775	Treaty of Surat	Raghunath Rao & British (Bombay)
1776	Treaty of Purandar	Pune Darbar & British (Calcutta)
1779	Treaty of Wadgaon	Pune Darbar & British (Humiliating defeat for British)
1782	Treaty of Salbai	Pune Darbar & British (Mediated by Mahadaji Sindhia)
1802	Treaty of Bassein	Baji Rao II & British (Accepted Subsidiary Alliance)
1803	Treaty of Deogaon	Bhonsle & British
1803	Treaty of Surji-Anjangaon	Sindhia & British
1806	Treaty of Rajpurghat	Holkar & British
1816	Treaty of Nagpur	Bhonsle & British

Year	Name of Treaty	Signatories / Factions Involved
1817	Treaty of Gwalior	Sindhia & British
1817	Treaty of Poona	Baji Rao II & British
1818	Treaty of Mandsaur	Holkar & British

The British Annexation of Sindh

The British conquest of Sindh was a prime example of aggressive imperial expansion, driven largely by the "Great Game"—the British fear of Russian influence advancing through Central Asia and Afghanistan. The annexation was a phased process, slowly eroding the sovereignty of the native rulers through a series of increasingly restrictive treaties.

Background: The Rule of the Amirs

Prior to British intervention, Sindh was ruled by the **Kalhora dynasty**. However, in 1783, **Mir Fath Ali Khan**, a leader of the Talpur Baloch tribe, successfully overthrew the Kalhoras. He established the rule of the Talpur Amirs, and the administration was subsequently divided among four brothers, collectively known as the *Char Yar* (Four Friends).

The Gradual Loss of Sovereignty

The British methodically stripped Sindh of its independence over several decades.

- **The Early Overtures (1799):** Governor-General Lord Wellesley attempted to establish commercial ties to neutralize potential French influence, but the British were expelled by Amirs in 1800.
- **The Russian Paranoia (1836):** Governor-General **Lord Auckland** adopted a forward policy, viewing Sindh as a necessary geopolitical buffer against Russian expansionism and a staging ground for British intervention in Afghanistan.
- **The Tripartite Treaty (1838):** A geopolitical agreement signed between the **British, Maharaja Ranjit Singh of Punjab, and Shah Shuja** (the exiled Afghan monarch). It compromised Sindh's sovereignty by forcing the Amirs to pay historical arrears to Shah Shuja, effectively funding the British campaign in Afghanistan.
- **Subsidiary Alliance (1839):** Exploiting the Amirs' vulnerabilities, the British forced them into a subsidiary treaty. This mandated the stationing of a British military force in Sindh at the Amirs' expense and stripped them of their right to conduct independent foreign relations.

Treaties of Sindh

Year	Treaty / Event	British Authority	Key Outcome
1809	Treaty of Eternal Friendship	Lord Minto	Mutual peace; Amirs agreed to exclude the French from Sindh.
1832	Commercial Treaty	Lord William Bentinck	Opened the Indus River and Sindh roads for British trade, but strictly prohibited military transport.
1838	Protectorate Treaty	Lord Auckland	British assumed the role of "mediator" between Sindh and the Sikh Empire.

The Final Annexation (1843)

The disastrous First Anglo-Afghan War (1839–1842) severely damaged British prestige. Seeking a compensatory victory, the British turned their sights on Sindh, despite the Amirs having remained largely loyal during the Afghan crisis.

- **The Provocation:** Governor-General **Lord Ellenborough** actively sought a pretext for annexation. He dispatched the aggressive military commander, **Sir Charles Napier**, who provoked the Amirs into an uprising.
- **The Conquest:** The Amirs' forces were decisively defeated. In **1843**, Sindh was formally annexed and merged into the Bombay Presidency.
- **The Aftermath:** Sir Charles Napier was appointed as the first British Governor of Sindh.

Anglo-Sikh Wars

The conquest of Punjab marked the final major phase of British territorial expansion in India. The Sikh Empire, consolidated into a formidable military power under Maharaja Ranjit Singh, collapsed within a decade of his death due to internal political fracturing, making it vulnerable to British imperial ambitions.

The Genesis of the Sikh Empire

- **Early Resistance:** Following the passing of Guru Gobind Singh, the military leadership of the Sikhs was assumed by **Banda Bahadur**. He dismantled the oppressive Mughal Zamindari system in Punjab before his capture and execution in 1716.
- **The Dal Khalsa (1748):** To survive Afghan and Mughal persecution, the fragmented Sikh factions were politically and militarily unified by **Kapur Singh Faizullapuria** into the *Dal Khalsa*. It was strategically divided into the *Taruna Dal* (active youth warriors) and the *Budha Dal* (veteran strategists).

Maharaja Ranjit Singh (1780–1839): The Lion of Punjab

Born into the **Sukerchakia Misl** (one of the 12 sovereign Sikh confederacies), Ranjit Singh emerged as a visionary leader who forged a sprawling empire spanning Multan, Kashmir, and Peshawar.

- **Rise to Power:** At just 19, he was appointed Governor of Lahore (1799) by the Afghan ruler Zaman Shah. By 1802, he captured the spiritual capital, Amritsar, from the rival Bhangi Misl.
- **Secular Administration:** Establishing Lahore as his political capital, Ranjit Singh founded the *Adalat-i-Ala* (High Court). His administration was notably secular; his most trusted Foreign Minister was a Muslim (**Fakir Azizuddin**), and his Finance Minister was a Hindu (**Diwan Dinanath**).
- **Diplomacy & The Kohinoor:** In 1809, he signed the crucial **Treaty of Amritsar** with Charles Metcalfe, which cemented the Sutlej River as the permanent boundary between his empire and British India. He later acquired the legendary **Kohinoor diamond** from the exiled Afghan monarch, Shah Shuja, in exchange for military assistance.
- **Military Modernization (Fauj-i-Khas):** Ranjit Singh modernized the Khalsa army utilizing European mercenaries, transforming it into the second most powerful military force in Asia.

European Commanders in Ranjit Singh's Army

European General	Nationality	Military Division Commanded
General Ventura	Italian	Infantry (Foot Soldiers)
General Allard	French	Cavalry (Horsemen)
General Court	French	Artillery (Cannons)
Colonel Gardner	American	Artillery / Infantry

The First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–1846)

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- **Immediate Cause:** A succession crisis and court intrigues following Ranjit Singh's death led to severe instability. The war was triggered in December 1845 when the Khalsa army, provoked by the aggressive buildup of British forces, crossed the Sutlej River.
- **Course of War:** Under Governor-General **Lord Hardinge** and Commander Sir Hugh Gough, fierce engagements occurred at Mudki, Ferozeshah, Baddowal, and Aliwal. The British secured a decisive, albeit bloody, victory at the **Battle of Sobraon (Feb 1846)**.
- **The Dual Treaties of 1846:**
 - **Treaty of Lahore (March 1846):** The Sikhs were forced to pay a ₹1 crore indemnity, cede the Jalandhar Doab, and accept a British Resident at Lahore. Because the Darbar could not pay the full indemnity, the British sold Kashmir to Dogra chief **Gulab Singh** for ₹75 lakh.
 - **Treaty of Bhairawal (Dec 1846):** Imposed after a Sikh rebellion over the sale of Kashmir. Rani Jindan was stripped of her regency and pensioned off. A Council of 8 Sikh Sardars was formed, heavily controlled by the British Resident, **Sir Henry Lawrence**.

The Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848–1849)

- **Immediate Cause:** Profound Sikh resentment over the humiliating terms of 1846, coupled with the maltreatment of Rani Jindan. The catalyst was a massive rebellion in Multan led by its governor, **Diwan Mulraj**, resulting in the assassination of two British officers.
- **Course of War:** Orchestrated by the fiercely imperialist Governor-General **Lord Dalhousie**, the war featured three major battles:
 - *Battle of Ramnagar* (Nov 1848) – Indecisive.
 - *Battle of Chillianwala* (Jan 1849) – A devastatingly costly battle for the British.
 - *Battle of Gujrat* (Feb 1849) – Fought largely with artillery (known historically as the "**Battle of Guns**"), resulting in the final, crushing defeat of the Sikh army.
- **The Annexation (March 1849):** Lord Dalhousie formally wiped the Sikh Empire off the map, annexing Punjab entirely.

The Aftermath

- The young Maharaja **Daleep Singh** was deposed, granted an annual pension, and exiled to England for "education."
- The priceless **Kohinoor diamond** was confiscated by Dalhousie and surrendered to the British Crown.
- Punjab was placed under a three-member Board of Administration (including the Lawrence brothers). By 1853, **John Lawrence** was appointed as the first Chief Commissioner of Punjab.

British India's Relations with Neighbouring Countries

British foreign policy regarding its neighbors was dictated by two primary motives: the economic exploitation of regional resources and the strategic necessity of creating "buffer states" to counter rival imperial powers (namely, the French in Southeast Asia and the Russians in Central Asia).

Anglo-Nepalese Relations

- **Context:** The British annexation of Gorakhpur in 1801 dissolved the geographical buffer between the East India Company and the expanding Gurkha kingdom, leading to immediate border frictions.
- **The Anglo-Nepalese War (1814–1816):** Fought during the tenure of **Lord Hastings**, the war was triggered by Gurkha incursions into Butwal and Sheoraj. Despite fierce Gurkha resistance at the battles of Nalapani and Jaithak, the British ultimately triumphed, forcing the surrender of the legendary Gurkha commander Amar Singh Thapa at Malaon.
- **The Treaty of Sugauli (Ratified 1816):** A landmark agreement that deeply shaped modern borders.
 - Nepal ceded the disputed districts of Garhwal, Kumaon, and the Terai.
 - Nepal withdrew all territorial claims over Sikkim.
 - A British Resident was permanently stationed in Kathmandu.

Anglo-Bhutanese Relations

- **Context:** Following the British annexation of Assam (1826), frequent cross-border raids by the Bhutanese into the Bengal and Assam plains heightened tensions. In 1863, a diplomatic envoy led by Ashley Eden (under Lord Elgin) was humiliated by the Bhutanese court.

- **The Retaliation & Treaty of Sinchula (1865):** Under Governor-General **John Lawrence**, the British launched a military expedition, occupying strategic mountain passes. To secure peace, Bhutan signed the **Treaty of Sinchula**, ceding the fertile Assam and Bengal Duars (over 80,000 sq. km) to the British in exchange for an annual subsidy of ₹50,000.

Anglo-Burmese Relations

Imperial designs on Burma were catalyzed by the desire to dominate the timber trade, secure new consumer markets, and preempt French colonial ambitions in Southeast Asia.

The Anglo-Burmese Wars

War	Duration	Governor-General	Immediate Cause	Treaty / Final Outcome
First War	1824–1826	Lord Amherst	Burmese occupation of Arakan and threats to British Assam.	Treaty of Yandabo (1826): Burma paid a ₹1 crore indemnity, ceded Arakan and Tenasserim, and recognized Manipur's independence.
Second War	1852	Lord Dalhousie	Commercial disputes and British greed for the timber-rich coastal provinces.	Annexation of Pegu (Lower Burma). Burma was effectively cut off from the sea.
Third War	1885	Lord Dufferin	King Thibaw's hostility towards the British and his secret commercial treaties with France.	Annexation of Upper Burma. The entire nation was integrated into British India.

(Note: Burma remained a province of British India until it was officially separated in 1937 under the Government of India Act of 1935).

Anglo-Afghan Relations

Throughout the 19th century, Afghanistan was viewed solely as a geographical pawn—a critical "buffer state" necessary to halt the southward expansion of the Russian Empire into British India.

- **The First Anglo-Afghan War (1839–1842):** Driven by the aggressive "Forward Policy" of **Lord Auckland**. The British formed a Tripartite Treaty (with Ranjit Singh and Shah Shuja) to depose the Afghan Amir, Dost Mohammad. Though the British initially captured Kabul, a massive Afghan uprising forced a disastrous, catastrophic military retreat in 1842. Dost Mohammad ultimately reclaimed his throne.
- **The Policy of "Masterly Inactivity" (1864–1869):** Initiated by Governor-General **John Lawrence**, this pragmatic policy strictly avoided interference in internal Afghan succession struggles, ensuring a period of stable, peaceful borders.
- **The Second Anglo-Afghan War (1878–1880):** Governor-General **Lord Lytton** discarded Lawrence's peaceful approach and demanded a British envoy be accepted in Kabul. When Amir Sher Ali refused, the British invaded. This resulted in the **Treaty of Gandamak (1879)**, which forcibly subordinated Afghan foreign policy to British control.
- **The Durand Line (1893):** Drawn during the tenure of **Lord Lansdowne**, this controversial boundary officially demarcated the border between British India and Afghanistan.
- **The Third Anglo-Afghan War (1919):** Following a brief conflict, the **Treaty of Rawalpindi (1921)** finally recognized full Afghan independence and sovereignty over its foreign affairs.

Anglo-Tibetan Relations

- **Context:** Nominally under Chinese suzerainty, Tibet was ruled by a theocracy of Buddhist Lamas. By the dawn of the 20th century, rumors of Russian diplomats infiltrating Lhasa sparked intense British paranoia.
- **The Younghusband Expedition (1903–1904):** Governor-General **Lord Curzon** dispatched a military expedition led by Colonel Francis Younghusband to force Tibet out of its isolationist shell. The superiorly armed Gurkha and British contingents easily overpowered the Tibetan forces.
- **The Treaty of Lhasa (1904):** Tibet was levied a heavy indemnity (initially ₹75 lakh, later reduced to ₹25 lakh).
 - The strategic **Chumbi Valley** was occupied by the British for three years as collateral.
 - Trade marts were forcibly opened at Yatung, Gyantse, and Gartok.
 - Tibet pledged to strictly prohibit any other foreign power (specifically Russia) from interfering in its affairs or building infrastructure.

EXPANSION OF BRITISH POWER IN INDIA

- **Initial Phase (1600):** The English East India Company (EIC) arrived in India strictly as a trading entity.
- **Turning Point (1764):** The **Battle of Buxar** marked a decisive shift. By this time, the British had effectively eliminated most European rivals and neutralized major native adversaries.
- **Opportunity for Expansion:** India's political fragmentation, widespread anarchy, and the absence of unified resistance left the subcontinent wide open for British territorial expansion.

Key Reasons for British Success

- **Political Vacuum:** A severe lack of central authority following the decline of the Mughal Empire.
- **Internal Divisions:** The absence of a unified nationalist ideology. The British expertly exploited mutual squabbles and political rivalries among Indian rulers.
- **Social Fragmentation:** Indian society was deeply divided along socio-religious lines. Loyalties were largely confined to regional and caste identities, preventing a united front.
- **Military Superiority:** The British possessed superior military organization, advanced weaponry, and modern strategic warfare tactics.
- **Strategic Imperial Policies:** The systematic application of three major policies to consolidate control:
 1. **Dual Government** (Lord Clive)
 2. **Subsidiary Alliance** (Lord Wellesley)
 3. **Doctrine of Lapse** (Lord Dalhousie)

KEY GOVERNOR-GENERALS AT A GLANCE

Governor-General	Tenure	Key Policy	Major Contribution	Key Battle / Event
Lord Clive	1757–1760; 1765–1767	Dual Government	Laid the foundation of the British Empire; Secured the crucial victory at Plassey.	Battle of Plassey (1757) Battle of Buxar (1764)
Warren Hastings	1772–1785	Abolished Dual Govt.	Strengthened the administrative foundation; Became the First Governor-General of Bengal.	First Anglo-Maratha War
Lord Cornwallis	1786–1793	Permanent Settlement	Began erecting the administrative structure; Introduced major Civil Service and judicial reforms.	Third Anglo-Mysore War

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Governor-General	Tenure	Key Policy	Major Contribution	Key Battle / Event
Lord Wellesley	1798–1805	Subsidiary Alliance	Established British paramountcy; Completely eliminated French influence from Indian courts.	Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799), Second Anglo-Maratha War
Lord Dalhousie	1848–1856	Doctrine of Lapse	Achieved massive territorial expansion; Introduced modern infrastructure (Railways, Telegraph).	Anglo-Sikh Wars

Lord Clive's Dual Government (1765–1772)**Background & Key Events**

- **Battle of Plassey (June 23, 1757):** Siraj-ud-Daulah was defeated, marking the beginning of the British conquest of Bengal.
- **Battle of Buxar (Oct 22, 1764):** A decisive British victory over the combined Indian forces, cementing British supremacy.
- **Treaty of Allahabad (Aug 12, 1765):** The British were formally granted the **Diwani** (revenue rights) of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa by the Mughal Emperor.
- **Acquisition of Nizamat:** The British concurrently acquired **Nizamat** (Subedari/administrative) rights from the Nawab of Bengal, Najm-ud-Daulah.

Understanding the Dual System: Diwani vs. Nizamat

The core of the Dual Government was the separation of power and responsibility into two distinct branches.

Feature	DIWANI (Civil & Revenue)	NIZAMAT / SUBEDARI (Executive & Judicial)
Primary Function	Collection of land revenue.	Maintenance of law & order.
Secondary Function	Adjudication of civil disputes (related to land tax).	Internal security and policing.
Presiding Officer	Diwan	Subedar / Nawab
Company Appointees	Bengal: Reza Khan Bihar: Shitab Roy Orissa: Rai Durlabh	Managed entirely by the Nawab's own native officials.

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Feature	DIWANI (Civil & Revenue)	NIZAMAT / SUBEDARI (Executive & Judicial)
Source of Authority	Rights granted by the Mughal Emperor via the Treaty of Allahabad (1765) .	Rights acquired from the Nawab of Bengal, Najm-ud-Daulah.

Why was the Dual Government Established?

Instead of taking direct control, Lord Clive designed this system for several strategic reasons:

- **Concealing Imperial Intent:** Direct rule would expose the Company's imperialist face, risking local rebellions and uniting European rivals against them.
- **Lack of Manpower & Knowledge:** The Company lacked the administrative personnel and the understanding of local customs needed to govern Bengal directly. Indian intermediaries were essential.
- **Profit Over Responsibility:** The Court of Directors prioritized maximum financial profit and wished to avoid the costs and burdens of direct political administration.
- **Fear of Parliament:** Acquiring open political power in India would likely invite unwanted interference and regulation from the British Parliament in London.

Impact of the Dual Government

This system created a corrupted environment of *"power without responsibility and responsibility without power."*

Aspect	Benefits to the British Company	Devastating Impact on Bengal
Administration	Extremely low administrative burden; absolute control without any accountability.	Complete anarchy and collapse of the justice system. The Nawab had responsibility but no funds.
Economy/Revenue	Commanded the entire treasury of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa.	Brutal taxation policies and harsh collection methods led to the extreme exploitation of farmers.
Agriculture	Maximized income through contracted revenue collection.	Severe agricultural collapse, culminating in the horrific Famine of 1770 causing massive loss of life.
Trade & Industry	Strengthened monopoly via 'Free Trade' (Dastak); procured goods at artificially low prices.	Complete ruin of local industries and crafts. Weavers were forced into agricultural labor.
Military & Security	Company's army controlled the territory, paid for by the region's revenue.	The Nawab was left completely defenseless with no real army.

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Aspect	Benefits to the British Company	Devastating Impact on Bengal
Diplomacy	Successfully avoided rivalry or conflicts with other European powers in the region.	The Nawab of Bengal was reduced to a mere dependent figurehead.

✦ **NOTE:** Warren Hastings abolished the Dual System of Government in 1772. Criticizing this period, the famous British historian Percival Spear termed it an "era of open and shameless plunder."

Lord Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance (1798 onwards)

Background & Objectives

Lord Wellesley arrived in India as the Governor-General of Bengal in 1798. Driven by a strong imperialist ideology, his primary objectives were twofold:

1. Establish the British East India Company as the supreme paramount power in India.
2. Completely destroy the growing French influence within the courts and armies of Indian rulers.

✦ **NOTE:** While Wellesley gave it a systematic and formal structure, the French Governor **Dupleix** was actually the first to conceptualize the 'subsidiary' system by providing French troops to Indian rulers in exchange for financial payment.

Chronology of States Accepting the Alliance

State	Year	Historical Remarks
Hyderabad	1798 & 1800	The first state to accept the alliance under Wellesley.
Mysore	1799	Imposed after the 4th Anglo-Mysore War and the death of Tipu Sultan.
Tanjore	Oct 1799	Accepted peacefully.
Awadh	Nov 1801	Formalized the earlier informal arrangement that existed since 1765.
Peshwa	Dec 1802	Signed via the Treaty of Bassein , severely weakening Maratha power.
Bhonsles (Berar)	Dec 1803	Accepted after defeat in the Anglo-Maratha conflict.
Sindhias	Dec 1803	Another significant Maratha power subdued.

State	Year	Historical Remarks
Rajput States	1803–1804	Jodhpur, Jaipur, Bundi, and Bharatpur were brought under the umbrella.
Holkars of Indore	—	EXCEPTION: They DID NOT accept the Subsidiary Alliance.

Analyzing the System: Features, Benefits, and Consequences

Key Features of the Alliance	Benefits to the British Company	Disastrous Impact on Native States
Foreign Policy Control: No war, treaty, or alliance without Company permission.	British paramountcy was firmly established over the Indian subcontinent.	Loss of Sovereignty: States completely lost their independent foreign policy.
Employment Restriction: No shelter or employment to enemy nationals (French) without EIC approval.	French influence was completely eradicated from Indian courts and armies.	Rulers were reduced to mere nominal heads within their own territories.
British Resident: A British Resident was permanently stationed in the native court.	The Company controlled strategic locations and became the arbitrator of all disputes.	Rulers became complacent and indolent under the British "security umbrella."
Military Maintenance: Native states had to pay for the British army stationed there (via cash or ceded territory).	The EIC acquired a massive, standing army entirely at the expense of Indian states.	Economic Ruin: Excessive military costs led to state bankruptcy.
Defense Guarantee: EIC promised protection from internal and external threats.	Completely nullified the threat of any united Indian confederacy against the Company.	Independent native armies were disbanded, leading to massive unemployment.
Non-Interference: EIC promised not to interfere in internal administration (mostly a nominal promise).	Secured loyal "buffer states" around British territories.	Native economies collapsed, pulling down local handicraft industries with them.

Lord Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse (1848–1856)

Concept & Implementation

Lord Dalhousie served as Governor-General from 1848 to 1856. He aggressively expanded the British Empire using the **Doctrine of Lapse** (Principle of Annexation).

- **The Core Principle:** If a ruler of a protected state died **without a natural heir**, his state would not pass to an adopted son. Instead, the state would "lapse" and be annexed to the British Empire.

✦ **HISTORICAL CONTEXT:** The practice of adopting an heir had been recognized in India since ancient times and was fully sanctioned by religion and tradition. Dalhousie deliberately weaponized the denial of this right as a tool for imperial expansion.

Dalhousie's Classification of Indian States

To implement his policy, Dalhousie categorized native states into three groups regarding their right to adopt:

Category	State Description	Rule on Adoption
First	Independent states; never subordinate to the British and paid no tribute.	No British interference; full right to adopt.
Second	Previously under the Mughal Emperor or Peshwa, but now subordinate to the British.	Consent Required: Must obtain Government approval before adopting an heir.
Third	States directly or indirectly created/restored by the British government.	Total Ban: Completely prohibited from adopting an heir.

Chronological Annexation Under the Doctrine

State Annexed	Year	Ruler / Key Figure	Reason / Remarks
Satara	1848	Appa Sahib	First victim; Appa Sahib's adopted heir was invalidated by Dalhousie.
Jaitpur	1849	—	Located in Bundelkhand; ruler died without a natural heir.
Sambalpur	1849	Narayan Singh	Died childless; the widowed queen's attempt to rule was declared invalid.
Baghat	1850	—	Annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse.

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State Annexed	Year	Ruler / Key Figure	Reason / Remarks
Udaipur	1852	—	Annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse.
Jhansi	1853	Gangadhar Rao (Husband of Rani Lakshmibai)	Died without a natural heir; adoption of Damodar Rao was rejected.
Nagpur	1854	—	One of the largest territorial annexations under this doctrine.
Awadh	1856	Wajid Ali Shah	Annexed on charges of Misgovernance (Maladministration), NOT under the Doctrine of Lapse.

Impact & Criticism of the Policy

- **Lack of Legality:** While it rapidly consolidated the British Empire, the policy had absolutely no moral, judicial, or legal justification. British paramountcy here was asserted through sheer brute force.
- **Widespread Discontent:** The ruthless annexation of revered states (especially Jhansi and Awadh) filled the masses and native soldiers with deep-seated anger.
- **Trigger for 1857:** This accumulated anti-British sentiment was a primary catalyst for the massive **Revolt of 1857**, exploding shortly after Dalhousie departed India.
- **Policy Reversal:** Following the revolt, the British completely abandoned the Doctrine of Lapse. Under the new policy of *Subordinate Union* (1858), the right of native rulers to adopt an heir was officially restored.

Summary Comparison of the Three Major Policies

Feature	Dual Government	Subsidiary Alliance	Doctrine of Lapse
Introduced by	Lord Clive (1765)	Lord Wellesley (1798)	Lord Dalhousie (1848)
Abolished by	Warren Hastings (1772)	—	Abandoned after the Revolt of 1857
Region / Scope	Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa (Initial phase)	Pan-India	Specific Princely States
Core Method	Separation of power (Diwani) from responsibility (Nizamat).	Treaty-based subjugation and military dependence.	Aggressive annexation by denying the right of adoption.

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Feature	Dual Government	Subsidiary Alliance	Doctrine of Lapse
Fundamental Flaw	Created a system of power without responsibility.	Caused a massive financial drain on native states.	Completely illegal, immoral, and arbitrary annexation.
Main Impact	Widespread anarchy and the devastating Famine of 1770 .	States became completely bankrupt and forcefully disarmed.	Triggered massive discontent, culminating in the Revolt of 1857 .

Phases of British Policy Towards Native States

Background: The British did not maintain a single, static policy toward the Indian princely states. Their approach evolved dynamically based on their military strength, commercial needs, and the political climate. This evolution was classically categorized by William Lee-Warner in his authoritative book, *"The Native States of India"*.

Policy Phase	Period	Key Features & Imperial Strategy	Important Events & Examples
Policy of Ring Fence	1765–1813	Limited Liability & Non-Intervention: The EIC was still consolidating power. The strategy focused on creating ' Buffer States ' on their frontiers to absorb the shock of invasions (e.g., from Marathas or Afghans).	Awadh was maintained as a buffer state for Bengal. <i>(Note: Wars like the Rohilla War and Anglo-Mysore Wars were practical deviations from this non-intervention rule).</i>
Policy of Subordinate Isolation	1813–1858	Direct Subordination: Driven by British industrial 'Free Trade' needs, the EIC aggressively intervened to bring states under its paramountcy. They systematically severed the diplomatic ties between states so they could not unite.	The era of mass expansion using the Subsidiary Alliance (control of Marathas/Rajputs) and the ruthless Doctrine of Lapse .
Policy of Subordinate Union	1858–1935	Loyalty & Integration: A direct reaction to the 1857 Revolt. The British realized isolating states was dangerous. They stopped annexations, restored the right of adoption, and sought the loyalty of native rulers as subordinate allies.	Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1858); Victoria declared ' Empress of India ' (1876);

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Policy Phase	Period	Key Features & Imperial Strategy	Important Events & Examples
			Modern political integration via railways and telegraphs.
4. Policy of Equal Federation	1935–1947	Constitutional Containment: As Indian nationalism matured, the British used constitutional reforms to manage anti-imperialist sentiments, proposing a federation of British provinces and Princely states.	Government of India Act (1935) (proposed federation); Cripps Mission, Cabinet Mission, Mountbatten Plan; culminating in the Independence Act of 1947.

British Economic Policy in India

PHASES OF BRITISH COLONIALISM IN INDIA

Introduction & Background

- **The Turning Point:** British dominance over Indian trade was firmly established following the decisive Battles of Plassey (1757) and Buxar (1764).
- **Economic Transformation:** The Indian economy was forcibly transformed from a surplus, self-sufficient economy into a dependent **colonial economy**.
- **Core Objective:** The primary motive was to procure raw materials from India at minimal costs and dump British manufactured goods into the Indian market.
- **The Reversal:** India was fundamentally changed from a prosperous exporting nation into a captive importing nation.

Summary of the Three Phases

Phase	Period	Nature of Colonialism
Phase I	1757–1813	Mercantilist Phase (Period of Monopoly & Plunder)
Phase II	1813–1858	Industrial Capitalism Phase (Era of Free Trade)
Phase III	1858–1947	Finance Capitalism Phase (Era of Foreign Investment)

Phase I: Mercantilist Phase (1757–1813)

Key Objectives of the British

- Establish a strict and absolute monopoly over Indian trade.
- Acquire maximum land revenue and expand political influence.
- Purchase goods as cheaply as possible in India and sell them at exorbitant prices in Europe.
- Ruthlessly oust European commercial rivals (Portuguese, Dutch, French).
- **The "Investment":** Use Bengal's own collected land revenue to purchase Indian export goods. Consequently, the British no longer needed to import gold or bullion from England to fund their trade.
- Avoid making any fundamental or costly changes to the Indian administrative structure, traditional judicial laws, or transport networks.

Impact & Consequences

- Drastic and rapid decline of indigenous industries, artisans, and crafts.
- Agriculture was reduced to being the sole source of national wealth.
- Land revenue was essentially plundered and siphoned off to England in the form of export goods and precious metals.
- The systemic plunder of India served as a crucial source of **indirect capital accumulation** for England's impending industrial boom.

📌 Historians' Views on Phase I

- **Percival Spear** (British Historian): Referred to this period as an era of "*open and shameless plunder in Bengal*."
- **K.M. Panikkar** (Indian Historian): Termed the period from 1765 to 1772 as a '**Robber State**' (*Daku Rajya*).

Phase II: Industrial Capitalism Phase (1813–1858)

Background: The Industrial Revolution in Britain

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- Between 1765 and 1785, key inventions (Spinning machine, Steam engine, Power loom, Water frame) triggered the Industrial Revolution in Britain.
- This led to massive surplus production in British factories.
- Britain now had a desperate, dual need: a steady supply of **raw materials** AND a massive, captive **market to dump** their finished goods.

Key Developments & Impact

- Charter Act of 1813:** Abolished the East India Company's trade monopoly in India (except for the trade in tea and trade with China).
- India's doors were thrown open to every British merchant. India officially became a raw material exporter and a finished goods importer.
- Deindustrialization:** Indian handicraft and artisan industries suffered a fatal blow and began rapidly declining from the first half of the 19th century.
- Home Charges:** Imposed heavily after 1813, ensuring that the interest on Indian public debt was drained to England.
- The Indian textile industry collapsed entirely as cheap, machine-made British clothes flooded Indian markets.
- Agrarian Exploitation:** Disastrous land revenue experiments like the Permanent Settlement and Ryotwari Settlement were introduced.
- Commercialization:** Food crops were forcefully replaced by commercial cash crops, leading to severe grain shortages and a sharp rise in food prices.

Important Quotes on Deindustrialization

"Our system acts very much like a sponge, drawing up all the good things from the banks of the Ganges, and squeezing them down on the banks of the Thames."

- **John Sullivan** (British Official)

"The home of cotton was inundated with foreign cottons."

- **Karl Marx**

"The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India."

- **Lord William Bentinck**

'Home Charges'

The 'Drain of Wealth' largely occurred through Home Charges, which consisted of:

- Salaries and pensions of the Secretary of State for India and British civil/military officials.
- Guaranteed dividends paid to East India Company shareholders.
- Interest paid on Indian public debt and capital invested in railways.
- Expenses for imperial wars fought outside India.
- British military purchases.
-

Development of Railways in India

Year	Milestone / Event
1846	Lord Hardinge first proposed the development of railways specifically for 'military transport'.
1849	A contract was signed between the East India Company and EIR for an experimental line from Howrah to Raniganj.

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Year	Milestone / Event
	1854: First Passenger Train in Eastern India: Steamed from Howrah to Hooghly (15th August). The line was extended to Pundooah in September. 1855: The railway line was completed and opened up to Raniganj (February).
1853	Dalhousie Minute: Provided rapid momentum to railway development. Private investors were aggressively attracted with a guaranteed 5% interest .
1853	India's first passenger train ran between Bombay and Thane .
1879	The Eastern Railway became the first line to be purchased by the government (during Lord Lytton's tenure).
1903	Lord Curzon established the Railway Board under the leadership of Thomas Robertson.
1924	The Railway Budget was formally separated from the General Budget (based on the Acworth Committee recommendations of 1921–22).

The Reality of Indian Railways

- The most **rapid and extensive** railway development occurred during **Lord Curzon's** administration.
- **The Real Motive:** To easily export raw materials from the hinterlands, distribute British finished goods internally, and allow for rapid military deployment to crush rebellions.
- By 1869, out of 33 companies involved in railway management, 24 were private foreign entities.

Phase III: Finance Capitalism Phase (1858–1947)**Background**

- This phase was triggered by the Revolt of 1857, rising international competition from other industrialized European nations, and shifts in the global economy.
- It was the logical culmination of the exploitation seen in Phase I and Phase II, though the *form* of exploitation evolved.

Key Features & Strategy

- British foreign investors focused their capital on highly lucrative and secure sectors: **Banks, insurance companies, tea/coffee/rubber plantations, the jute industry, and shipping**.
- They deliberately **AVOIDED** investing in core industries (like cotton textiles and steel) that could potentially compete with British domestic companies.
- Indians were forced to pay heavy interest on public debt, which severely weakened domestic capital formation.
- The overwhelming dominance of foreign capital actively prevented the growth of indigenous industries and modern agriculture.

Consequences

- The Indian economy was completely hollowed out, drowning in the burden of paying massive interest and corporate dividends to Britain.

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- To justify this continued economic stranglehold, Indians were routinely declared unfit for self-governance and political participation.
- The British actively discouraged the development of modern society, culture, and political thought, fearing an organized backlash.
- Ultimately, this undeniable clash between Indian national interests and British colonial exploitation gave birth to the **Indian National Movement**.

LAND REVENUE SYSTEMS UNDER BRITISH RULE**Background & Introduction**

- **The Imperial Need:** To expand and consolidate their empire, the British Company desperately needed immense wealth for purchasing raw materials, paying official salaries, and maintaining control over remote areas.
- **The Solution:** Land Revenue became the primary source of this wealth.
- **1765 (The Beginning):** After acquiring the *Diwani* rights for Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa, the Company appointed Deputy Diwans. Revenue collection was handed to contractors who ruthlessly extracted money from the peasantry.
- **1772 (The Shift):** Warren Hastings abolished the Dual Government and brought revenue collection under the Company's direct administrative supervision.

Ijaredari System (Revenue Farming System) - 1772

- This revenue collection system was used during the Mughal period and later adopted by the British in India.

Feature	Details
Introduced by	Warren Hastings (1772)
Duration	Initially a 5-year settlement; converted to an Annual System in 1776.
Mechanism	The contract for collecting land revenue was auctioned off to the highest bidder .
Role of Zamindars	Intentionally excluded at first. Hastings believed they would conceal the true revenue potential and deprive the government of its share.
Impact	Disastrous. It led to fluctuating revenue collections, completely halted agricultural progress, and resulted in extreme exploitation of farmers by the contractors.

Zamindari / Permanent Settlement / Istimrari System - 1793

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Feature	Details
Introduced by	Lord Cornwallis (Introduced as a 10-year settlement in 1790; made permanent in 1793).
Revenue Split	Government: 10/11th share; Zamindars: 1/11 th share
Zamindar's Power	The government deliberately did not specify a limit on the rent Zamindars could collect from farmers, leading to unchecked extortion.
Sunset Law (1794)	If a Zamindar failed to deposit the revenue into the government treasury by sunset on the due date, their estate was instantly confiscated and auctioned.
Coverage	~19% of British India (Bengal, Bihar, Orissa, Banaras, and Northern Karnataka).

Key Impacts of the Permanent Settlement

- **Rise of Absentee Landlordism (*Doorvasi Zamindari*):** Traditional Zamindars lost lands to urban merchants and moneylenders who had no connection to the village or agriculture.
- **Sub-infeudation (*Up-samantikaran*):** Created a long, parasitic chain of middlemen between the state and the actual cultivator.
- **Creation of Serfs (*Krishak Daas*):** By 1812, legal amendments allowed Zamindars to confiscate a defaulting farmer's land without court permission.
- **Agricultural Stagnation:** Because the state's revenue demand was permanently fixed, the government had zero incentive to invest in agricultural improvements.
- **Political Loyalty:** It successfully created a wealthy class of Zamindars whose existence depended on the British, leading them to actively support the British during the **Revolt of 1857**.

Ryotwari System

Feature	Details
Founders	Thomas Munro and Captain Alexander Reed .
First Trial (1792)	Implemented experimentally by Captain Reed in the Baramahal district (Tamil Nadu).
Expansion (1820)	Officially implemented across the Madras Presidency. Thomas Munro was appointed Governor of Madras (1820–1827) to oversee it.

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Feature	Details
Further Expansion	Expanded to the Bombay Presidency (1825) and eventually the entire Deccan by 1858.
Coverage	The largest area: ~ 51% of British India (Madras, Bombay, Assam, Coorg).
Duration & Rate	Generally a 30-year settlement ; Revenue demand was extremely high, typically fixed at 50% of the gross produce for dry land and 60% for wet (irrigated) land.
Core Mechanism	The settlement was made directly with the registered farmer (Ryot), completely eliminating the Zamindar as a middleman.

Impacts of the Ryotwari System

- **The Supreme Landlord:** It destroyed the traditional concept of collective village ownership, effectively replacing the local Zamindar with the British Government itself as the ultimate landlord.
- **Forced Commercialization:** Farmers were compelled to shift from food crops to cash crops just to meet the exorbitant cash demands of the government.
- **Constant Threat:** Failure to pay the excessively high revenue resulted in immediate eviction from the land.

Mahalwari System

Feature	Details
Founder	Holt Mackenzie (Proposed in his 1819 report; legally implemented in 1822).
Reformation (1833)	Emerged in a significantly revised and better form under Martin Bird and James Thomson.
Coverage	~ 30% of British India (Central Provinces, Ganga Valley, North-Western Provinces [Agra, Awadh], and Punjab).
Mechanism	Land revenue was collected by village headmen (<i>Mukhiya</i>) from farmers, with the entire village treated as a single unit called a "Mahal" for payment.

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Feature	Details
Responsibility	Joint Liability: All landowners within the <i>Mahal</i> were collectively responsible for the payment of the state's revenue.
Outcome	Made the village headman excessively powerful and corrupt; revenue assessment was arbitrary, making the system a miserable failure.

- Despite their different structures, all three land revenue systems had ONE fundamental objective: **The maximum extraction of wealth from the land.**
- The impoverishment of the farmers led directly to the ruin of the villages. This deep agrarian distress was the root cause of the numerous **Peasant and Tribal Revolts** that shook the British Empire.

Note: **Martin Bird** is widely recognized as the 'Father of land revenue settlements in Northern India'.

QUICK REVISION: The Three Major Systems

Feature	Permanent Settlement	Ryotwari System	Mahalwari System
Introduced By	Lord Cornwallis (1793)	Munro & Reed (1820)	Holt Mackenzie (1822)
Coverage Area	~19%	~51% (Largest)	~30%
Key Regions	Bengal, Bihar, Orissa	Madras, Bombay, Assam	NW Provinces, Punjab, Awadh
Settlement Made With	Zamindar	Individual Farmer (Ryot)	Village / Headman (Mahal)
Nature of Assessment	Permanent (Fixed forever)	Revised periodically (~30 yrs)	Revised periodically

COMMERCIALIZATION OF AGRICULTURE

Commercialization of Agriculture is a process wherein farmers are forced or incentivized to cultivate market-based cash crops (such as cotton, tobacco, indigo, jute, and tea) **INSTEAD** of traditional food grain crops.

While classical economics suggests this brings prosperity, under British colonialism, it was strictly designed to enrich Britain, directly leading to severe food shortages and massive, devastating famines in India.

Factors Promoting Commercialization

The shift from food crops to cash crops was largely involuntary. The key drivers were:

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- **Exorbitant Land Revenue Demand:** The British fixed land revenue at impossibly high rates. Farmers could not generate enough cash by selling food crops alone, forcing them to shift to lucrative cash crops just to pay their taxes and avoid eviction.
- **The Industrial Revolution in Britain:** Rapid industrialization created a massive, insatiable demand for raw materials. Indian agriculture was ruthlessly exploited to fuel British factories.
- **Selective Colonial Promotion:** The colonial government did not promote all cash crops-only those specifically needed by the British Empire:
 - **Indigo:** Promoted aggressively to end British reliance on Caribbean imports.
 - **Opium:** Cultivated specifically to be smuggled and exported to China to balance British trade deficits.
 - **Mulberry Silk:** Heavily promoted in Bengal to reduce British dependence on Italian silk imports.
- **Profit Motive:** A minor factor where some wealthy farmers voluntarily shifted to cash crops hoping to earn higher profits in the international market.

Impact of Commercialization

The commercialization of agriculture was an absolute disaster for the Indian agrarian economy:

- **A Forced Process:** It was largely forced upon Indian farmers through oppressive contracts (like the Tinkathia system) and high taxation, rather than voluntary market participation.
- **Famines & Starvation:** The massive shift away from food grain production directly caused severe, recurring famines and widespread starvation across the subcontinent.
- **Middleman Exploitation:** Farmers became mere puppets. During economic booms, middlemen and merchants pocketed all the profits. During economic recessions, the farmers were left to bear the entire brunt of the losses.
- **Rural Debt Trap:** It drastically increased rural indebtedness, as farmers frequently had to take loans from moneylenders to survive or pay taxes when cash crops failed.
- **Agrarian Revolts:** The sheer misery and exploitation triggered massive agrarian riots, most notably the **Deccan Riots**.
- **Zero Agrarian Benefit:** Ultimately, Indian agriculture derived absolutely NO developmental or technological benefit from this commercialization.

The Rapid Decline of Indigo

Year	Indian Indigo Export Volume	Key Event / Reason
1895–1896	~9,300 tons	Peak of the colonial indigo trade.
1910–1911	Plummeted to just 846 tons	The German Invention of Synthetic Dye.

REASON: In the late 19th century, Germany successfully invented a **synthetic (artificial) dye**. This artificial dye was significantly cheaper and easier to produce, which virtually wiped out the European demand for natural Indian indigo overnight, leaving Indian planters and farmers ruined.

DEINDUSTRIALIZATION

- **Deindustrialization** refers to the systematic decline and ruin of India's pre-existing, traditional indigenous industries (especially the textile sector) under British colonial rule.
- Prior to the arrival of the British, India possessed a highly prosperous and globally renowned abundance of cottage and handicraft industries.

Primary Causes of Deindustrialization The destruction of Indian industries was not accidental; it was a result of deliberate colonial policies:

- **The Gomastha System (Post-Plassey & Buxar):** The British East India Company established brutal control over Bengal's artisans through appointed agents called **Gomastha**. They interfered in the entire production process, forcing artisans to work under oppressive conditions and sell at dictated, low prices.
- **The Charter Act of 1813:** This act abolished the Company's trade monopoly, throwing open the Indian market. Consequently, India was flooded with cheap, machine-made British goods that local artisans could not compete with.
- **Discriminatory Tariffs:** The British imposed excessive export duties on Indian manufactured goods, effectively shutting the doors of the British market for Indian products, while British goods entered India duty-free.
- **The Role of Railways:** Railways acted as a double-edged sword against Indian industries. They facilitated the rapid extraction and transport of raw materials to ports, while simultaneously enabling cheap British finished goods to penetrate and capture the remotest rural markets of India.

Key Impacts & Consequences

- **Total Devastation:** Both the rural handicraft sector (traditionally organized under the **Jajmani System**) and the relatively advanced urban handicraft sector were completely devastated.
- **Overburdening of Agriculture (De-urbanization):** Ruined artisans and craftsmen had no alternative but to migrate back to their villages and take up agricultural labor. This drastically overburdened the agrarian economy and severely disrupted the socio-economic structure.
- **Ruin of the Jute Industry:** Bengal's thriving indigenous jute weaving industry was destroyed after 1835, as it simply could not compete with British mechanized mass production.
- **The Resilience of Handlooms:** Despite all these adversities and exploitative policies, the Indian handloom industry miraculously survived. It later drew immense renewed strength and patronage from the **National Movement**, specifically the **Swadeshi Movement**.

ESTABLISHMENT OF MODERN INDUSTRIES

- **The Rise of Modern Industry:** During the late 19th and early 20th centuries, modern industries began to take root in India, primarily driven by British **Financial Capitalism**.
- **Foreign Monopoly:** Foreign capital heavily dominated almost all profitable sectors (e.g., before the 20th century, over 90% of banking capital was foreign). Indian capitalists were systematically sidelined and could only enter sectors where there was no direct British competition.
- **The Cotton Exception:** The **Cotton Textile industry** was the *only* major industrial sector where Indian capital investment actually exceeded foreign capital.

Key Industrial Timeline

Year	Milestone / Event	Key Details & Personalities
1830	Establishment of the Porto Novo Iron Works (the first attempt at modern iron production). It ultimately failed and was closed in 1860.	Set up by Josiah Marshall Heath in South Arcot (Madras Presidency).

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Year	Milestone / Event	Key Details & Personalities
1833	Plantation Investment Shift	Following the 1833 Act (which ended the EIC's China trade monopoly), British investment aggressively shifted toward indigo, tea, and coffee plantations.
1835	First Tea Garden	Established in India. By 1838, Indian-grown tea was successfully sold in London.
1839	Assam Tea Company	Formally established, marking the first organized corporate entry into plantations.
1854	First Cotton Textile Mill	Established by Cowasjee Nanabhoy Davar in Bombay ('Bombay Spinning and Weaving Company'). <i>This is regarded as the first successful factory established by an Indian.</i>
1854	First Coalfield	Discovered in Raniganj (Bengal).
1855	First Jute Mill	Established by George Acland in Rishra, Bengal.
1874	Bengal Iron Works	Established as the first modern iron and steel company in India.
1896	INC Calcutta Session	Formal lectures were given on the <i>Drain of Wealth</i> , making economic critique a central pillar of the Congress's political agenda.
1907	TISCO Established	Tata Iron & Steel -the first steel factory in the private sector. The British supported it due to the strategic needs of the impending World War I.
1916	Indian Industrial Commission (also known as the Holland Commission)	Led by Thomas Holland ; officially recommended protection for Indian industries (again, driven by WWI necessities).
1921	Fiscal Commission	Chaired by Ibrahim Rahimtoola ; formally demanded the protection of Indian industries.

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Year	Milestone / Event	Key Details & Personalities
1927	FICCI Established	Provided a massive structural and organizational base for Indian industrialists and the Swadeshi movement.
1944	Bombay Plan	A sweeping economic development proposal drafted by top industrialists: Purshottamdas Thakurdas, J.R.D. Tata, G.D. Birla, and Ardeshir Dalal.

IMPORTANT PERSONS & THEIR CONTRIBUTIONS

Historical Figure	Associated Concept / Key Contribution
Dadabhai Naoroji	Propounded the ' Drain of Wealth ' Theory; Author of " <i>Poverty and Un-British Rule in India</i> "; Called the drain the ' Evil of all evils '.
R.C. Dutt	Author of " <i>The Economic History of India</i> " (the first book on India's economic history); Surprisingly supported the Permanent Settlement.
Percival Spear	British historian who termed Phase I of colonialism in Bengal as an era of " <i>open and shameless plunder</i> ".
K.M. Panikkar	Indian historian who famously termed the period of 1765–1772 as the ' Robber State ' (<i>Daku Rajya</i>).
Thomas Munro	Co-founder (with Captain Reed) and implementer of the Ryotwari System .
Holt Mackenzie	The original architect/father of the Mahalwari System .
Martin Bird	Known as the ' Father of land revenue settlements in Northern India '; heavily reformed the Mahalwari system in 1833.
Lord Cornwallis	Architect of the Permanent Settlement (1793) and the Sunset Law.
Warren Hastings	Introduced the Ijaredari System (1772); Abolished the Dual Government in Bengal.

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Historical Figure	Associated Concept / Key Contribution
Lord Dalhousie	Penning the ' Dalhousie Minute ' (1853) that kick-started rapid railway development and the Doctrine of Lapse.
Thomas Holland	Headed the Industrial Commission (1916).
Ibrahim Rahimtoola	Chaired the Fiscal Commission (1921).
Gopal Krishna Gokhale	Officially presented the 'Drain of Wealth' theory in the Imperial Legislative Council (1901).

IMPORTANT YEARS - AT A GLANCE

Year	Landmark Event
1757	Battle of Plassey: Marks the beginning of British dominance and Phase I (Mercantilist) colonialism.
1764	Battle of Buxar: Decisive British victory securing their hold over Northern India.
1765	Treaty of Allahabad: British acquire the <i>Diwani</i> rights (Bengal, Bihar, Orissa).
1772	Warren Hastings abolishes Dual Government; Introduces the Ijaredari System .
1790	Cornwallis introduces the 10-year settlement (precursor to Permanent Settlement).
1793	Permanent Settlement officially implemented.
1794	Implementation of the strict Sunset Law .
1813	Charter Act: Ends Company monopoly; Marks the start of Phase II (Industrial Capitalism).

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Year	Landmark Event
1820	Ryotwari System expanded across the Madras Presidency under Munro.
1822	Mahalwari System legally implemented (Mackenzie).
1853	India's first passenger train runs (Bombay–Thane); Dalhousie Minute issued.
1867	Dadabhai Naoroji presents " <i>England's Debt to India</i> " in London (May 2).
1879	Eastern Railway purchased by the Government (under Lord Lytton).
1896	INC Calcutta Session: Formally adopts the Drain of Wealth theory.
1924	Railway Budget separated from the General Budget.
1947	K.C. Neogy Committee formed to review railway finance.

THE REVOLT OF 1857**The Revolt at a Glance**

Aspect	Details
Start Date & Location	May 10, 1857 - Meerut
First Incident	March 29, 1857 - Mangal Pandey mutinies at Barrackpore
First Martyr	Mangal Pandey (Hanged on April 8, 1857)
Symbolic Leader	Bahadur Shah Zafar
Immediate Cause	Greased Cartridges of the new Enfield Rifle (cow + pig fat)
Nature of Revolt	Started as a Sepoy Mutiny → Evolved into a Mass Uprising
Governor-General (During the Revolt)	Lord Canning
End of Company Rule	November 1, 1858 (Via Queen Victoria's Proclamation)

Causes of the Revolt of 1857**A. Political Causes**

- **Subsidiary Alliance (Lord Wellesley):** Forced Indian kings to station the Company's army within their states, completely eroding the independence of Indian monarchs.
- **Doctrine of Lapse (Lord Dalhousie):** Annexation policy where states without a natural heir were taken over by the British.
- **Stoppage of Peshwa's Pension:** The British stopped the pension of **Nana Saheb** (the adopted son of Peshwa Baji Rao II), making him a fierce enemy of the British.
- **Annexation of Awadh (1856):** Awadh was annexed on the grounds of **misgovernance** (maladministration) because Dalhousie could not apply the Doctrine of Lapse, as the Nawab (Wajid Ali Shah) had natural heirs.

Chronological Order of States Annexed by Lord Dalhousie

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Year	State Annexed	Basis of Annexation
1848	Satara	Doctrine of Lapse (<i>First Victim</i>)
1849	Jaitpur & Sambalpur	Doctrine of Lapse
1850	Baghat	Doctrine of Lapse
1852	Udaipur	Doctrine of Lapse
1853	Jhansi	Doctrine of Lapse
1854	Nagpur	Doctrine of Lapse
1855	Karauli	<i>Doctrine of Lapse (Returned as Board of Control refused to recognize it)</i>
1856	Awadh	Misgovernance (<i>Nawab had heirs</i>)

B. Administrative Causes

- **Exclusion from High Posts:** Indians were systematically excluded from administrative services and considered unfit for higher civil roles.
- **Biased Judicial System:** The British justice system was prolonged, expensive, and deeply racist. Indian judges were not allowed to hear cases against Englishmen.
- **Abolition of Titles:** Dalhousie confiscated the royal titles of the Nawabs of Tanjore and the Carnatic.
- **Religious Bias:** Religion replaced merit in administrative affairs, openly facilitating Christian proselytization.
- **Administrative Failure:** Frequent, devastating famines since the late 18th century thoroughly exposed the deep flaws and apathy of the British administrative machinery.

C. Social & Religious Causes

- **Religious Disabilities Act / Lex Loci Act (1850):** This act allowed converts to Christianity to inherit their ancestral property, creating deep insecurity and anger within orthodox Hindu society.
- **Christian Missionaries:** The **Charter Act of 1813** officially permitted Christian missionary activities. Vulnerable groups (unemployed, widows, tribals, orphans) became primary targets for conversion.

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- **Hindu Widow Remarriage Act (1856):** Drafted under Dalhousie and passed under Canning. Following earlier reforms (abolition of Sati, bans on human sacrifice), orthodox sections viewed this as the final, intolerable interference in their religion.
- **Western Education:** The aggressive introduction of Western education undermined the foundations of traditional Indian society, leading supporters of traditional education to rebel.

D. Economic Causes

- **Ruthless Agrarian Exploitation:** Oppressive land revenue policies like the Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari, and Mahalwari systems crushed the peasantry.
- **Deindustrialization:** British trade policies actively destroyed Indian cottage industries, reducing once-prosperous artisans, weavers, and farmers to absolute misery.
- **Famines:** The forced commercialization of agriculture caused severe food shortages, triggering mass starvation.
- **Profit Over People:** The East India Company kept maximum economic profit at the core of all its policies, showing zero concern for Indian welfare.

E. Military Causes

- **Skewed Ratio:** The ratio of Indian sepoys to British soldiers was highly disproportionate, at approximately **5:1**.
- **Racial Discrimination:** No matter how capable, an Indian soldier could not rise above the rank of **Subedar** and received significantly lower pay than European counterparts.
- **General Service Enlistment Act (1856):** Passed by Lord Canning, it mandated that new recruits must be ready to serve anywhere, including overseas. Crossing the sea violated the socio-religious beliefs of high-caste Hindus at the time.
- **Post Office Act (1854):** This act abruptly withdrew the long-standing privilege of free postage for sepoys, which felt like a direct infringement on their financial rights.

The Immediate Cause: The Greased Cartridges

- **The Upgrade:** In December 1856, the government decided to replace the old iron '**Brown Bess**' musket with the new '**Enfield Rifle**'.
- **The Spark:** The top of the new cartridge had to be bitten off with teeth before loading into the rifle. A rumor quickly spread that the grease used on the cartridge casings was made of **cow fat and pig fat**.
- **Religious Outrage:** This deeply offended BOTH Hindu soldiers (to whom the cow is sacred) and Muslim soldiers (to whom the pig is strictly forbidden/haram).
- **The Reality:** British officials initially dismissed the rumor, but it was later **PROVED** that fat from cows and pigs was indeed used at the Royal Laboratory at Woolwich Arsenal where the cartridges were manufactured.
- **The Breaking Point:** The sepoys became absolutely convinced that this was a deliberate, malicious plot by the British government to corrupt their religion and forcibly convert them to Christianity.

Beginning & Spread of the Revolt

Date	Event	Location / Details
March 29, 1857	Mangal Pandey (34th Native Infantry) refused the greased cartridges and shot his officers, Lt. Baugh & Sergeant Major Hewson.	Barrackpore (Commanding Officer: General Hearsey)

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Date	Event	Location / Details
April 8, 1857	Mangal Pandey was hanged, becoming the First Martyr of the 1857 revolt.	Barrackpore
May 10, 1857	Indian sepoy's officially refused the cartridges, fired on their officers, freed comrades, and the GREAT REVOLT BEGAN . Key Regiments Involved: The 3rd Bengal Light Cavalry (who initiated the breakout), joined by the 11th and 20th Native Infantry .	Meerut (Commanding Officer: General Hewitt)
May 11, 1857	The rebellious Meerut sepoy's reached Delhi.	Delhi
May 12, 1857	Sepoy's captured the city and proclaimed Bahadur Shah Zafar as the Emperor of India.	Delhi

- **Leadership in Delhi:** While Bahadur Shah II was the *symbolic* leader of the revolt, the actual military power and real command lay with **General Bakht Khan**.

◆ Delhi

- **Rebel Leader:** Bahadur Shah II (Zafar) (*Symbolic*) | General Bakht Khan (*Real Commander*).
- **Recapture:** The British recaptured Delhi in September 1857.
- **British Officers Deployed:** **John Nicholson** (killed during the fighting), William Hodson, and John Lawrence.
- **Arrest & Exile:** Bahadur Shah II was arrested at Humayun's Tomb (his location was revealed by his own wife, Zeenat Mahal). He was exiled to **Rangoon** (Myanmar), where he died in 1862.

◆ Lucknow

- **Revolt Began:** June 1857.
- **Leader:** **Begum Hazrat Mahal** (also known as *Mahak Pari*). She declared her minor son, **Birjis Qadir**, as the Nawab and established her own parallel administration.
- **British Casualties:** Chief Commissioner **Henry Lawrence** was killed while defending the British Residency. **Tatya Tope** defeated the British near 'Chinhat'; Havelock and Brigadier-General Neill were also killed during the Lucknow campaign.
- **Suppression & Escape:** Suppressed in March 1858 by **Colin Campbell**. Begum Hazrat Mahal successfully escaped to Nepal.

◆ Kanpur

- **Revolt Began:** June 5, 1857.
- **Leader:** **Nana Saheb (Dhondu Pant)**, the adopted son of Peshwa Baji Rao II. He declared himself the 'Peshwa of the Emperor'.
- **Key Aide:** **Tatya Tope** (Real name: **Ramchandra Pandurang**).
- **Sati Chaura Ghat Incident:** Nana Saheb gave an assurance of safe passage to the British, but they were ambushed and killed at the ghat.
- **Suppression & Escape:** **Colin Campbell** recaptured Kanpur in December 1857. Nana Saheb successfully escaped to Nepal.

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◆ Jhansi & Gwalior

- **Revolt Began:** June 1857.
- **Leader:** Rani Lakshmibai (Original Name: **Manikarnika Tambe / Manu**; Born in Varanasi, Martyred in Gwalior).
- **Course of Action:** Defeated by **General Hugh Rose's** army in Jhansi, she retreated to Gwalior, where Tatya Tope joined her. She fought fiercely in military attire and attained martyrdom near the Gwalior fort walls.
- **Tatya Tope's Guerrilla War:** He received immense support from the Gwalior army despite the local ruler Scindia's refusal. He troubled the British the most using guerrilla tactics.
- **Betrayal & Death:** He was betrayed by his treacherous friend **Man Singh**, arrested, and hanged in **Shivpuri (MP) on April 18, 1859**.

◆ Bihar (Jagdishpur)

- **Leader:** Kunwar Singh, the veteran Zamindar of Jagdishpur.
- **Succession:** After his death, his brother **Amar Singh** took over the leadership.
- **Suppressed By:** Major **William Taylor** and **Vincent Eyre**.

◆ Other Prominent Centres

Centre	Leader(s)	Suppressor / Key Notes
Faizabad (Ayodhya)	Maulvi Ahmadullah	Suppressed by Colin Campbell. Ahmadullah issued a <i>Fatwa</i> against the British, gave the slogan of Jihad, and had a ₹50,000 bounty on his head. He originally belonged to Madras.
Allahabad (Prayagraj)	Maulvi Liaquat Ali	Suppressed by Brigadier-General Neill. Lord Canning made Allahabad his emergency HQ during the revolt.
Banaras	General public uprising	Suppressed by Brigadier-General Neill, who ruthlessly executed even women and children.
Bareilly	Khan Bahadur Khan	Suppressed by Colin Campbell. Khan Bahadur Khan (who declared himself Nawab) was sentenced to death.
Rajasthan (Kota)	Jaidayal & Hardayal	Kota was the primary epicentre of anti-British activity in Rajasthan.
Assam	Maniram Dewan	Declared Kandarpeshwar Singha as ruler. Maniram was captured and hanged in Calcutta.
Sambalpur (Odisha)	Prince Surendra Sai	Surrendered in 1862 and was exiled from the country.

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Centre	Leader(s)	Suppressor / Key Notes
Ganjam (Odisha)	Radhakrishna Dandasena	
Kashmir	Gulab Singh	

The Revolt at a Glance

Centre	Rebel Leader(s)	British Suppressor(s)
Delhi	Bahadur Shah Zafar, Bakht Khan	John Nicholson, William Hodson, John Lawrence
Lucknow	Begum Hazrat Mahal	Henry Lawrence, Colin Campbell
Kanpur	Nana Saheb, Tatya Tope	Colin Campbell
Jhansi & Gwalior	Rani Lakshmibai, Tatya Tope	General Hugh Rose
Jagdishpur (Bihar)	Kunwar Singh, Amar Singh	Major William Taylor, Vincent Eyre
Faizabad	Maulvi Ahmadullah	Colin Campbell
Allahabad & Banaras	Maulvi Liaquat Ali	Brigadier-General Neill
Bareilly	Khan Bahadur Khan	Colin Campbell

Failure, Significance & Consequences

Causes of the Failure of the Revolt

- **Lack of Broad Support:** Powerful elements of Indian society-such as major Zamindars, native rulers, and the newly educated middle class-did NOT support the revolt.
- **Weak Organizational Base:** The rebels lacked a strong, unified structure. Even when prominent leaders converged, they failed to execute a solid, collective military plan.

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- **Limited Military Participation:** While the Bengal Army rebelled, the soldiers from Punjab, the Gurkhas, and the Madras Army remained loyal and actively suppressed the mutiny on behalf of the British.
- **No Central Leadership:** There was no single, capable leader who could coordinate the revolt across all the scattered centres.
- **Internal Factionalism:** Constant infighting and uncoordinated strategies among the rebel leaders weakened their front.
- **Technological Disadvantage:** The rebels faced a severe shortage of modern weapons and communication networks (telegraphs) compared to the well-equipped British forces.

Consequences & Impact of the Revolt**End of Company Rule - Queen Victoria's Proclamation**

- On **November 1, 1858**, Lord Canning read Queen Victoria's Proclamation at a grand Durbar held in **Allahabad**.
- The East India Company was stripped of all rights to govern India. Consequently, India came under the direct rule of the **British Crown**.
- The **Annexation Policy (Doctrine of Lapse)** was officially abandoned, and the right to adopt an heir was legally restored to native monarchs.

Government of India Act 1858 - Key Provisions

Provision	Details
New Post Created	Secretary of State for India (<i>Bharat Rajya Sachiv</i>).
India Council	A 15-member advisory body was formed (8 appointed by the Crown + 7 by the Court of Directors).
Accountability	The Secretary of State was a member of the British Cabinet and was directly responsible to the British Parliament.
Viceroy Created	The title of 'Governor-General of India' was changed to ' Viceroy ' (representing the Crown directly).
First Viceroy	Lord Canning became the first Viceroy of India.
Policy Shifts	Halted British territorial expansion; promised non-interference in religious matters; guaranteed equal legal protection; and pledged respect for ancient rights and customs.
Military Reorganization	Artillery was handed over entirely to European troops. The Indian Army was restructured along caste and regional lines (based on the Peel Commission recommendations).

- **Peel Commission (1858):** Constituted *AFTER* the suppression of the revolt to reorganize the Indian Army. It recommended dividing army regiments strictly along caste, community, and religious lines to prevent any future unity among Indian soldiers.

Historians' Views on the Nature of the Revolt

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Historian / Thinker	View / Statement on the 1857 Revolt
V.D. Savarkar	<i>The Revolt of 1857 was the First War of Independence</i>
R.C. Majumdar	<i>The so-called First National War of Independence is neither 'First', nor 'National', nor 'a War of Independence'.</i>
Sir John Seeley	<i>"wholly unpatriotic and selfish sepoy mutiny with no native leadership and no popular support."</i>
John Lawrence	<i>"Nothing more than a sepoy mutiny."</i>
T.R. Holmes	<i>"A conflict between civilization and barbarism."</i>
L.E.R. Rees	<i>'a war of fanatic religionists against Christians'.</i>
James Outram & W. Taylor	<i>"A Hindu-Muslim conspiracy against the British."</i>

Important Books on the Revolt of 1857

Book Title	Author
<i>The Indian War of Independence 1857</i>	V.D. Savarkar
<i>The Sepoy Mutiny and the Revolt of 1857</i>	R.C. Majumdar
<i>The First Indian War of Independence 1857–59</i>	Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels
<i>The Causes of the Indian Revolt (Asbab-e-Baghawat-e-Hind)</i>	Sir Syed Ahmad Khan
<i>The Sepoy Mutiny of 1857: A Social Analysis</i>	H.P. Chattopadhyay

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Book Title	Author
<i>Eighteen Fifty-Seven (1857)</i>	<i>S.N. Sen (Official Historian)</i>

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MAJOR INDIAN REVOLTS

Before the grand spectacle of the 1857 Revolt, the foundations of British rule were continuously shaken by localized, fierce uprisings.

Root Causes of Rebellions

Peasant Revolt Causes	Tribal Revolt Causes
• Extortionate Revenue: Impossibly high land tax demands under new colonial settlements (Permanent, Ryotwari, Mahalwari). • New Landlords: The creation of an absentee Zamindar class that had no traditional ties to the cultivators. • Economic Ruin: The destruction of indigenous handicrafts and the forced commercialization of agriculture, which pushed artisans back to the land and caused widespread famine.	• Loss of Autonomy: The imposition of British forest laws that suddenly declared traditional tribal lands as 'State Property'. • The 'Diku' Invasion: The unchecked influx of outsiders-moneylenders, contractors, and corrupt police-into tribal sanctuaries. • Cultural Assault: The aggressive proselytization by Christian missionaries and the banning of ancient tribal customs (like the Khond <i>Meriah</i> sacrifice).

MAJOR CIVIL REBELLIONS

Civil Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Sanyasi Revolt Region: Bengal (Dhaka, Rangpur) Leaders: Bhavani Pathak, Devi Chaudhurani	1763–1820	• Cause: Economic exploitation, the devastating Bengal Famine (1770), and British restrictions on Hindu and Muslim pilgrims. • 1773: The rebels grew so powerful they established a parallel government. • Literary Link: Bankim Chandra Chatterjee's famous novel <i>Anandamath</i> is based on this revolt (which gave India the national song, <i>Vande Mataram</i>). • Suppressed by: Governor-General Warren Hastings.
Fakir Uprising Region: Bengal Leaders: Majnu Shah → Musa Shah, Chirag Ali Shah	1776–1777	• Nature: A religious uprising initiated by a group of wandering Muslim Fakirs. They specifically targeted English factories and military convoys. • Cross-Religious Unity: Hindu leaders Bhavani Pathak and Devi Chaudhurani (from the Sanyasi revolt) actively supported this uprising. • Received broad support from Rajputs, Pathans, and former army soldiers. • Suppressed by British forces in the early 19th century.
Paika Rebellion Region: Odisha (Khurda District) Leader: Bakshi Jagabandhu Bidyadhar (<i>Military Commander of the King of Khurda</i>)	1817–1825	• Cause: Loss of land rights, heavy taxes, and economic hardship under British rule. • The Paikas were a traditional militia community in Odisha. Before 1568, they primarily engaged in farming during peace and served as mercenaries in wartime, defending their territories and the king. For their military services, they were granted rent-free land by the rulers of Khurda. • Completely suppressed by the British by 1825.

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Civil Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
		• Current Context: In July 2017, the Government of India celebrated its bicentenary (200th anniversary). • Demand: There is a strong movement to officially recognize it as the 'First War of Independence', as it pre-dates 1857.
Ahom Revolt Region: Assam (Northern Assam) Leaders: <i>Phase I:</i> Gomdhar Konwar <i>Phase II:</i> Kumar Rupchand	1828–1833	• Background: Following the First Anglo-Burmese War (1824–26), the British occupied Northern Assam, prompting the heirs of the Ahom dynasty to revolt. • Phase I (1828–30): Gomdhar Konwar was arrested, and the initial revolt was crushed. • Phase II (1830): Kumar Rupchand planned a much larger rebellion. • Diplomatic Resolution: Sensing danger, the British pacified the region by handing Upper Assam to Maharaja Purandar Singh in 1833. <i>This is a rare instance of a revolt resolved through diplomatic concession rather than pure military suppression.</i>
Faraizi Movement Region: Bengal Leaders: Haji Shariatullah <i>(Founder)</i> → Dadu Mian / Mohammad Mohsin <i>(Son)</i>	1838–1857	• Nature: A profound social, religious, and political reform movement. • Political Aim: To completely expel the British from Bengal and protect peasants from the growing atrocities of the Zamindars. • Outcome: Active until the outbreak of the 1857 revolt, the followers eventually merged into the larger Wahabi Movement.
Kuka Movement Region: Punjab (Western Punjab) Leaders: Bhagat Jawahar Mal (Sian Sahib), Balak Singh → Ram Singh Kuka	1840–1872	• Evolution: Started as a religious reform movement to eradicate social evils in Sikhism, but transformed into a militant anti-British political movement following the British annexation of Punjab. • 1869: First political revolt occurred at Ferozpur under Ram Singh Kuka. • 1872: Ram Singh was arrested and exiled to Rangoon (Myanmar), where he died in 1885. • Precursor to Gandhian Methods: The Kukas wore hand-spun clothes (Khadi), strictly boycotted British goods, and abandoned English schools-laying the groundwork for Non-Cooperation and Civil Disobedience. • Namdhari Sect: Founded on April 12, 1857, by Ram Singh to promote the prohibition of alcohol/beef, tree worship, and women's equality.
Gadkari Revolt Region: Maharashtra (Kolhapur State) Leader: Daji Krishna Pandit	1844	• Background: The Gadkaris were a hereditary martial class who served as garrison guards for Maratha forts. • Cause: Administrative reorganization by the British leading to massive unemployment among the guards. • Key Event: The fierce rebels successfully captured the forts of Samangarh and Bhudargarh. • The British had to struggle significantly to suppress this highly organized military rebellion.

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Civil Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Kittur Revolt Region: Karnataka (Kittur) Leaders: Rani Chennamma → Rayanna (<i>Guerrilla Warfare</i>)	1824–1829	• Cause: The British refused to recognize Rani Chennamma's adopted son, Shivalingappa, as the legitimate heir. • The Struggle: Rani Chennamma was imprisoned in late 1824 and died in captivity in February 1829. • Continuation: Her loyal guard, Rayanna, continued a fierce guerrilla war until he was captured and hanged in 1830. • This is widely recognized as the first armed revolt by a woman against the British in South India.
Minor Civil Rebellions	1806–1819	• Vellore Mutiny (1806, Tamil Nadu): A massive, violent Sepoy mutiny that occurred half a century before 1857. • Kutch Rebellion (1819, Gujarat): Sparked by unwarranted British interference in the princely state's internal affairs. • Velu Thampi's Revolt (1808–09, Kerala): The Dewan of Travancore revolted against the oppressive Subsidiary Alliance forced upon the Maharaja. • Waghera rising (1818–20, Gujarat): A combined anti-British and anti-Gaekwad uprising in Baroda. A peace treaty was concluded in November 1820.

MAJOR TRIBAL UPRISINGS

Tribal Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Chuar Uprising Region: The region between Chota Nagpur and the plains of Bengal. Leaders: Durjan Singh	1768	• Reasons: By 1798, the tribals rebelled, took to arms, and adopted the guerrilla tactics of war when they realised that the British had taken away their land.
Khond & Savara Uprising Region: Odisha–Bengal–Central India Leaders:	1837–1856	• Causes: Imposition of new taxes, entry of Zamindars, and the strict British ban on the traditional Khond practice of 'Meriah' (human sacrifice). • Dandasena was captured and hanged in 1857, officially ending the uprising.

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Tribal Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
<i>Khond:</i> Chakra Bisoi <i>Savara:</i> Radhakrishna Dandasena		
Khasi Uprising Region: Meghalaya Leader: Tirath Singh (<i>Khasi Chief</i>)	1827–1833	• Cause: The British planned to construct a strategic military road directly through Khasi territory to link Assam and Sylhet. • Suppressed militarily in 1833.
Kol Uprising Region: Jharkhand (Chotanagpur) Leaders: Buddhu Bhagat	1831–1832	• Identity: The 'Kols' collectively referred to the Munda, Oraon, Ho, and Mahli tribes. • Cause: Traditional tribal lands were being handed over to 'Dikus' (outsider contractors/farmers). • The revolt involved heavy guerrilla warfare and continued intermittently until 1848.
Ramosi Uprising Region: Maharashtra (Western Ghats) Leaders: Chittur Singh (1822) → Umaji (1825) → N.D. Petkar (1839)	1822–1841	• Evolution: Occurred in three distinct phases over two decades. • 1839 Phase: Triggered politically by the British deposition of the Raja of Satara. • Key Event: The rebels successfully captured the Badami fort before being suppressed.
Santhal Rebellion (Hul) Region: Damin-i-Koh (Bhagalpur to Rajmahal) Leaders: Sidhu and Kanhu (<i>Brothers</i>)	1855–1856	• Impact: The revolt was so ferocious that Company rule was temporarily eradicated in the entire region. • Administrative Reform: Forced the British to formally create the Santhal Pargana District (Nov 1856). • Ashley Eden was appointed as its first District Magistrate. • Protective Law: The Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act was passed to strictly prevent the transfer of tribal lands to non-tribals.
Munda Rebellion (Ulgulan)	1899–1900	• Cause: The Zamindars and British were destroying the Mundas' traditional Khuntkatti (joint farming/land ownership) system.

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Tribal Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Region: Jharkhand (Chotanagpur) Leader: Birsa Munda		• Results: The government legally recognized <i>Khuntkatti</i> rights and strictly banned Beth Begari (forced, unpaid labor).
Tana Bhagat Movement Region: Jharkhand (Chotanagpur) Leader: Jatra Oraon	1914	• Evolution: Started among the Oraon tribes to protest high rents and the <i>Chowkidari</i> tax. • Nationalist Shift: Following Jatra Oraon's death, the movement took a unique turn-it fully embraced Gandhian nationalism, non-violence, and the Swadeshi movement. • Post-Independence: Acknowledging their sacrifices, the Indian government passed the Tana Bhagat Raiyat Agricultural Land Restoration Act, 1947.
Kuki Uprising Region: Manipur & NE States	1917–1919	• Cause: against British policies of recruiting labour during the first World War. • Spread rapidly across a massive region including Manipur, Nagaland, Mizoram, and the Chin Hills (Myanmar).
Rampa Rebellion Region: Andhra Pradesh (Godavari) Leader: Alluri Sitarama Raju	1922–1924	• Reasons: Forced labor, embargoes on forest produce, and restrictions on tribal agriculture led to widespread distress. • Developments: In 1922, Raju and 500 tribals attacked police stations, stealing rifles and ammunition, gaining attention for their guerrilla tactics. • British Response: British forces struggled to contain the uprising, capturing and executing Raju in 1924, leading to violent repression and the arrest of many activists. • Modern Legacy: On April 4, 2022, the Andhra Pradesh government honored his legacy by carving out a new district named the "Alluri Sitharama Raju District" (from Visakhapatnam and East Godavari).
Manipur / Naga Uprising Region: Manipur Leaders: Rongmei Jadonang → Rani Gaidinliu	1930s	• National Integration: After Jadonang was hanged in 1931, a 16-year-old Naga girl, Gaidinliu, took over. She brilliantly linked her localized tribal movement with Gandhiji's nationwide Civil Disobedience Movement. • She spent over a decade in prison and was released only after India's independence. • Honors: Jawaharlal Nehru honored her with the prestigious title of 'Rani'. • Legacy: Based on Jadonang's ideas, she founded the Heraka cult.

Birsa Munda

- **Birth:** 15th November 1875 in Ulihatu (Khunti, Jharkhand).
- **Tribe:** Munda (Chotanagpur Plateau).
- **Popular Titles:** *Dharti Aaba* (Father of the Earth), Bhagwan.

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- **Early Name:** Daud Munda.
- **Guru:** Anand Panre (Influenced him towards Vaishnavism).

Spiritual & Social Reforms

- Founded the **Birsait sect**.
- Preached monotheism, urging the worship of **Singhbonga** (tribal deity).
- Campaigned strictly against alcoholism, superstitions, and **beth begari** (forced labour).

The Ulgulan (Great Rebellion) - 1895

- **Core Cause:** British land policies destroying the traditional **Khuntkatti system** (communal land ownership) and extreme exploitation by Zamindars and *thikadars* (middlemen).
- **Famous Slogan:** “*Abua raj ete jana, maharani raj tundu jana*” (Let the queen’s rule end, and our rule begin).
- **Key Timeline:**
 - **1895:** Revolt begins; Birsa arrested for rioting.
 - **1897:** Released; resumes mobilizing villages for a tribal-led kingdom.
 - **1900:** Died of Cholera, marking the end of the active revolt.

NOTE: 15th November is celebrated annually as **Janjatiya Gaurav Divas** (Tribal Pride Day) since 2021.

MAJOR PEASANT UPRISINGS

Peasant Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Pagal Panthi Revolt Region: North Bengal Leader: Tipu Shah (<i>Son of Pagal Panthi sect founder Karam Shah</i>)	1825	• Cause: Oppressive taxes, zamindari exploitation, and British policies • Major Event: Tipu Shah captured Sherpur in 1825 • Course: Armed resistance continued for ~2 decades; Tipu Shah died in 1852 but movement persisted
Indigo Revolt Region: Bengal Leaders: Digambar Biswas & Bishnu Biswas	1859–1860	• Cause: Forced cultivation of indigo on fertile rice lands by European planters. • First Incident: Govindpur village, Nadia district (Sept 1859). • Literary Impact: The brutalities of the Indigo system were exposed in Neel Darpan by Dinabandhu Mitra. The newspaper Hindu Patriot, edited by Harish Chandra Mukherjee, also actively supported and highlighted the plight of the peasants. • Outcome: Forced the government to establish the Indigo Commission (Nov 1860). • Widely considered the FIRST successful peasant revolt in India.
Pabna Revolt Region: Bengal (Pabna District)	1873–1885	• Cause: Zamindars arbitrarily raised rents and tried to illegally evict peasants to destroy their land occupancy rights.

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Peasant Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Leaders: Ishan Chandra Roy, Keshab Chandra Roy, Shambhu Nath Pal		• Action: Peasants formed the Agrarian League (1873), organized a massive no-rent campaign, and fought the Zamindars in court using raised funds. • Result: The British intervened and eventually passed the Bengal Tenancy Act of 1885, which permanently protected the land rights of the peasants.
Deccan Riots Region: Maharashtra (Pune & Ahmednagar)	1875	• Groups: Kunbis (Peasant cultivators) vs. Vanis (Village moneylenders). • Cause: The Ryotwari system and new British laws favored moneylenders. High taxes led peasants into debt traps, resulting in the rapid transfer of their lands to the moneylenders. • Action: Peasants socially boycotted the moneylenders, then launched targeted attacks to seize and burn debt contracts, mortgage bonds, and title deeds. • Result: The British suppressed the riots but were forced to pass the Deccan Agriculturists Relief Act of 1879, which offered peasants legal protection against extreme exploitation and land seizure by moneylenders.
Moplah Rebellion Region: Kerala (Malabar Coast) Leader: Variyankunnath Kunjahammed Haji and Ali Musaliyar	1921	Core Causes • Agrarian Exploitation: Severe oppression of Mappila (Muslim) tenants by Nambudiri Brahmin landlords. • Pro-Landlord British Laws: 19th-century British land policies stripped Mappilas of their traditional customary rights, granting absolute legal ownership to upper-caste Hindu landlords. • Political Backing: The Malabar District Congress Committee (at Manjeri in 1920) formally supported the tenants' demands for fair legislation, emboldening the movement. Nature & Key Events • Communal Turn: What began as a secular, anti-imperialist, and anti-landlord peasant uprising tragically took on strict communal colours, leading to widespread violence and forced conversions of Hindus. • The "Wagon Tragedy": A defining and horrific event where numerous Moplah prisoners suffocated to death while being transported in a closed, unventilated railway wagon to Podanur Central Prison. British Reaction • Imposed strict Martial Law to violently suppress the months-long rebellion. • Raised a dedicated armed force known as the Malabar Special Police specifically to crush the uprising.

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Peasant Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Eka Movement Region: Awadh, Uttar Pradesh Leader: Madari Pasi	1921	• Cause: Severe economic distress (drought, inflation) combined with extreme agrarian oppression: extracting rent higher than recorded, refusal to give rent receipts, <i>begari</i> (forced labour), <i>nazrana</i> (forced advance payments), and corruption by middlemen (<i>thekedars</i>). • Action: Initially started as a peaceful movement supported by Congress and Khilafat leaders, utilizing social boycotts and mass rallies. • Shift: As the movement turned militant and violently resisted the oppression of Taluqdars and Zamindars, Congress and Khilafat leaders withdrew their support, making the Eka movement completely independent.
Bardoli Satyagraha Region: Gujarat (Surat) Leader: Vallabhbhai Patel (It was during this movement that the women participants bestowed upon him the historic title of " Sardar ").	1928	• Cause: An unjust and arbitrary 30% increase in land revenue by the British government. • Action: A highly disciplined 'No-Tax' campaign where farmers took religious oaths not to pay. Public opinion was heavily mobilized through the publication of the <i>Bardoli Satyagraha Patrika</i>. • Result: The British yielded and instituted the Broomfield-Maxwell Inquiry, which declared the hike unjustified and slashed it to just 6.03%.
All India Kisan Sabha (AIKS) Region: Pan-India (Formed in Lucknow)	1936	• Key Figures: Swami Sahajanand Saraswati (<i>President</i>) and Prof. N.G. Ranga (<i>General Secretary</i>). • Formation: Created by merging the Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha (formed in 1929) with Andhra and other regional unions. • Core Demands: The total abolition of the Zamindari system, substantial reduction in land revenue, and minimum wages for agricultural laborers.
Tebhaga Movement Region: Bengal Leaders: Kamparam Singh, Bhavan Singh	1946 - 1947	• Organised by: Communist cadres of the Bengal Provincial Krishak Sabha. • The Core Demand: Sharecroppers demanded a 2/3rd share of the harvest (instead of the traditional 50-50 split), leaving only 1/3rd for the landlords. • Additional Demand: As the movement grew, they added the slogan demanding the total abolition of the Zamindari system. • Result: Partially successful. Approximately 40% of sharecroppers successfully obtained these "tebhaga" (three shares) rights and saw a reduction in illegal taxes, though the movement's success was limited in East Bengal.

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Peasant Uprising (Region & Leaders)	Time Period	Significance
Telangana Movement Region: Hyderabad	1946–1951	• Key Targets: Oppressive landlords (<i>Jagirdars</i> and <i>Deshmukhs</i>, locally known as <i>Doras</i>) patronized by the Nizam of Hyderabad. • Cause: Extreme agrarian exploitation, including arbitrary high taxes, massive land evictions, and rampant forced labour (<i>Vetti</i>). • Action: Evolved from early political pressure by the Andhra Maha Sabha (AMS) into a massive Guerrilla-style armed struggle led by the Communist Party of India (CPI). Peasants took up arms against both the landlords and the Nizam's armed militia (<i>Razakars</i>). Outcome: <i>Vetti</i> (forced labour) abolished; vast land redistribution.

SOCIO-RELIGIOUS MOVEMENTS IN INDIA**Introduction & Background**

- **The Cultural Clash:** The radical administrative, economic, and political changes introduced by the British deeply disrupted traditional Indian society. This created a profound conflict between the new colonial system and ancient Indian values.
- **The Western Education Paradox:** The British introduced Western education merely to create a loyal class of clerks and administrators. However, Indians exposed to Western rationalism, humanism, and scientific temper began critically evaluating their own social structures and dogmas.
- **Cultural Nationalism:** Enlightened reformers realized that to successfully resist Western cultural imperialism, they had to first reform Indian society from within. Therefore, these reform movements are widely considered the **earliest expression of Cultural Nationalism** in India.
- **The Catalyst (Charter Act of 1813):** This act officially permitted Christian missionaries to enter India. Their aggressive attacks on Indian religions and culture triggered a strong, defensive intellectual reaction among Indians.

MAJOR HINDU REFORM MOVEMENTS**The Brahmo Samaj**

Raja Rammohan Roy is the undisputed pioneer of the Indian Renaissance. His philosophy was a brilliant synthesis of the monotheism of Vedanta, the mysticism of Sufism, the ethical teachings of Christianity, and the liberal-rationalist ideals of the West.

- **Epithets & Titles:** Herald of the New Age (*Navjagaran ka Agradut*)
 - Father of Modern India
 - Morning Star of the Indian Renaissance
 - Title of '**Raja**': Bestowed by Mughal Emperor Akbar II before sending him to England as an envoy.
- **Social Stance:** He fiercely opposed Sati, polygamy, child marriage, and the rigid caste system, while championing widow remarriage and women's property rights.
- **Literary Work:** Authored *Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin* (A Gift to Monotheists), arguing logically for monotheism in the Persian language.
- **Death:** He died in Bristol, Britain, in 1833.

Institutions & Publications of Raja Rammohan Roy

Year	Institution / Publication	Significance
1815	Atmiya Sabha	Founded in Calcutta to propagate monotheism and campaign against idolatry.
1817	Hindu College	Established in Calcutta with the help of David Hare (a Scottish watchmaker and philanthropist).
1821	Sambad Kaumudi	A Bengali weekly newspaper used specifically to campaign against Sati.
1822	Mirat-ul-Akbar	The very first Persian language journal published in India.

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Year	Institution / Publication	Significance
1823	Calcutta Unitarian Committee	Formed with Dwarkanath Tagore & William Adam.
1825	Vedanta College	Offered courses that blended Indian learning with Western physical sciences.
1828	Brahmo Sabha	Later renamed the Brahmo Samaj -the institutional base of his reform movement.

Evolution of the Brahmo Samaj

- **Maharishi Devendranath Tagore:** Took over leadership after Roy's death. In **1839**, he founded the **Tattvabodhini Sabha** and *Tattvabodhini Patrika* to promote a rational study of India's past. He expanded the Samaj to UP, Punjab, and Madras.
- **The First Schism (1866):** An ideological clash occurred between **Keshab Chandra Sen** (who wanted radical, universal reforms) and Devendranath Tagore (who favored a traditional Hindu approach).
 - Sen broke away and founded the '**Brahmo Samaj of India**' (Bharatiya Brahmo Samaj).
 - Tagore's original faction became known as the '**Adi Brahmo Samaj**'.
- **Keshab Chandra Sen's Impact:** He founded the *Tabernacle of New Dispensation* (1868) and the *Indian Reform Association* (1870). His tireless efforts led to the passing of the **Native Marriage Act (1872)** under Viceroy Lord Northbrook, which banned polygamy and set the minimum marriage age at 14 for girls and 18 for boys.
- **The Second Schism (1878):** Sen hypocritically violated his own 1872 Act by marrying his minor daughter to the King of Cooch Behar. Angered, leaders like Shivanath Shastri and Anand Mohan Bose broke away to form the **Sadharan Brahmo Samaj (1878)**.

Prarthana Samaj

- **Foundation:** Founded in Bombay in 1867 by **Dr. Atmaram Pandurang**, deeply inspired by Keshab Chandra Sen's visit to Maharashtra.
- **Key Leader:** **M.G. Ranade** (famously known as the '**Socrates of Maharashtra**') and R.G. Bhandarkar brought the greatest momentum to the Samaj.
- **Nature:** The Prarthana Samaj was much more active in the social sphere than the religious sphere, becoming the central hub of social reform in Western India.

Key Associations Founded by M.G. Ranade:

- **Poona Sarvajanik Sabha (1870).**
- **Maharashtra Widow Remarriage Association** (Ranade also ran Widow Ashrams & Night Schools for Dalits).
- **Deccan Education Society (1884):** Co-founded with Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Vishnushastri Chiplunkar, and Gopal Ganesh Agarkar.
- **Servants of India Society (1905):** Founded by Ranade's most prominent disciple, **Gopal Krishna Gokhale**.

Theosophical Society

- **Foundation:** Founded in New York in 1875 by **Madam H.P. Blavatsky** (Russian) and **Colonel H.S. Olcott** (American). The international headquarters was shifted to **Adyar, Madras** in 1882.
- **Annie Besant's Leadership:** Annie Besant arrived in India in 1893 and took charge of the society, making a monumental contribution to awakening Indian national consciousness.

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- **Philosophy:** *Theosophy* (Brahma Vidya) heavily supported Hindu spiritual philosophy, fully accepting the doctrines of Karma and Reincarnation.
- **Educational Impact:** Annie Besant established the **Central Hindu College (1898)** in Banaras. Through the later efforts of Madan Mohan Malaviya, this **served as the key nucleus** for the prestigious **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)** in 1916.
- **Political Impact:** She led the Indian **Home Rule League** (modeled on the Irish movement) and became the **First Woman President of the Indian National Congress in 1917**.

Arya Samaj

- **Foundation:** Founded by **Swami Dayanand Saraswati** in Bombay in 1875 (Headquarters shifted to Lahore in 1877).
- **Core Motto:** "**Vedo ki aur lauto**" (Go Back to the Vedas). He proclaimed the Vedas as eternal, infallible, and divine, while rejecting the Puranas as full of myths and priestly corruptions.
- **Reforms:** He was the first major reformer to advocate that Shudras and women had the absolute right to read the Vedas, acquire higher education, and wear the sacred thread (*Yajnopavit*). He supported a Karma-based (action-based) Varna system over a birth-based caste system.
- **Nationalist Firsts:** The Arya Samaj was the first organization to use the terms '**Swaraj**' and '**Swadeshi**', the first to accept Hindi as the national language, and the first to boldly proclaim: "*India is for Indians.*"
- **Key Movements:** Launched the **Shuddhi Movement** (reconversion into the Hindu fold) and the **Go Raksha Andolan** (Cow Protection).
- **Literary Work:** His ideology is captured in his masterpiece, **Satyarth Prakash** (The Light of Truth).

Post-Death Split in Arya Samaj

After Dayanand's death, his followers split over the medium of education:

- **1886:** Lala Hansraj founded the **Dayanand Anglo-Vedic (DAV) School** in Lahore (blending English and Vedic education).
- **1902:** Swami Shraddhanand founded the **Gurukul Kangri University** in Haridwar (focused strictly on traditional Vedic education).

Young Bengal Movement

- **The Founder:** Led by the brilliant Anglo-Indian prodigy, **Henry Louis Vivian Derozio**. He was profoundly inspired by the French Revolution (Liberty, Equality, Fraternity).
- **Organizations:** Founded the Academic Association as a forum for free, radical debate. (**Note: The Society for the Acquisition of General Knowledge was established later in 1838 by his devoted disciples, notably Tarachand Chakraborti and Ramgopal Ghosh.**)
- **Core Demands:** Championed the Freedom of the Press, the protection of *ryots* (peasants) from Zamindars, and the inclusion of Indians in higher government posts.

Derozio's Legacy

- Surendranath Banerjee described the Derozians as "the pioneers of the modern civilisation of Bengal, the conscript fathers of our race whose virtues will excite veneration and whose failings will be treated with gentlest consideration."
- Derozio is widely celebrated as the '**First Nationalist Poet of Modern India.**'

Ramakrishna Mission

- **Foundation:** Founded on **May 1, 1897**, at Baranagar (later shifted to Belur Math) by **Swami Vivekananda** (childhood name: Narendranath Datta), the chief disciple of Ramakrishna Paramahansa.
- **The Chicago Address (1893):** Vivekananda famously represented India at the Parliament of the World's Religions in Chicago. (**Note: He changed his name from Narendranath to Swami Vivekananda upon the suggestion of the Maharaja of Khetri.**)
- **Core Message:** He preached that blending Western materialism with Eastern spiritualism is the greatest path for the welfare of mankind.
- **Publications:** **Prabuddha Bharata/ Awakened India** (English) and **Udbodhan** (Bengali).
- **Books:** *Raja Yoga, Jnana Yoga, Karma Yoga, Vedanta Philosophy.*

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The Spiritual Father

Recognizing his immense impact on the youth, **Subhas Chandra Bose** declared Swami Vivekananda the '**Spiritual Father of the Modern National Movement.**'

MUSLIM SOCIO-RELIGIOUS REFORM MOVEMENTS**The Aligarh Movement**

- **The Pioneer: Sir Syed Ahmad Khan.**
- **Core Objective:** The primary goal was the **modernization of Islamic society**. Sir Syed strongly opposed orthodox practices like the *Piri-muridi* system (blind faith in religious guides) and the practice of slavery.
- **The Pro-British Strategy:** Unlike many other movements of the time, the Aligarh movement favored **English education** and actively advocated for full cooperation with the British government to secure and protect Muslim political and economic interests.
- **Key Institutions:**
 - "1864: Founded the 'Scientific Society' in **Ghazipur (UP)** - and relocated it to **Aligarh in 1866** - to translate prominent English books into Hindi and Urdu, familiarizing Muslims with Western scientific thought."
 - **1875:** Established the '**Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College**' in Aligarh. This iconic institution later evolved into the renowned **Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)** in **1920**.
- **Political Opposition to Congress:** Sir Syed explicitly opposed the newly formed Indian National Congress. To counter it, he partnered with Raja Shiv Prasad Singh of Banaras (*Sitara-Hind*) to found the '**United Indian Patriotic Association**'.
- **Literary Contributions:** He published the highly influential journal **Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq** (Manners and Morals) and wrote a liberal, rational commentary on the Quran.

The Deoband Movement

- **The Founders: Muhammad Qasim Nanotavi and Rashid Ahmad Gangohi** established a highly influential Islamic Madrasa in Deoband (Saharanpur, UP) in **1866**.
- **The Rivalry with Aligarh:** The Deoband School represented the exact ideological opposite of Sir Syed's Aligarh Movement. Deoband was fiercely opposed to English education, Western culture, and pro-British loyalty. They went as far as issuing a *Fatwa* against Sir Syed's 'United Indian Patriotic Association'.
- **Political Stance on Nationalism:** Unlike the Aligarh movement, the Deoband school openly **supported the formation of the Indian National Congress**, aligning itself with the broader anti-imperialist struggle.

The Ahmadiyya Movement

- **The Founder: Mirza Ghulam Ahmad.**
- **Alternative Name:** Because the movement originated in **Qadian** (in the Gurdaspur district of Punjab), it is also famously known as the '**Qadiani Movement**'.
- **Ideology & Influences:** This movement strictly **opposed Jihad**. Ghulam Ahmad was a progressive thinker, deeply influenced by Western liberalism, Theosophy (*Brahma Vidya*), and contemporary Hindu reform movements.
- **Controversial Claims:** The movement drew immense controversy when Ghulam Ahmad proclaimed himself to be "another Prophet" following Muhammad, and concurrently claimed to be an "Avatar of Krishna."

The Wahabi Movement

- **The Indian Leader:** Sparked by the teachings of Abdul Wahab of Arabia, the movement gained massive popularity in India under the leadership of **Syed Ahmed of Rae Bareilly**.
- **The Epicenter: Patna (Bihar)** served as the absolute center of power, coordination, and funding for this movement.

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- **Nature of the Revolt:** Fundamentally, this was a **revivalist** religious movement. Its main goal was to re-establish the pure, unadulterated Islam of Prophet Muhammad's era.
- **The Geopolitical Shift:** The movement's core ideology was to convert India from '*Dar-ul-Harb*' (Land of Infidels) into '*Dar-ul-Islam*' (Land of Islam).
 - Initially, they declared *Jihad* (holy war) against the Sikhs in Punjab.
 - However, after the British annexed the Sikh empire, the movement turned its fierce hostility entirely toward the British.
- **Historical Limitation:** Despite its fierce anti-British stance, the Wahabi movement could never take the shape of a true national movement because of its strictly communal and exclusionary nature.

DALIT & LOWER-CASTE REFORM MOVEMENTS

As the 20th century dawned, the focus of socio-religious reform heavily shifted towards eradicating untouchability and fighting caste discrimination.

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Born in 1891 in the Mhow district (MP) into the untouchable Mahar caste, Dr. Bhimrao Ambedkar dedicated his life to the absolute annihilation of caste discrimination.

- **Key Organizations Founded:**
 - **1924: Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha** (To promote the moral & material progress of untouchables).
 - **1927: Samaj Samata Sangh** (To foster social equality between Hindus and untouchables).
 - **1936: Independent Labour Party** (To protect working-class interests).
 - **1942: All India Scheduled Castes Federation.**
- **Journalism:** He launched two highly influential Marathi journals: ***Mooknayak*** (Leader of the Silent, 1920) and ***Bahishkrit Bharat*** (Ostracized India, 1927).
- **The Poona Pact (1932):** When the British announced the 'Communal Award' granting separate electorates to lower castes, Mahatma Gandhi began a fast unto death in Yerwada Jail, fearing the permanent division of Hindu society. A compromise was reached through the historic **Poona Pact**, which provided reserved seats within a *joint* electorate instead.

Satyashodhak Samaj

- **The Pioneer:** **Jyotirao Govindrao Phule (Jyotiba Phule)** founded this Samaj in Maharashtra in 1873.
- **Educational Firsts:** This was the **first Indian organization** to open schools specifically dedicated to the untouchable classes. Jyotiba Phule and his wife, Savitribai Phule, also opened a girls' school in Poona.
- **Literary Work:** He documented the misery of the lower castes and criticized hypocritical Brahminical dominance in his seminal book, ***Gulamgiri***.

Self-Respect Movement

- **The Leader:** Founded in South India by **E.V. Ramasamy Naicker**, who is respectfully known across India as '**Periyar**'.
- **Core Objectives:** The movement directly and aggressively challenged Brahmin supremacy.
- **Radical Methods:** It encouraged weddings to be conducted without Brahmin priests, forcefully asserted the right to temple entry, and advocated for the burning of the *Manusmriti*.
- **Literary Work:** Periyar translated and rewrote the Ramayana in the Tamil language, provocatively titling it the '**True Ramayana**' (*Sachchi Ramayan*).

Vaikom Satyagraha

- **Location:** Travancore, Kerala (centered around the Vaikom Mahadeva Temple).
- **Key Leaders:** T.K. Madhavan, K. Kelappan (known as 'Kerala Gandhi'), Periyar E.V. Ramasamy, Mannathu Padmanabhan, and M.K. Gandhi.

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- **The Cause:** Severe untouchability practices where lower castes were denied access to the public roads surrounding the temple.
- **The Goal:** A purely social reform movement (distinct from the political freedom struggle) aiming to secure equal rights for all sections of society to use the public roads and eventually enter the temple.

WOMEN'S UPLIFTMENT MOVEMENTS

Figure / Movement	Key Contributions & Significance
Pandita Ramabai	Founded the Arya Mahila Samaj (Pune). Established Sharda Sadan , a crucial shelter and vocational training ashram for widows and orphans. Authored the revealing book, <i>The High Caste Hindu Woman</i> .
D.K. Karve	"Collaborated with M.G. Ranade on the Widow Remarriage Association. He founded the First Indian Women's University in 1916 ."
Sarala Devi Chaudhurani	Founded the Bharat Stree Mahamandal (1910) in Allahabad. This was the first major organization working purely for the common interests of Indian women.
Margaret Cousins	Founded the All India Women's Conference (AIWC) in 1927. The very first conference was held at Fergusson College, Pune.
Rakhmabai Raut (Landmark Case, 1884)	One of India's first practicing female doctors. Married at 11, she refused to live with her husband, leading to the <i>Dadaji Bhikaji vs. Rakhmabai</i> case. The court sided with her husband, but Queen Victoria personally intervened to dissolve the marriage. This landmark case directly led to the drafting of the Age of Consent Act, 1891 .

SIKH & PARSİ REFORM MOVEMENTS

Sikh Reform Movements

- **Early Spiritual Reforms:** The **Nirankari Movement** (led by Baba Dayal Das) and the **Namdhari Movement** (led by Baba Ram Singh).
- **Singh Sabha Movement (1873):** Officially founded in Amritsar by prominent Sikhs like **Thakur Singh Sandhawalia** and **Giani Gian Singh**. It successfully established the **Khalsa College**, opened numerous schools, and actively promoted the Gurmukhi script and Punjabi literature.
- **Akali Movement (1920s):**
 - **The Issue:** Corrupt *Mahants* (priests) were misusing Gurudwara funds and donated lands for personal gain.
 - **The Struggle:** In 1921, the Akalis launched a massive, non-violent Satyagraha against the Mahants.
 - **The Victory:** Bowing to the protests, the government passed the **Sikh Gurdwara Act (1922, amended 1925)**, permanently transferring the management of all Gurudwaras to the Sikh community via the SGPC.

Parsi Reform Movement

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- **Rahnumai Mazdayasan Sabha (1851):** Founded by stalwarts like Naoroji Furdoonji, **Dadabhai Naoroji**, S.S. Bengalee, and R.K. Cama.
- **The Journal:** To spread their reformist message, they launched the highly influential journal, ***Rast Goftar*** (The Truth Teller).
- **Core Reforms:** The Sabha fought religious orthodoxy, abolished the purdah system among Parsis, strongly emphasized female education, and raised the legal age of marriage.
- **Impact:** This reform movement was extraordinarily successful, helping make the Parsi community one of the most prosperous, educated, and modernized sections of Indian society.

NOTE: Dadabhai Naoroji was the **founder** of Gujarati newspaper **Rast Goftar**.

- Dadabhai Naoroji is also known as the "**Unofficial Ambassador of India**" and "**Grand Old Man of India**".
- He was the first Indian to become a British MP (Member of Parliament).

LEGISLATIVE ACTS FOR SOCIAL REFORM

Act / Reform	Year	Viceroy / Gov-General	Key Details & Associated Reformers
Abolition of Sati <i>(Regulation XVII)</i>	1829 (Dec)	Lord William Bentinck	• Enforced first in the Bengal Presidency. • Raja Rammohan Roy played the most vital and courageous role.
Female Infanticide Banned	1795 & 1804	John Shore (1795) Lord Wellesley (1804)	• Passed via Bengal Regulation XXI (1795) and later reinforced by Bengal Regulation III (1804). • The act declared female infanticide entirely equivalent to murder.
Abolition of Thuggee	1830s	Lord William Bentinck	• Bentinck specifically appointed Colonel William Sleeman to hunt down and eradicate the Thugs.
Indian Slavery Act <i>(Act V of 1843)</i>	1843	Lord Ellenborough	• The initial directive was given in the Charter Act of 1833. • <i>(Historical link: Firoz Shah Tughlaq and Akbar also banned the slave trade in the medieval era).</i>
Abolition of Human Sacrifice <i>(Meriah System)</i>	1844–1845	Lord Hardinge I	• Hardinge appointed Major-General John Campbell (along with Captain Macpherson) to eradicate it. • The <i>Meriah</i> system was primarily prevalent among the aboriginal Khond tribe.

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Act / Reform	Year	Viceroy / Gov-General	Key Details & Associated Reformers
Hindu Widow Remarriage Act (Act XV, 1856)	1856	Lord Canning	• Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar was the key reformer. • Granted full legal recognition to widow remarriage and legitimized their children.
Brahmo Marriage Act (Native Marriage Act)	1872	Lord Northbrook	• Passed due to the relentless efforts of Keshab Chandra Sen. • Completely banned polygamy. • Minimum age fixed at 14 for girls and 18 for boys.
Age of Consent Act	1891	Lord Lansdowne	• Minimum age of consent for girls raised to 12 years. • Behramji Malabari (Parsi reformer) was the key driver. • Directly influenced by the Rakhmabai Case (1884). • Famously opposed by nationalist Bal Gangadhar Tilak.
Sarda Act (Child Marriage Restraint Act)	1929 (Effective: April 1, 1930)	Lord Irwin	• Drafted by prominent Ajmer educationist Dr. Harbilas Sarda. • Minimum age fixed at 14 for girls and 18 for boys. • <i>Post-Independence Amendment (1978)</i>: Raised to 18 (girls) and 21 (boys).

THE DEVELOPMENT OF POLITICAL CONSCIOUSNESS IN INDIA

Introduction & Background

Political consciousness in India developed from the late 19th-century, fueled by British administrative unification, the spread of modern education, and the rise of a nationalist press, these policies inadvertently sowed the seeds of national awakening.

- **The Western Education Paradox:** Although the British introduced Western education merely to produce loyal clerks and administrators, it inadvertently exposed Indians to modern concepts of rationalism, humanism, and democracy.
- **The 'Lingua Franca' (link language):** English became the common intellectual medium for educated Indians hailing from diverse linguistic backgrounds across the subcontinent. This newly shared language heavily fostered ideological unity and national integration.
- **The Catalyst of Oppressive Policies:** The reactionary and anti-Indian policies of the British government frequently accelerated the growth of nationalism by uniting Indians in common grievance.

Lord Lytton's Repressive Era

Viceroy Lord Lytton took several deeply unpopular steps that crushed the aspirations of educated Indians and accelerated nationalist anger:

1. **The Indian Arms Act (1878):** Effectively disarmed Indians by making it a criminal offense to keep or bear arms without a license.
2. **The Vernacular Press Act (1878):** Imposed strict, discriminatory censorship specifically targeting Indian-language (vernacular) newspapers.
3. **Civil Services Restrictions:** He held the ICS exams exclusively in England and deliberately reduced the maximum age limit for Indian candidates from **21 years to 19 years**, making it nearly impossible for them to compete.

THE DEVELOPMENT OF MODERN EDUCATION IN INDIA

Early Oriental Institutions (Pre-1813)

Initially, the East India Company had absolutely no interest in public education. The earliest institutional efforts were focused strictly on **Oriental (Traditional) learning** to serve administrative needs—specifically, training British officers in local languages and helping them understand Hindu and Muslim laws for the courts.

Early Educational Institutions

Year	Institution	Founder	Objective & Key Details
1781	Calcutta Madrasa	Warren Hastings	To study Arabic, Persian, and Islamic law.
1784	Asiatic Society of Bengal	Sir William Jones	Founded in Calcutta to study ancient Indian history and culture. • Charles Wilkins translated the <i>Bhagavad Gita</i> . • William Jones translated <i>Abhigyanashakuntalam</i> .
1791	Sanskrit College (Banaras)	Jonathan Duncan	Established specifically for the study of Hindu law and philosophy.

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Year	Institution	Founder	Objective & Key Details
1800	Fort William College (Calcutta)	Lord Wellesley	Established strictly for the training of the Company's civil servants- not for public education.

The Push for Western Education

Over time, pressure mounted to introduce modern Western education, but the motives of the different groups varied drastically:

- **Educated Indians:** Concluded that India's deep-rooted social, economic, and political weaknesses could only be cured through the light of modern Western education and sciences.
- **Christian Missionaries:** Believed that Western education would destroy the natives' faith in their traditional religions, ultimately leading to mass conversions to Christianity.
- **The British Administration (The Real Motive):** Pragmatically, the Company needed to produce a cheap, steady supply of educated Indians to fill the lower-ranking administrative and clerical posts in the expanding colonial bureaucracy.

The Charter Act of 1813: The First Official Intervention

- **The Turning Point:** The East India Company made its very first official, concrete intervention in the sphere of education through the Charter Act of 1813.
- **The Financial Provision:** The Governor-General was authorized to set aside an annual sum of ₹1,00,000 (One Lakh Rupees) for the revival of literature, the encouragement of learned Indians, and the promotion of science.
- **The Flaw:** The Act completely lacked clarity regarding the *objectives* and the *medium of instruction*-a glaring ambiguity that directly triggered the infamous Anglicist-Orientalist Controversy.

Key Early Institutions

- **Hindu College (1817):** Established in Calcutta by **Raja Rammohan Roy** and **David Hare** (a Scottish philanthropist). It was the **first college** to impart higher education strictly on Western lines.
- **Delhi College (1824) (now Zakir Husain Delhi College):** Founded as a madrasa in late 17th century by Ghaziuddin Khan, a leading commander of Aurangzeb and father of the first Nizam of Hyderabad; it was re-established as Delhi College by the East India Company in 1824.
- **Asiatic Society of Bombay (1804):** Founded by **Sir James Mackintosh**.
- **Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain (1823):** Founded by the renowned Sanskrit scholar **Henry Thomas Colebrooke**; it received a royal charter by King George IV in August 1824.
- **Bethune School (1849):** **J.E.D. Bethune** (a British law member) established the Hindu Kanya Vidyalaya in Calcutta, with **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar** as its Secretary. **Kadambini Ganguly** (one of India's first female doctors) received her early education here.
- **Deccan Education Society (1884):** Founded in Pune by **Lokmanya Tilak**, **V.K. Chiplunkar**, and **Gopal Ganesh Agarkar** to make English education cheap, accessible, and to inspire nationalist education among the youth.

BCW Bits: - First Indian in the ICS

The very first Indian to successfully pass the prestigious Indian Civil Service (ICS) examination was **Satyendranath Tagore** in the year **1863**.

THE GREAT DEBATE & POLICY SHIFT**The Anglicist-Orientalist Controversy**

To decide how to spend the ₹1 Lakh allocated by the 1813 Act, the government formed a 10-member **General Committee of Public Instruction (1823)**. However, the committee quickly fractured into two bitterly opposed factions.

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The Orientalist Faction	The Anglicist Faction
Leaders: H.T. Prinsep (Secretary) & H.H. Wilson.	Leaders: Thomas Munro, Mountstuart Elphinstone, & Lord Macaulay.
Core Argument: Western science should be imparted, but only through traditional languages (Sanskrit, Arabic, Persian).	Core Argument: Oriental education is dead and cannot be revived. Traditional literature has no practical or scientific value.
Cultural Warning: Imposing Western thought and English medium would shock and destroy Indian culture.	The Demand: All government funds must be spent exclusively on Western education through the English medium.
Claim: Modern sciences were already outlined in the Vedas and simply required proper interpretation.	Imperial View: English education would create a loyal class of Indian administrators.

Macaulay's Minute on Education (1835)

To break the deadlock, Governor-General Lord William Bentinck appointed his Law Member, **Lord Macaulay**, as President of the Committee.

- **The Submission (Feb 2, 1835):** Macaulay submitted his famous 'Minute', fiercely supporting the Anglicist faction.
- **Infamous Insult:** He completely dismissed Indian literature, arrogantly declaring: *"A single shelf of a good European library is worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia."*
- **The Imperial Objective:** Macaulay explicitly stated the ultimate goal of his policy: *"We must form a class of persons, Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect."*
- **Bentinck's Order (1835):** Lord William Bentinck fully approved the Minute. He passed a decisive order that all government education funds would be spent **solely on European literature and science through the English medium.**
- **Macaulay on the EIC:** Regarding the East India Company, Macaulay famously remarked: *"The Company is an anomaly, but it is part of a system where everything is an anomaly."*

The Downward Filtration Theory

Because the government chose to spend its limited funds exclusively on English higher education, mass education was entirely neglected. To justify this, the British adopted the '**Downward Filtration Theory**'.

- **The Concept:** Education should be given only to the upper, elite classes. The British believed this knowledge would naturally 'trickle down' or filter down to the common masses over time.
- **The Spectacular Failure:** This theory proved to be a complete failure. Once Indians acquired English education and secured comfortable government jobs, they alienated themselves from their own people. Indigenous schools were systematically neglected, leaving the broader mass education system devastated.

EDUCATION COMMISSIONS & POLICIES**Education Policies - Quick Reference**

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Policy / Commission	Year	Chairman / Author	Key Tag & Core Significance
Wood's Despatch	1854	Sir Charles Wood (<i>President, Board of Control</i>)	Universally known as the ' Magna Carta of English Education in India '.
Hunter Education Commission	1882–83	W.W. Hunter	Focused exclusively on Primary & Secondary education; proposed the bifurcation of secondary education.
Indian Universities Act	1904	Based on the Raleigh Commission (Sir Thomas Raleigh, 1902)	Lord Curzon's strict policy. Condemned by Gokhale as a ' retrograde measure '.
Sadler University Commission	1917	Dr. Michael Sadler (<i>V.C., Univ. of Leeds</i>)	Introduced the modern structure: 12-year schooling , 2-year Intermediate, and a 3-year degree.
Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms	1919	-	Education was officially transferred to the provinces under the system of Dyarchy .
Hartog Committee	1929	Sir Philip Hartog (<i>Auxiliary to the Simon Commission</i>)	Emphasized consolidation over expansion ; recommended restricting university admissions.
Wardha Scheme	1937	Mahatma Gandhi's initiative; Syllabus by Dr. Zakir Hussain Committee	Focused on learning through a manual productive craft with the mother tongue as the medium.
Sargent Plan	1944	Sir John Sargent (<i>Educational Advisor to GoI</i>)	Proposed free & compulsory education (6–11 yrs) and a 40-year reconstruction plan (later reduced to 16 years by the Kher Committee).

Wood's Despatch (1854) - The Magna Carta

- **Why significant:** First regulatory framework for education on an all-India level. Decided under Lord Dalhousie's tenure.
- **State responsibility:** Government must bear responsibility for mass education.
- **Medium:** English for higher education; vernacular languages actively encouraged at lower levels.
- **School hierarchy:** Vernacular primary schools (village) → Anglo-Vernacular high schools (district) → affiliated colleges.
- **Universities:** Modelled on London University - to be established in Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras (all three came up in 1857). Function: conduct exams and confer degrees.
- **Grants-in-Aid:** Introduced to support private educational efforts.
- **Teacher training:** Normal Schools to train educators.

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- **Female education:** Must be actively encouraged; government support for Bethune-style women's schools.
- **Aftermath:** 1855 - separate Education Department established; Directors of Public Instruction appointed. In 1870 - education made a provincial subject → reduced central funding.

Hunter Commission

- **Scope:** Unlike Wood's Despatch, this commission was restricted to evaluating and expanding only **primary and secondary education**.
- **Primary Education:** Recommended maximum emphasis on primary education, suggesting that its control be handed over to the newly established **Municipal and District Boards**.
- **Secondary Bifurcation:** Proposed dividing the secondary curriculum into two distinct tracks:
 1. **Literary Track:** Geared towards university entrance.
 2. **Practical/Vocational Track:** Geared towards commercial and practical life.

Indian Universities Act, 1904

- **Background:** Viceroy Lord Curzon convened the Shimla Conference (1901), which led to the formation of the **Raleigh Commission (1902)**, ultimately resulting in the 1904 Act.
- **Tightened Control:** The Act reduced the number of University Fellows (50–100), fixed their tenure to 6 years, and ensured the majority were nominated by the government.
- **Research Focus:** Directed universities to appoint their own professors and lecturers, shifting them from purely examining bodies to teaching and research institutions.
- **Government Veto:** Granted the government absolute veto power over all University Senate resolutions and exceptionally strict control over the affiliation of private colleges.
- **Financial Grant:** Allocated ₹5 Lakhs per year for 5 years for university upliftment.

Sadler University Commission (1917)

- **Indian Members:** Prominently included **Dr. Ashutosh Mukherjee** and **Dr. Ziauddin Ahmed**.
- **Structural Overhaul:** It introduced the modern educational framework:
 - School course must span **12 years**.
 - A **2-year Intermediate course** must be completed before university entry.
 - A **3-year degree** program with a clear separation between 'Pass' and 'Honours' courses.
- **University Autonomy:** Recommended replacing rigid 'affiliating' universities with autonomous, centralized teaching and residential universities.
- **Outcome:** Sparked the creation of several new universities between 1916–1921, including Mysore, Patna, Banaras, Aligarh, Dhaka, Lucknow, and Osmania.

Hartog Committee (1929)

- **Background:** Formed as an auxiliary committee of the **Simon Commission**.
- **Core Finding:** The committee noted a massive, unplanned expansion of education and firmly recommended **consolidation (quality over quantity)**.
- **Recommendations:** Suggested restricting university admissions to capable and deserving students only. Recommended that average students (especially in rural areas) be diverted to industrial or vocational courses immediately after Middle School.

Wardha Scheme / Basic Education - Nai Talim (1937)

- **Origin:** Inspired by Mahatma Gandhi's articles in the *Harijan*, the scheme was adopted at the All India National Education Conference in Wardha (1937). The detailed syllabus was formulated by the **Dr. Zakir Hussain Committee**.
- **Core Principle:** Education should revolve around **manual productive work** (craft-centered education).

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- **Key Features:** Mandated **free and compulsory education** for all children aged 7–14 years, with the **mother tongue** strictly as the medium of instruction.
- **Outcome:** Implementation was abruptly halted due to the outbreak of WWII (1939) and the resignation of Congress provincial ministries. It was resumed post-independence.

Sargent Plan (1944)

- **Origin:** Prepared by **Sir John Sargent** (Educational Advisor to the Government of India).
- **Key Proposals:** Recommended free and compulsory education for children aged 6–11, followed by an additional 6 years of high school (ages 11–17).
- **Structural Changes:** Proposed the **complete abolition of the intermediate tier**. Suggested two types of high schools: Academic and Technical/Vocational.
- **Timeframe:** Originally envisioned as a 40-year reconstruction plan, the post-independence **Kher Committee** drastically reduced the implementation target to just 16 years.

HISTORY AND REGULATION OF THE INDIAN PRESS

The development of the press in India was a double-edged sword for the British. While they introduced it, nationalist leaders quickly adopted it as the most powerful weapon to spread political consciousness.

Origins of the Press in India

- **First Printing Press:** The Portuguese brought the very first printing press to India. In **1556**, Portuguese priests published the first book in India in **Goa**.
- **East India Company:** The Company established its own printing press in **Bombay in 1684**.
- **India's First Newspaper:** In **1780**, an Irishman named **James Augustus Hicky** published India's very first newspaper, titled '**The Bengal Gazette**' (also known as *The Calcutta General Advertiser*). However, it was swiftly shut down and its press seized because Hicky fiercely criticized British officials.

Press Acts & Regulations At a Glance

Act / Regulation	Year	Enacted By	Nature & Key Provisions
Censorship of Press Act	1799	Lord Wellesley	• Imposed strict censorship and mandatory pre-censorship (all content had to be approved <i>before</i> printing). • Later relaxed by Lord Hastings (pre-censorship abolished in 1818).
Licensing Regulations	1823	John Adams	• Made it mandatory to obtain a government license to print. The Governor-General could cancel it at any time. • Impact: Raja Rammohan Roy was forced to stop the publication of his journal, <i>Mirat-ul-Akbar</i>.
Press Act / Metcalfe Act	1835	Charles Metcalfe	• Repealed the draconian 1823 regulations. • Publishers only had to give a simple location declaration. • Metcalfe is celebrated as the 'Liberator of the Indian Press'.

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Act / Regulation	Year	Enacted By	Nature & Key Provisions
Licensing Act	1857	-	An emergency measure due to the Revolt of 1857. Prohibited press without a license. Terminated after 1 year.
Registration Act	1867	-	- Aimed to <i>regulate</i> rather than prohibit. Required mandatory display of the printer/publisher's name. Crucial Addition: Added Section 124A (Sedition) to the IPC, prescribing life imprisonment for sedition (initially directed at Wahabi Rebellion writers).
Vernacular Press Act	1878	Lord Lytton	- Highly discriminatory; targeted only Indian-language papers. - Magistrates could demand a bond to not publish anti-government material, with no right to appeal in court. - Amrita Bazar Patrika (a prominent Bengali newspaper) converted to English overnight to escape it. - Pre-censorship clause removed Sept 1878. - Officially repealed by Lord Ripon in 1882.
Newspapers (Incitement to Offences) Act	1908	-	- Enacted following the unrest of the Partition of Bengal (1905). - Empowered authorities to confiscate presses publishing material inciting violence or murder.
Indian Press Act	1910	-	- Revived the worst features of the Vernacular Press Act. - Required hefty security deposits (₹500–₹2,000) which could be forfeited if "objectionable" material was printed. - Re-registration: ₹1,000–₹10,000. Appeal to Special Tribunal within 2 months.
Press Enquiry Committee	1921	Sir Tej Bahadur Sapru	Formed due to massive public outcry. Based on its report, the 1908 and 1910 Acts were officially repealed.
Indian Press (Emergency Powers) Act	1931	-	Enacted to ruthlessly suppress Gandhi's Civil Disobedience Movement. Expanded in 1932 to include any acts harming British sovereignty.

Post-Independence Press Regulations

After India gained independence, the new government reviewed colonial laws to align them with the fundamental rights guaranteed by the Constitution.

- Press Enquiry Committee (1947):** Reviewed all colonial press laws. Recommended repeal of 1931 Emergency Powers Act; amendment of Sections 124A & 153A IPC; repeal of Indian States (Protection) Act 1934.

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- **Press (Objectable Matter) Act (1951):** Lapsed 1956. Key feature: affected party must be given opportunity to present defence before punitive action. Press Commission set up 1954 to review it.
- **Press Council Act (1965):** Established Press Council of India - to elevate standards and maintain independence of the press. Repealed following declaration of Internal Emergency in 1975.

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POLITICAL ASSOCIATIONS BEFORE THE INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS**Background**

- **Post-1857 awakening:** After the Revolt of 1857, nationalist sentiments developed rapidly. Indians recognised that every class - peasants, artisans, intellectuals, traders - had their interests sacrificed under colonial rule.
- **Role of discriminatory policies:** British exploitative policies catalysed modern nationalism. People realised foreign rule would permanently threaten their economic, social, cultural and political interests.
- **Pre-Congress phase:** Before the Indian National Congress was established in 1885, several political associations emerged in Bengal, Bombay, Madras, and London - using magazines, newspapers, and public meetings to awaken political consciousness.

NOTE:

- **Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha (1836):** Led by Gouri Shankar Tarkabagish and supported by associates of Raja Ram Mohan Roy, including Dwarkanath Tagore, this is widely considered by historians to be the **very first organized political association** in India.
- **British India Society (1839, England):** Founded by William Adams; it actively collaborated with the Landholders' Society in India.

Pre-Congress Associations At a Glance

Association	Year	Region	Founder(s) / Key Figures
Bangabhasha Prakasika Sabha	1836	Bengal	Associates of Raja Rammohan Roy
Landholders' Society	1838	Bengal (Calcutta)	Dwarkanath Tagore
Bengal British India Society	1843	Bengal	George Thompson
British Indian Association	1851	Bengal (Calcutta)	Radhakant Deb (<i>President</i>), Devendranath Tagore
Bombay Association	1852	Bombay	Dadabhai Naoroji
Madras Native Association	1852	Madras	Gazulu Lakshminarasu Chetty
London India Society	1865	London	Dadabhai Naoroji
East India Association	1866	London	Dadabhai Naoroji
Poona Sarvajanic Sabha	1870	Bombay (Pune)	M.G. Ranade, Ganesh Vasudev Joshi
Indian League	1875	Bengal (Calcutta)	Sisir Kumar Ghosh

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Association	Year	Region	Founder(s) / Key Figures
Calcutta Students Association	1875	Bengal (Calcutta)	Anand Mohan Bose
Indian Association	1876	Bengal (Calcutta)	Surendranath Banerjee, Anand Mohan Bose
Madras Mahajan Sabha	1884	Madras	M. Viraraghavachari, G. Subramania Iyer
Bombay Presidency Association	1885	Bombay	Pherozeshah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji, K.T. Telang

POLITICAL ASSOCIATIONS IN BENGAL

Bengal was the epicenter of early political awakening. The organizations here gradually shifted from protecting elite landlords to representing the middle class.

Landholders' Society / Zamindari Association (1838)

- **Foundation:** Founded in 1838 by **Dwarkanath Tagore** in Calcutta.
- **Historical Significance:** It was the **first political association in India** to initiate organized political efforts using constitutional methods.
- Initially **Zamindari Association**; renamed **Landholders' Society** soon after its launch in Calcutta in March 1838.
- **Leading members:** Radhakanta Deb, Dwarkanath Tagore, Prasanna Kumar Tagore, Rajkamal Sen, Bhabani Charan Mitra.
- **Objective:** To safeguard the interests of Zamindars (landlords) and pioneer the use of constitutional remedies to redress grievances.

Bengal British India Society (1843)

- **Foundation:** Founded under the presidency of **George Thompson**.
- **Nature:** A joint organization comprising both Indians and non-official Englishmen. It aimed to collect and disseminate information about the actual condition of Indians under British rule.

British Indian Association (1851)

- **Formation:** Formed by **merging** the Landholders' Society and the Bengal British India Society. Founded under the presidency of **Radhakant Deb**.
- **Mouthpiece:** **Hindu Patriot** newspaper.
- **Key Actions:** Sent a major petition to the British Parliament during the renewal of the 1853 Charter, demanding a popular legislature and separation of the judiciary from the executive.
 - **Direct Result:** The Charter Act of 1853 added 6 new members to the Governor-General's Executive Council specifically for legislative purposes.
 - It also demanded the formation of a commission to inquire into the **Indigo Revolt (Neel Vidroh)**.

Indian League (1875)

- **Founded:** September 1875 by Sisir Kumar Ghosh - Calcutta.
- **Objective:** Stimulate nationalism among people; encourage political education among the masses.

Calcutta Students Association (1875)

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- **Founded:** 1875 by Anand Mohan Bose.
- Surendranath Banerjee joined alongside Bose - later emerged as a major influential leader of the Bengal student community.

Indian Association (1876)

- **Foundation:** Founded on **July 26, 1876**, at Albert Hall, Calcutta, by **Surendranath Banerjee** (Founder) and **Anand Mohan Bose** (Secretary). It replaced the Indian League.
- The Indian National Association was initially established as **Bharat Sabha**
- **Inclusivity:** Deliberately prioritized the middle class and common masses over Zamindars by keeping the annual subscription at a highly affordable ₹5.
- **Ideology:** Inspired by **Mazzini** (the harbinger of Italian unification), it aimed for a united India with common political aspirations.
- **Key Agitations:**
 - **Civil Services Agitation:** Demanded simultaneous ICS exams in India and higher age limits.
 - Fiercely opposed Lytton's **Vernacular Press Act** and **Arms Act (1878)**.
 - Actively supported the **Ilbert Bill**.

Surendranath Banerjee & The Indian Association

- **Title:** Surendranath Banerjee was universally revered as '**Rashtra Guru**' (Teacher of the Nation).
- **First Political Imprisonment (1883):** Banerjee became the first Indian journalist to be imprisoned. He was sentenced to 2 months in jail for criticizing Calcutta High Court Judge J.F. Norris in his paper, *The Bengalee*.
- **The Missing Founder:** The Indian Association organized the Second **Indian National Conference** in Calcutta in December 1885, presided over by Banerjee. Because he was occupied with this, **he could NOT attend the founding session of the Indian National Congress (INC)** held simultaneously in Bombay.
- **Merger:** The Indian Association officially merged with the INC in **1886**.

POLITICAL ASSOCIATIONS IN BOMBAY**Bombay Association (August 26, 1852)**

- **Founded:** August 26, 1852 by Dadabhai Naoroji - modelled on the British Indian Association of Calcutta.
- **Objective:** Submit memorandums to the government to remove discriminatory rules and policies.
- **Key action:** Sent memorandum to British Parliament demanding Indian representation in legislative councils; criticised exorbitant salaries of British officials and exclusion of Indians from high posts.

Poona Sarvajanik Sabha (1870)

- **Founded:** 1870 - by M.G. Ranade + Ganesh Vasudev Joshi.
- **Objective:** Bridge the gap between government and people; educate public on securing their rights.
- **1875 petition:** Submitted petition to the House of Commons demanding **direct representation for Indians in the British Parliament**.
- **Key members:** S.H. Sathe, S.H. Chiplunkar.
- **Limitation:** Primarily represented middle class, landlords and wealthy traders (mostly Brahmins and Vaishyas). Failed to mobilise the peasant class.

Bombay Presidency Association (1885)

- **Founded:** 1885 by the famous triumvirate - **Pherozeshah Mehta + Badruddin Tyabji + K.T. Telang**.
- **Objective:** Spread political ideas and national consciousness among the masses.

POLITICAL ASSOCIATIONS IN MADRAS**Madras Native Association (1852)**

- **Founded:** 1852 by Gazulu Lakshminarasu Chetty - established as a regional branch of the British Indian Association of Calcutta.
- **Key action:** Sent detailed memorandum to English Parliament just before the Charter Act of 1853.

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Madras Mahajan Sabha (1884)

- **Founded:** 1884 by M. Viraraghavachari, G. Subramania Iyer, and P. Anand Charlu.
- **Objective:** Coordinate and unify the functions of various scattered local organisations in the Madras presidency.
- **First Conference:** December 29, 1884 to January 2, 1885 - Madras.
- **Key demands:** Reforms in legislative councils; strict separation of executive from judiciary; improvement of condition of agriculturalists.

POLITICAL ASSOCIATIONS IN LONDON**London India Society (1865)**

- **Founded:** 1865 in London by Dadabhai Naoroji.
- **Key members:** Pherozeshah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji, W.C. Bonnerjee, Manmohan Ghosh.
- **Objective:** Use the English press to inform the British public about the mistreatment and exploitative policies of the British government toward Indians.

East India Association (1866)

- **Founded:** 1866 in London by **Dadabhai Naoroji** - the 'Grand Old Man of India'.
- **Objective:** Thoroughly inform the British public and Parliament about genuine Indian grievances; mobilise public opinion and build political support in England for the Indian people.
- **Expansion:** 1869 - major branch established in Bombay; further branches opened across India.
- **Historical significance:** Prior to the birth of the Indian National Congress, this was the **most prominent and influential organisation** that inspired and mobilised Indian youth to strive for political rights.

NATIONAL MOVEMENT (1885–1905)**ESTABLISHMENT OF INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS (1885)****Key Facts at a Glance**

Founder	Allan Octavian Hume (A.O. Hume) - retired ICS officer
Founded	December 1885
Original Name	Indian National Union (changed to INC on suggestion of Dadabhai Naoroji)
Viceroy at time of founding	Lord Dufferin (1884–1888)
First Session Date	December 28, 1885
Venue of First Session	Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Gowalia Tank, Bombay
Why venue changed?	Planned at Pune, shifted due to a cholera outbreak in Pune.
Delegates in 1st session	72 delegates (majority: lawyers & journalists)
Highest delegates from	Bombay Province (38 members)
First President	Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee (W.C. Bonnerjee)
First General Secretary	A.O. Hume

Who Was Present

- Prominent attendees: Pherozeshah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji, W.C. Bonnerjee, Anand Mohan Bose, Romesh Chandra Dutt

Who was ABSENT from 1885 founding?	Surendranath Banerjee - was presiding over 2nd All India Conference of Indian Association in Calcutta simultaneously. Indian Association merged with INC in 1886.
Never associated with INC	Sir Syed Ahmad Khan
Active member but NEVER elected INC President	Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Theory of Founding - Safety Valve vs. Lightning Conductor**Safety Valve Theory**

- **Concept:** Congress created to channel discontent harmlessly after 1857's failure, preventing violent extremism.
- **Proponent:** Lala Lajpat Rai (in journal Young India)
- **Lajpat Rai's view:** Called Congress "the product of Lord Dufferin's brain." Said its primary objective was to save the British Empire, not achieve freedom.

Lightning Conductor Theory (Tadit Chalak)

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- **Nationalist Counter-Argument:** Nationalists claimed they used A.O. Hume as a 'Lightning Conductor' - a prominent British founder would shield the organization from immediate suppression.

Famous Quotes on Congress

Speaker	Famous Quote / Statement
Lord Dufferin	"Congress represents only a microscopic minority of the people."
Lord Curzon	"Congress is tottering to its fall, and one of my greatest ambitions while in India is to assist it to a peaceful demise."
Bankim Chandra Chatterjee	"The people of Congress are hungry for power/posts."
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	"If we croak once a year like a frog, we will get nothing."
Ashwini Kumar Dutt	"The Congress session is merely a three-day spectacle (tamasha)."
Sir Syed Ahmad Khan	"The Congress movement was neither inspired by the people, nor devised or planned by them."

Dufferin's Changing Tone

- **Initially tolerant:** Hosted a tea party for Congress at 1886 Calcutta session.
- **Later turned hostile:** Called INC an "Institution of Seditiousists" (Rashtradrohiyon ki Sanstha).

ASSOCIATED POLITICAL & SOCIAL ORGANIZATIONS

National Social Conference (1887)

- **Founders:** Mahadev Govind Ranade (M.G. Ranade) & Raghunath Rao
- **First Session:** December 1887, Madras
- **Role:** Social reform cell of the INC - kept social issues separate from political platform.
- **Key Campaigns:** Opposed polygamy, Kulinism, child marriage. Launched the 'Pledge Movement' against child marriage.

Indian Parliamentary Committee (1893)

- **Founded by:** Sir William Wedderburn with W.S. Caine
- **Purpose:** Raise voice in British House of Commons for Indian political reforms.
- **Wedderburn's INC Presidency:** 1889 (Bombay) and 1910 (Allahabad) - served twice.

Welby Commission (1895)

- **Objective:** Investigate 'Drain of Wealth' from India; scrutinize British colonial expenditure.
- **Chair:** Lord Welby
- **Indian Representatives:** Dadabhai Naoroji, Sir William Wedderburn, W.S. Caine
- **Key Presenters (1897):** Gopal Krishna Gokhale & Dinshaw Edulji Wacha - exposed colonial economic exploitation.

THE MODERATE PHASE (1885–1905)

Overview

- **Time Period:** 1885–1905 (also called Udarwadi Charan / Narampanthi phase)
- **Character:** Urban, educated, middle-class - lawyers, engineers, doctors, professors, writers, journalists.
- **Major Failure:** Did not represent common masses - farmers, laborers, women were ignored.

Key Moderate Leaders

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Key Leaders	Dadabhai Naoroji · Surendranath Banerjee · Gopal Krishna Gokhale · Pherozeshah Mehta · Madan Mohan Malaviya · W.C. Bonnerjee
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Methods of the Moderates

- ▶ **Core Approach - '3 Ps':** Prayers, Petitions, and Persuasion. Polite memorandums, speeches, articles.
- ▶ **Annual Sessions:** Congress sessions held yearly; resolutions published in newspapers.
- ▶ **Indian Reform Committee (1887):** Set up in Britain under Dadabhai Naoroji's chairmanship.
- ▶ **British Committee of India (1889):** Formed in London; William Digby as secretary. Started publishing journal 'India' in 1890.

Achievements of the Moderates

- ▶ **Indian Councils Act, 1892:** Most significant direct outcome - slightly broadened political representation.
- ▶ **Welby Commission:** Continuous economic critique (Drain Theory) forced government to constitute the commission.
- ▶ Sent delegations to England periodically to pressure British public and government.

Secular Foundation - 'First' in INC Presidency

First Parsi President	Dadabhai Naoroji (1886)
First Muslim President	Badrudin Tyabji (1887)
First Christian President	George Yule (1888)

Era of Economic Nationalism

NOTE: The Moderate phase is called the 'Era of Economic Nationalism'.

Dadabhai Naoroji	Presented 'Drain of Wealth Theory'
Mahadev Govind Ranade	Educated Indians on importance of modern industrial development
Romesh Chandra Dutt (R.C. Dutt)	Authored 'The Economic History of India'

Key Demands of the Moderates

- ▶ **Administrative/Political:** Indianization of civil services; expansion of legislative councils; more elected Indian members.
- ▶ **Separation of Powers:** Strict separation of judicial from executive powers.
- ▶ **Welfare & Development:** Spread of primary education; technical/higher education; irrigation expansion; agricultural banks.
- ▶ **Self-Government:** Self-government within British Empire on the model of Australia/Canada.
- ▶ **Civil Rights:** Protection of freedom of speech, press, and assembly.

Limitations & Criticisms of the Moderates

- ▶ **No Mass Base:** Confined to narrow educated urban elite. Never reached farmers, laborers, or women.
- ▶ **Paradox of Loyalty:** Combined patriotism with loyalty to Crown (Rajbhakti) - nationalism remained partial.
- ▶ **Misplaced Faith:** Believed British rule was beneficial; forgot imperialists prioritize their own interests.
- ▶ **Ineffective Methods:** Years of 'prayers and petitions' ignored. British understood only the language of pressure, not prayer.
- ▶ **Lack of Sacrifice:** Except Gokhale, leaders were not ready to go to jail or endure hardship.
- ▶ **Failure to Adapt:** Did not evolve strategies with changing times - lost the younger radical generation.

SECOND PHASE OF NATIONAL MOVEMENT**THE EXTREMIST PHASE (1905–1919)**

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Other Names	Garam Dal · Ugrawadi Charan · Garampanthi
Period	1905–1919
Primary Goal	Swaraj - Complete Self-Rule (not just self-govt under British paramountcy)
Core Methods	Boycott · Swadeshi · National Education · Non-Cooperation · Dharnas
Key Slogan (Tilak)	"Swaraj is my birthright, and I shall have it."

Lal-Bal-Pal Trio

Lal	Lala Lajpat Rai
Bal	Bal Gangadhar Tilak
Pal	Bipin Chandra Pal
4th key leader	Aurobindo Ghosh

Causes for Rise of Extremism

- ▶ **Failure of Moderate methods:** Years of prayers & petitions yielded nothing - youth lost faith.
- ▶ **Provocative British policies:** Vernacular Press Act (1878) · Indian Universities Act (1904) · Official Secrets Act (1904) · Partition of Bengal (1905).
- ▶ **Socio-Religious Movements:** Arya Samaj, Ramakrishna Mission instilled cultural pride and rejected Western superiority.
- ▶ **European Invincibility shattered:** Italy defeated by Ethiopia (1895–96) · Russia defeated by Japan (1904–05). Also: nationalist movements in Ireland, China, Turkey inspired Indians.
- ▶ **Economic Ruin vs. Imperial Extravagance:** Devastating famines (1896–1900) while Curzon organized lavish 2nd Delhi Durbar (1903).
- ▶ **Oppressive Arrests:** Sedition charges and harsh imprisonment of Tilak inflamed public anger.
- ▶ **New Ideology born:** "Swaraj will not be achieved by begging, but through struggle."

Ideology & Methods of Extremists

- ▶ **Self-Reliance:** Salvation through India's own struggle - rejected 'Political Mendicancy' (Rajnitik Bhikshavritti).
- ▶ **Three Pillars:** Boycott (foreign goods) · Swadeshi (indigenous goods) · National Education.
- ▶ **Cultural Nationalism (Tilak):** Ganapati Mahotsav (1893) + Shivaji Mahotsav (1895) - religion and culture used as political weapons.
- ▶ **Revolutionary Methods:** Non-cooperation, dharnas, strikes, deliberate violation of unjust laws.
- ▶ **National Education:** Bengal National Council of Education (Sir Gurudas Banerjee) · D.A.V. movement in Punjab.
- ▶ **Grassroots:** Volunteer groups (Samitis), secret societies, local fairs, cooperative organizations.

Limitations of Extremists

- ▶ **Unintended Communalism:** Heavy Hindu religious symbolism (Shivaji, Ganesh festivals) alienated Muslims.
- ▶ **Surat Split (1907):** Ideological clash led to Congress partition - movement weakened, British got opportunity to suppress.

PARTITION OF BENGAL (1905) & SWADESHI MOVEMENT

Partition of Bengal

Viceroy	Lord Curzon (1899–1905)
Official Pretext	Administrative inconvenience - province too large to govern

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Real Motive	Crush Bengal nationalism · Divide Hindus & Muslims · Weaken Congress
Division	Hindu-majority West Bengal vs. Muslim-majority East Bengal + Assam
Capital of new East Bengal	Dhaka
Lt. Governor of Bengal (at time)	Sir Andrew Fraser

Chronology of Key Dates

19 July 1905	Official announcement of Partition (some sources: 20 July)
7 August 1905	Calcutta Town Hall meeting - Swadeshi Movement proclaimed · Boycott Resolution passed
16 October 1905	Partition came into effect - observed as Day of Mourning (Shok Divas). People fasted, sang Vande Mataram, tied Rakhis as symbol of unity.
1905 Banaras Session	INC officially endorsed Swadeshi and Boycott (presided by G.K. Gokhale)
December 12, 1911	Partition CANCELLED at Delhi Durbar (Lord Hardinge II)

Regional Leaders of Swadeshi Movement

Region	Leader(s)	Key Detail
Bengal	Aurobindo Ghosh · Barindra Kumar Ghosh	Anushilan Samiti founded here
Bombay & Pune	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Dubbed 'Father of Indian Unrest' by British journalist Valentine Chirol
Punjab & UP	Lala Lajpat Rai · Ajit Singh	
Delhi	Syed Haider Raza	
Madras Presidency	V.O. Chidambaram Pillai · Subramania Iyer · P. Anand Charlu · T.M. Nair	
Barisal	Ashwini Kumar Dutt	Founded 'Swadesh Bandhav Samiti'

Impact & Cultural Renaissance of Swadeshi

- ▶ **Scope expanded:** Boycott extended to government schools, courts, titles, government jobs.
- ▶ **Anushilan Samiti:** First major revolutionary org in Bengal - Barindra Kumar Ghosh & Bhupendra Nath Dutt.
- ▶ **Swadesh Bandhav Samiti:** Ashwini Kumar Dutt, Barisal - mass mobilization.
- ▶ **Atmashakti (Self-Reliance):** Greatest achievement of the movement.
- ▶ **Literature:** Rabindranath Tagore wrote 'Amar Sonar Bangla' - sung in protest marches. Became Bangladesh's National Anthem (1971).
- ▶ **National Council of Education (Aug 1906):** Literary, scientific, technical education under indigenous control.
- ▶ **Industry:** Acharya Prafulla Chandra Ray → 'Bengal Chemical Swadeshi Stores'. Revived handlooms, silk, leather.
- ▶ **Art:** Abanindranath Tagore broke Western dominance - drew from Mughal, Swadeshi & Ajanta traditions.
- ▶ **Science:** Jagadish Chandra Bose & Prafulla Chandra Ray achievements boosted national pride.
- ▶ **Women Participation:** FIRST TIME in Indian history women stepped out of homes to join a political movement.

NOTE: Major Limitation: Movement failed to mobilize peasantry and Muslim masses. Heavy Hindu ritual emphasis alienated minority communities - majority of Bengali Muslims kept distance.

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NOTE: Tagore translated Jana Gana Mana (National Anthem) from Bengali to English - February 1919, at Besant Theosophical College, Madanapalle, Andhra Pradesh.

NOTE: British journalist Henry Wood Nevinson documented the Swadeshi movement in his 1908 book 'The New Spirit in India'.

ESTABLISHMENT OF MUSLIM LEAGUE (1906)

Founded	December 30, 1906
Place	Dhaka
Key Founders	Aga Khan · Nawab of Dhaka (Salimullah) · Mohsin-ul-Mulk
'Founding Father'	Nawab Salimullah
First President	Aga Khan
Shimla Deputation (Oct 1906)	Delegation led by Aga Khan met Viceroy Lord Minto - pledged loyalty, demanded separate electorates
Separate Electorate formally demanded	Amritsar Session (1908) - accepted by British via Morley-Minto Reforms (1909)

Three Core Objectives of Muslim League

- ▶ Foster loyalty among Muslims toward the British government.
- ▶ Protect and advance the political rights and interests of Indian Muslims.
- ▶ Prevent the rise of hostility among Muslims toward other communities.

KEY CONGRESS SESSIONS (1906 & 1907)

Calcutta Session (1906)

- ▶ **Presidential compromise:** Dispute between Moderates & Extremists resolved by choosing Dadabhai Naoroji ('Grand Old Man').
- ▶ **Four Historic Resolutions:** Swadeshi · Boycott · National Education · Self-Government - all passed under Extremist pressure.
- ▶ **First use of 'Swaraj':** Dadabhai Naoroji used 'Swaraj' from Congress platform for the FIRST TIME in history.

Surat Session (1907) - The Great Split

Outcome	First partition / split of the Indian National Congress
President clash	Extremists: Lala Lajpat Rai / Tilak · Moderates: Rash Behari Ghosh - Moderates won
Strategy clash	Moderates: confine Swadeshi to Bengal · Extremists: expand nationwide + full non-cooperation
Prince of Wales (1905)	Extremists: oppose welcome · Moderates: support
Venue clash	Extremists: Nagpur · Moderates: deliberately chose Surat (their stronghold)
Aftermath (April 1908)	Moderates held Allahabad convention - new Congress constitution drafted, approved at 1908 Madras Session (Rash Behari Ghosh)

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DELHI DURBARS & DELHI CONSPIRACY CASE

Durbar	Viceroy / Key Person	Key Event / Significance
1st Delhi Durbar (1877)	Lord Lytton	Queen Victoria proclaimed Empress of India ('Kaiser-i-Hind'). Held during severe South India famine - massive backlash for wasteful spending.
2nd Delhi Durbar (1903)	Lord Curzon	Coronation of King Edward VII. Huge imperial spectacle - enormous waste of Indian wealth.
3rd Delhi Durbar (1911) - Dec 12	Lord Hardinge II · King George V + Queen Mary	Decisions (1) Partition of Bengal CANCELLED. (2) Capital shifted Calcutta → Delhi. Orissa & Bihar separated from Bengal. Assam + Sylhet → separate province.

Delhi Conspiracy Case (1912)

Date	December 23, 1912
Incident	Bomb thrown at Viceroy Lord Hardinge's elephant carriage in Chandni Chowk during the Delhi capital-shift procession - Hardinge severely injured
Masterminds	Rash Behari Bose
Executioners	Basant Kumar Biswas · Amir Chand · Awadh Bihari · Bal Mukund
Outcome	All four arrested, tried under 'Delhi Conspiracy Case', sentenced to death by hanging Rash Behari Bose: Planned Delhi Conspiracy (Hardinge assassination attempt); escaped to Japan (1915).

REVOLUTIONARY ORGANISATIONS

India House, London (1905)

Founder	Shyamji Krishna Varma (1857–1930) - born in Mandvi, Kutch, Gujarat
Founded	1905, London
Established	Indian Home Rule Society (IHRS) + 'India House'
Role	Central hub for Indian revolutionaries in Britain
Key Members	P.M. Bapat · Virendranath Chattopadhyay · Lala Hardayal · Bhai Parmanand · Madan Lal Dhingra · Madam Bhikaji Cama · Veer Savarkar
Famous Assassination (1909)	Madan Lal Dhingra killed British official William Curzon Wylie in London → arrested and hanged
Shyamji's journal	'The Indian Sociologist' (monthly) · Also 1st President of Bombay Arya Samaj · Died in Geneva (1930)

Ghadar Party (1913)

Founded	November 1, 1913
Founder	Lala Hardayal

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Headquarters	San Francisco, California, USA
Journal	'Ghadar' (weekly) - 1st issue: Nov 1, 1913, in Urdu; later in multiple Indian languages
Meaning of 'Ghadar'	Rebellion / Mutiny
Grassroots base	Punjabi farmers and ex-soldiers in USA & Canada
Unique feature	Explicitly advocated Guerrilla Warfare - unlike other contemporary organizations
Key Leaders	Ram Chandra · Barkatullah · Sohan Singh Bhakna · Kartar Singh Sarabha · Bhai Parmanand · Bhagwan Singh · Pandit Kashi Ram · Ramdas Puri
WWI activities	Virendranath Chattopadhyay active in Berlin since 1909. Lala Hardayal formed 'Indian Independence Committee' in Berlin after WWI.
Provisional Govt, Kabul (Dec 1915)	President: Raja Mahendra Pratap Singh · PM: Mohammad Barkatullah - First India-in-Exile government

Komagata Maru Incident (1914)

Issue	Canada's discriminatory immigration laws against Indians
Chartered by	Gurdit Singh (Singapore-based Indian merchant)
Ship	Komagata Maru (Japanese ship)
Passengers	~376 passengers from Southeast Asia → heading to Vancouver
Shore Committee (Canada)	Husain Rahim · Balwant Singh · Sohan Lal Pathak - legal support
Outcome	Ship forced to return → Budge Budge port (Calcutta) · Clashes with police → ~18 passengers killed, rest jailed
Character	Secular - majority Sikh leaders but movement fundamentally non-communal
Significance	Inspired revolutionaries to adopt an international perspective against British imperialism

HOME RULE LEAGUE MOVEMENT (1916)

- **Inspiration:** Modeled on Irish Home Rule Movement.
- **Joint Founders:** Bal Gangadhar Tilak + Annie Besant (territory divided to avoid organizational clash).
- **Famous Slogan:** "Swaraj is my birthright, and I shall have it." - Tilak, during this movement.

Tilak's Home Rule League

Launched	April 1916 - provincial conference at Belgaum
Operational HQ	Pune
Territory	Karnataka · Maharashtra (excl. Bombay city) · Central Provinces · Berar

Annie Besant's Home Rule League

Launched	September 1916, Adyar (Madras)
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Territory	Rest of India (all areas not assigned to Tilak)
Key Associates	George Arundale (secretary) · C.P. Ramaswamy Aiyer · B.P. Wadia
Arrested (June 1917)	Annie Besant · George Arundale · B.P. Wadia
Protest against arrests	S. Subramania Iyer returned his 'Knighthood' (title of Sir) to British
Prominent members who joined	Motilal Nehru · Bhulabhai Desai · Tej Bahadur Sapru · Madan Mohan Malaviya · Lala Lajpat Rai · M.A. Jinnah · Jawaharlal Nehru
Historic milestone	Besant elected FIRST WOMAN PRESIDENT of INC - Calcutta Session, 1917
Name change (1920)	'All India Home Rule League' renamed to 'Swaraj Sabha'

Person / Authority	Newspaper/ journal
Annie Besant	<i>New India (daily newspaper) · Commonweal (weekly journal)</i>
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	<i>Maratha (English) · Kesari (Marathi)</i>

Achievements of Home Rule Movement

- **Mass Awakening:** Established political importance of the common masses alongside the educated elite.
- **New Generation:** Created energized, militant nationalist youth ready for direct action.
- **Montagu Declaration (August 1917):** Pressure from Home Rule Leagues forced British to promise 'responsible government' → led directly to Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919).
- **Lucknow Reunion (1916):** Tilak & Besant brokered Moderate-Extremist reunion after 9-year Surat split.
- **Local Committees:** First time local committees established as essential for an all-India movement (previously only in Bengal during Swadeshi).

LUCKNOW SESSION & LUCKNOW PACT (1916)

Session	INC Annual Session, Lucknow, 1916
President	Ambika Charan Majumdar
Why Historic	Two events: (1) Moderate-Extremist REUNION after 9 years · (2) Lucknow Pact - Congress & Muslim League agreement

Event 1 - Reunion of Moderates & Extremists

- After 9-year separation post-Surat (1907), Extremists re-entered Congress.
- Made possible by persistent efforts of Annie Besant and Tilak.

Event 2 - The Lucknow Pact (Congress–League Scheme)

- **Parties:** Indian National Congress + All India Muslim League.
- **Critical Concession:** Congress officially ACCEPTED Muslim League's demand for Separate Communal Electorate (Prithak Sampradayik Nirvachan Mandal) - major historical shift in Congress policy.

Who OPPOSED the Pact?	Madan Mohan Malaviya - strongly opposed, especially concession on separate electorates
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How long did unity last?	Until suspension of Non-Cooperation Movement (1922) - pact effectively broke down after that
Long-term impact	Conceding separate electorates had major communal consequences for the future of Indian politics

THE LAST PHASE OF THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT

The Gandhian Phase - Overview (1919–1947)

- **Third and final phase** of the freedom struggle - also called the '**Gandhian Era**'.
- **Transformation:** Independence movement became a genuine **mass struggle** (Jan-Sangharsh) for the first time.
- **Three great movements:** Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22) → Civil Disobedience Movement (1930) → Quit India Movement (1942).
- **Dark side:** Hindu-Muslim tensions reached their peak → Muslim League under Jinnah demanded Pakistan in 1940.

GANDHI: SOUTH AFRICA & RETURN TO INDIA

Gandhi in South Africa (1893–1914)

- **Arrived:** Durban, South Africa, 1892–93 - to fight a lawsuit for Dada Abdullah (Indian Muslim merchant). Won the case.
- **Racial discrimination:** Threw off a first-class train at **Pietermaritzburg** station - became a major catalyst for his activism.
- **Asiatic Registration Act:** Every Indian had to carry a registration certificate at all times - Gandhi fiercely opposed it.
- **Institutions founded:** Natal Indian Congress (1894); Phoenix Settlement/Ashram (1904, near Durban); Tolstoy Farm (with German architect Hermann Kallenbach).
- **Journalism:** *Indian Opinion* newspaper - first editor: **Mansukhlal Hiralal Nazar**.
- **Book:** *Hind Swaraj* (1909) - criticised Western materialism; called British Parliament 'sterile woman and a prostitute'. Advocated complete self-reliance.
- **Success:** Most discriminatory racial laws repealed by 1914 due to Gandhi's relentless movements.
- **Girmitiya System:** Gandhi played a monumental role in abolishing Indentured (*Girmitiya*) Labour - described by historian Hugh Tinker as a '*New System of Slavery*'.

Gandhi's Return to India (January 1915)

- **Political Guru:** Accepted Gopal Krishna Gokhale as his political guru after return.
- **'Recruiting Sergeant':** Encouraged Indians to join the British Army in WWI (at Lord Chelmsford's War Conference - on condition India would receive autonomy after the war).
- **Kaiser-i-Hind title (1915):** Awarded by the British for humanitarian work (medical services) during the Boer War (1899–1902) in South Africa.
- **Sabarmati Ashram:** Established on the banks of the Sabarmati River, Gujarat - centre for constructive national work.
- **Rise to leadership:** Through three early regional successes - Champaran Satyagraha, Ahmedabad Mill Strike, and Kheda Satyagraha.

Gandhi's Core Philosophy

- **John Ruskin - *Unto This Last*:** Inspired the concept of **Sarvodaya** (universal upliftment / progress of all).
- **Henry David Thoreau:** Agreed with: "*That government is best which governs least*" - believed in radical decentralisation of power.
- **Trusteeship Principle:** To ensure economic justice and combat inequality - rich are trustees of wealth, not owners.
- **Ahimsa:** Non-violence in thought, word, and deed.
- **Sarva Dharma Sambhava:** Equal respect for all religions; fundamental essence of all religions is the same.
- **Purity of means and ends:** Means and ends are inextricably linked - corrupt means cannot produce a noble end.

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GANDHI'S EARLY SATYAGRAHAS IN INDIA**Champaran Satyagraha (1917) - First Satyagraha in India**

- **Location:** Champaran district, Bihar - 1917.
- **Tinkathia System:** European planters forced farmers to cultivate indigo on **3/20th of their total landholdings** - mandatory and exploitative.
- **Trigger:** Germany invented synthetic dyes → natural indigo demand collapsed → planters shut factories → illegally hiked rents and imposed unlawful taxes called '**Abwab**'.
- **Catalyst:** Local farmer **Rajkumar Shukla** personally met Gandhi and brought him to Champaran - 1917.
- **Outcome:** Government forced to form an Inquiry Commission - made Gandhi a member. Tinkathia system **abolished**; planters had to refund illegally extorted money.
- **Title 'Mahatma':** Bestowed on Gandhi by **Rabindranath Tagore** for the first time, after Champaran's success.
- **Key associates:** Braj Kishore Prasad, Rajendra Prasad, Mahadev Desai, Narhari Parikh, J.B. Kripalani, Anugrah Narayan Sinha, Mazharul Haq

Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918) - First Hunger Strike

- **Issue:** Dispute over continuation of 'Plague Bonus' - mill owners wanted to end it; workers demanded it continue due to WWI inflation.
- **Gandhi's demand:** 35% wage increase was justified; owners offered only 20% and threatened dismissal.
- **First hunger strike:** Gandhi undertook his first-ever hunger strike in India to strengthen workers' resolve.
- **Outcome:** Tribunal awarded the 35% bonus.
- **Key associate:** **Anusuya Behn** - sister of mill owner Ambalal Sarabhai.

Kheda Satyagraha (1918) - First Non-Cooperation

- **Issue:** Severe famine destroyed crops in Kheda, Gujarat - British continued to collect land revenue (Lagaan). Farmers demanded complete waiver.
- **Key leaders:** **Vallabhbhai Patel** and Indulal Yagnik stood with Gandhi.
- **Gujarat Sabha:** Played significant role; Gandhi was its president that year.
- **Outcome:** Government secretly directed that revenue be collected only from those able to pay - Gandhi called off the movement.

ROWLATT ACT & JALLIANWALA BAGH MASSACRE (1919)**The Rowlatt Act (1919)**

- **Sedition Committee (1917):** Formed under **Sir Sidney Rowlatt** to suppress revolutionary activities.
- **Act:** 'The Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act, 1919' - magistrate could imprison anyone on **mere suspicion, without trial**.
- **Nicknamed:** '*No Vakil, No Appeal, No Dalil*' (No Lawyer, No Appeal, No Argument). Indians called it the '**Black Act**'.
- **Gandhi's response:** Formed **Satyagraha Sabha**; called nationwide strike and Satyagraha on April 6, 1919.
- **Gandhi arrested:** April 9, 1919 (some sources: April 8).

Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (April 13, 1919)

- **Trigger:** Government arrested two popular Punjab leaders - **Dr. Satyapal** and **Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew** (April 9/10, 1919).
- **Gathering:** Massive public protest organised on **Baisakhi, April 13, 1919** at Jallianwala Bagh, Amritsar.
- **Massacre:** **General Dyer** ordered troops to open fire on the unarmed crowd without warning.
- **Death toll:** Official figure - **379 killed**; actual number vastly higher.
- **Movement withdrawn:** Gandhi withdrew Rowlatt Satyagraha on April 18, fearing nationwide violence.

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- Rabindranath Tagore - renounced his Knighthood (title of 'Sir') in protest
- Shankaran Nair - resigned from Viceroy's Executive Council
- Gandhi - returned his Kaiser-i-Hind medal
- Dinbandhu C.F. Andrews - called the massacre 'deliberate murder'
- Congress inquiry committee: Madan Mohan Malaviya (Chairman); members - Motilal Nehru, Gandhi, C.R. Das, Abbas Tyabji, M.R. Jayakar
- Hunter Commission (British): Indian members - Chimanlal Setalvad, Sultan Ahmad, Jagat Narayan
- British passed Indemnity Bill BEFORE Hunter Commission submitted report - to protect guilty officers
- General Dyer dismissed but given 'Sword of Honour' + financial purse (30,000 Pounds)
- Sardar Udham Singh - shot dead Michael O'Dwyer (Lt. Governor of Punjab during 1919) at Caxton Hall, London, March 1940; hanged at Pentonville Jail, July 31, 1940

KHILAFAT MOVEMENT & NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT

Khilafat Movement (1919–1924)

- **Issue:** Allied Powers imposed **Treaty of Sèvres** on Turkey after WWI - partitioned the nation and abolished the Khalifa (Caliph), the spiritual leader of Muslim world.
- **Khilafat Committee (1919):** Formed under **Ali Brothers (Muhammad Ali + Shaukat Ali)**, Maulana Azad, Hakim Ajmal Khan, Hasrat Mohani.
- **Delhi Conference (Nov 1919):** All India Khilafat Conference - **Gandhi elected to preside**. He saw it as a once-in-a-century opportunity for Hindu-Muslim unity.
- **Allahabad (June 1920):** Khilafat Committee granted Gandhi authority to launch Non-Cooperation Movement.
- **End:** 1924 - new Turkish leader **Mustafa Kemal Pasha (Atatürk)** abolished the post of Khalifa - Khilafat issue dissolved naturally.

Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922)

- **Official launch:** August 1, 1920 - by Gandhi. **Lokmanya Tilak died on this very day.**
- **Nagpur Session (Dec 1920):** Resolution formally ratified. Two historic decisions:
 - Goal changed: 'Self-government within British Empire' → 'SWARAJ' (whether within or outside the Empire) - first time Congress embraced direct mass struggle outside constitutional limits.
 - Constructive programmes adopted: Open membership to all adults; All India CWC established; Provincial Congress Committees reorganised on linguistic basis; promote Charkha, Khadi, Hindi language.
- **Vijayawada Session (March 1921):** Target of enrolling 1 Crore members set to strengthen the grassroots reach of the Congress.
- **The Madurai Decision (September 1921):** On 22nd September at Madurai, Gandhi permanently abandoned the dhoti-kurta and adopted the loincloth (*langoti*) to fully identify with the poorest Indians.

Key Activities

- **Boycott of foreign cloth:** Public bonfires of foreign clothes. Imports dropped by half.
- National schools & colleges set up by: Acharya Narendra Dev, C.R. Das, Lala Lajpat Rai, Zakir Husain, Subhas Chandra Bose.
- **Lawyers who gave up practice:** Motilal Nehru, C.R. Das, C. Rajagopalachari, Saifuddin Kitchlew, Vallabhbhai Patel, Asaf Ali, T. Prakasam, Rajendra Prasad.
- **Tilak Swaraj Fund:** Set up in Tilak's memory to finance the movement - raised a massive sum quickly.
- **Associated movements:** Akali Movement (Punjab Gurdwaras); Assam tea garden strikes; Midnapore peasants (Bengal) refused taxes; Moplah Rebellion (Malabar); Andhra tribals defied forest laws.

Chauri Chaura & Suspension

- **February 1, 1922:** Gandhi gave ultimatum - release political prisoners + lift press controls within 7 days or he would launch Mass Civil Disobedience from Bardoli.

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- **February 5, 1922:** At **Chauri Chaura, Gorakhpur**, police fired on a Congress–Khilafat procession. Mob retaliated - chased police into the station and **burnt it; 22 policemen killed** (21 constables + 1 inspector).
- **Suspension:** Gandhi called CWC meeting at Bardoli → movement **officially terminated February 12, 1922**.
- **Critics of withdrawal:** Motilal Nehru, C.R. Das, Jawaharlal Nehru, Subhas Chandra Bose - all heavily criticised Gandhi's unilateral decision.
- **Gandhi arrested:** March 10, 1922. Tried by Session Judge **Broomfield**, Ahmedabad (March 18, 1922) → sentenced to **6 years**. Released prematurely February 5, 1924 (failing health).

NOTE

- Significance: Despite abrupt withdrawal, Non-Cooperation Movement transformed independence struggle into a genuine mass movement. Eliminated fear of British prisons; Indians realised their collective strength for the first time.

SWARAJ PARTY & NEW FORCES (1922–1927)**Birth of the Swaraj Party (1923)**

- **Idea ('Council Entry'):** Motilal Nehru + C.R. Das - enter legislative councils and **disrupt British administration from within**.
- **Gaya Session (1922):** Council Entry proposal voted down by orthodox Gandhians.
- **Formation:** C.R. Das resigned from Congress presidency → formed '**Congress-Khilafat Swaraj Party**' (later: Swaraj Party) - January 1923 (NCERT: December 1922).
- **Leadership:** C.R. Das = President | Motilal Nehru = General Secretary.
- **Muhammad Ali Jinnah** extended support to Swaraj Party in Central Legislative Assembly.

Pro-Changers	No-Changers
Supported council entry • C.R. Das, Motilal Nehru • Vithalbhai Patel • Kasturi Ranga, Hakim Ajmal Khan	Opposed council entry • C. Rajagopalachari • S. Srinivasa Iyengar • M.A. Ansari, Dr. Rajendra Prasad

- **Delhi Special Session (Sep 1923):** Presided by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad - Congress officially recognised Swaraj Party, permitted elections. Split averted.
- **November 1923 elections:** Swarajists won **42 out of 101 elected seats** in Central Legislative Assembly. Clear majority in Central Provinces; largest party in Bengal, and achieved satisfactory success in Bombay and Uttar Pradesh. However, they failed to achieve desired results in Madras and Punjab due to the prevailing waves of communalism and casteism.

Key Achievements of Swarajists

- **Muddiman Committee (1924):** Forced government to investigate the working of the dyarchy system under the Government of India Act 1919
- **Municipal victories (1923–24):** C.R. Das = Mayor, Calcutta | Vithalbhai Patel = Mayor, Ahmedabad | Rajendra Prasad = Mayor, Patna | Jawaharlal Nehru = Mayor, Allahabad.
- **1925 - Crowning achievement:** **Vithalbhai Patel** elected **President (Speaker) of Central Legislative Assembly**.

Decline of Swaraj Party

- **June 1925:** C.R. Das died - devastating blow. C.R. Das was the political guru of Subhas Chandra Bose.
- Defeated in November 1926 elections.
- 1930 - Resigned from legislatures after Lahore Session (Poorna Swaraj) and Civil Disobedience Movement.

Gandhi-Das Pact (November 1924)

- Joint statement by Gandhi, C.R. Das, and Motilal Nehru.
- **Key provisions:** Swaraj Party formally recognised as integral part of Congress; Non-Cooperation officially suspended; Gandhi entrusted with organising '**All India Spinners Association**' (Charkha + Khadi).
- **Belgaum Session (December 1924):** Pact ratified. **First and ONLY time Gandhi presided over an INC session.**

Other Parties & Movements (1919–1927)

- **Indian Liberal Federation (1919):** Formed by Surendranath Banerjee + Tej Bahadur Sapru + M.R. Jayakar + V.S. Srinivasa Sastri - broke away from INC; cooperated with government; supported Montagu Report 1918.
- **All India Muslim League (1924):** Re-emerged after Khilafat collapse - Jinnah rose as undisputed leader.
- **Hindu Mahasabha:** Madan Mohan Malaviya laid groundwork at 1915 Kumbh Mela, Haridwar. First session chaired by Maharaja of Kasim Bazar. Became highly active after Malaviya assumed presidency post December 1924.
- **Akali Dal:** Freed Sikh Gurdwaras from corrupt Mahants - **Gurdwara Act 1925** passed → established **SGPC** (Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee).
- **Nagpur Flag Satyagraha (1923):** Against British order restricting hoisting of the Congress National Flag.
- **Butler Committee (1927):** Sir Harcourt Butler - to examine relationship between British Paramount Power and Native Princely States.

COMMUNIST & REVOLUTIONARY MOVEMENTS**Rise of Communism in India**

- **Inspiration:** Russian Revolution (1917) deeply inspired Indian youth. Left Wing emerged within Congress - championed by Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhas Chandra Bose.
- **CPI in Tashkent (1920):** Communist Party of India established at Tashkent (Uzbekistan) - by **M.N. Roy (Manabendra Nath Roy)**, Abani Mukherji, Muhammad Ali, Muhammad Shafiq - after 2nd Comintern session in Russia.
- **CPI in Kanpur (1924):** Satyabhakta founded 'Indian Communist Party' - demand for Complete Swaraj + collective ownership of means of production.
- **CPI in Bombay (Dec 1925):** Singaravelu Chettiar organised scattered communist groups - HQ shifted Kanpur → Bombay.
- **Historic first:** CPI was the **first political party to officially demand 'Complete Independence' (Poorna Swaraj)** for India.

Three Conspiracy Cases (British Crackdown)

Case	Year	Key Details
Peshawar Conspiracy Case	1922–27	Against communists trying to enter India from Moscow to spread revolutionary ideas
Kanpur Conspiracy Case	1924	S.A. Dange, Muzaffar Ahmad, Shaukat Usmani, Nalini Gupta - arrested; 'Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case'
Meerut Conspiracy Case	1929–33	March 20, 1929: 32 communists arrested. INC defended them - formed Central Defence Committee; blocked 'Public Safety Bill' in Assembly. Global support: Albert Einstein, H.G. Wells, Harold Laski, Franklin D. Roosevelt

NOTE

- Post-1934: CPI declared illegal by British government
- 1935: Party reorganised - P.C. Joshi appointed General Secretary of CPI

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- Saumyendranath Tagore broke away → founded 'Revolutionary Communist Party of India' (RCPI) - 1934
- Communists called Gandhi 'leader of the Bourgeoisie'

Hindustan Republican Association - HRA (1924)

- **Founded:** Kanpur Conference, October 1924 - by Sachindranath Sanyal, Yogesh Chatterjee, Ramprasad Bismil + Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Chandrashekhar Azad, Bhagwati Charan Vohra, Shiv Verma.
- **Three Ideals:** (1) Armed revolution over Gandhi's non-violent policies; (2) Complete Independence (Poorna Swaraj); (3) Replace British rule with '**United States of India**' - a federal socialist republic.

Kakori Train Robbery (August 9, 1925)

- **Target:** Looted government treasury from the 8-Down train near **Kakori village, Saharanpur-Lucknow railway line**
- **Sentenced to death - 4 leaders:** Ramprasad Bismil (Gorakhpur jail) | Ashfaqulla Khan (Faizabad jail) | Roshan Singh (Naini jail, Allahabad) | Rajendra Lahiri (Gonda jail).
- Ramprasad Bismil, offered milk before execution: "Now I will only drink my mother's milk."
- **17 long sentences + 4 life imprisonments.** Chandrashekhar Azad escaped.
- **Defence committee:** Chaired by **Govind Ballabh Pant**; members: Mohanlal Saxena, Chandra Bhanu Gupta, Gopinath Srivastava. Prosecutor for British: Jagat Narayan Mulla.

Hindustan Socialist Republican Association - HSRA (1928)

- **Founded:** 1928 at **Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi** - reorganised by surviving members under Chandrashekhar Azad.
- **Objective:** Establish a **Socialist Republican State** in India.
- **Key leaders:** Chandrashekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru, Bhagwati Charan Vohra, Shiv Verma, Vijay Kumar Sinha, Jaidev Kapoor.

Assassination of Saunders (December 17, 1928)

- Lala Lajpat Rai led peaceful protest against Simon Commission in Lahore (October 30, 1928) → mercilessly beaten in police lathi charge ordered by Superintendent of Police, James A. Scott. Lajpat Rai died November 17, 1928.
- December 17, 1928 - **Bhagat Singh, Chandrashekhar Azad, and Rajguru** shot and killed Saunders near Lahore police station.
- The revolutionaries actually intended to assassinate **James A. Scott** to avenge Lajpat Rai's death, but they mistakenly identified and killed Saunders instead.

Central Legislative Assembly Bombing (April 8, 1929)

- **Who:** Bhagat Singh + Batukeshwar Dutt.
- **Target:** Trade Dispute Bill + Public Safety Bill being debated - aimed at crushing workers' rights.
- **Intent:** NOT to kill - threw **harmless smoke bombs** into empty space. Courted arrest voluntarily.
- **Message:** "It takes a loud voice to make the deaf hear."

Lahore Conspiracy Case (1929) - Final Sacrifice

- **Hunger strike in jail:** Demanded treatment as Political Prisoners. **Jatindra Nath Das (Jatin Das)** died after **64 days** of fasting.
- **March 23, 1931:** Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru hanged.
- **February 27, 1931:** Chandrashekhar Azad died fighting police at **Alfred Park, Allahabad**. End of HSRA's organised activities in Northern India.

NOTE

- Naujawan Bharat Sabha (1926): Founded by Bhagat Singh in Lahore - inspired by Mazzini's 'Young Italy'. Co-founders: Yashpal and Chhabil Das.

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- Lala Lajpat Rai (Sher-e-Punjab): Traveled to America during WWI | Authored biographies of Mazzini, Garibaldi, Shivaji, Lord Krishna | First President of AITUC | Member of Central Legislative Assembly
- Madam Bhikaji Cama: 'Mother of the Indian Revolution' - first to hoist an early version of the Indian National Flag on foreign soil; International Socialist Conference, Stuttgart, Germany, 22 August 1907.
- Chittagong Armoury Raid (April 18, 1930): Led by Surya Sen ('Master Da'); IRA (Indian Republican Army) - proclaimed Provisional Revolutionary Government. Women: Pritilata Waddadar (martyrdom, Pahartali raid), Kalpana Dutt (life imprisonment), Suniti Chaudhary + Shanti Ghosh (shot DM Comilla, Dec 1931), Bina Das (fired at Governor, Calcutta University convocation, Feb 1932). Surya Sen arrested Feb 16, 1933; hanged Jan 12, 1934.

SIMON COMMISSION, NEHRU REPORT & POORNA SWARAJ

Simon Commission (1927–1928)

- **Background:** Government of India Act 1919 mandated a review commission after 10 years (due 1929). Conservative Party appointed it early - **November 1927** - fearing Labour Party election victory. Appointed by **Lord Birkenhead** (Secretary of State for India).
- **Chairman: Sir John Simon. All 7 members were British** - no Indian included. Called '**White Commission**'.
- Member trivia: **Clement Attlee** (later PM during India's independence) was a member.

Boycott of Simon Commission

- **Madras Session (December 1927):** Presided by Dr. M.A. Ansari - unanimous resolution to boycott "at every stage and in every form."
- **Supporters of boycott:** Liberal Federation, Hindu Mahasabha, Kisan Mazdoor Party, Jinnah faction of Muslim League.
- **Protests:** Nationwide hartals, black flags, slogan "**Simon Go Back**".

NOTE

- Who DID NOT boycott Simon Commission (supported it): Unionist Party (Punjab), Justice Party (South India), Muhammad Shafi faction of Muslim League, All India Achhut Association, Central Sikh Sangh
- Simon Commission submitted final report: May 1930 → basis for Round Table Conferences → framework for Government of India Act, 1935

Nehru Report (1928)

- **Challenge by Lord Birkenhead:** Dared Indians to draft a mutually acceptable constitution.
- **First All Parties Conference:** Delhi, February 1928.
- **Committee:** 8-member committee under **Motilal Nehru** - formed at Second All Parties Conference, Bombay, May 1928.
- **Members:** Tej Bahadur Sapru, Subhas Chandra Bose, M.S. Aney, Mangal Singh, Ali Imam, G.R. Pradhan, Shoaib Qureshi.
- **Report submitted:** August 1928.

Key Recommendations of Nehru Report

- **Dominion Status** (not complete independence) - biggest internal controversy.
- **Federal structure:** bicameral legislature; central ministry responsible to legislature.
- **Residual powers:** Vested in the **Centre** (Jinnah demanded provinces - key clash).
- **Sindh** to be separated from Bombay. NWFP to get same status as other provinces.
- **Rejected Separate Electorates:** Proposed Joint Electorates with reserved seats for minorities (not in Muslim-majority provinces like Punjab and Bengal).
- **Universal Adult Suffrage; Fundamental Rights; Women's equal rights; separation of religion from state; linguistic provinces.**
- **Governor-General** to be merely a constitutional head.

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Internal Dissent - All India Independence League (1928)

- Subhas Chandra Bose, Jawaharlal Nehru, Satyamurti opposed Dominion Status - demanded **Complete Independence (Poorna Swaraj)**.
- Deep rift at Calcutta Session 1928. Bose, Nehru, Satyamurti formed '**All India Independence League**' - 1928.

Muslim Reactions - Jinnah's Fourteen Points (March 1929)

- **Context:** Nehru Report rejected Muslim League's demand for separate electorates. Jinnah's December 1928 proposals voted down → League split from All Parties Conference.
- **Significance:** Historians mark this as the moment communalism - initially sown by the British - became a massive destructive force in Indian politics.

Most Important of Jinnah's 14 Points

- **Federal constitution with Residual Powers in Provinces** (opposite of Nehru Report).
- **Separate Electorates** to continue.
- **Minimum 1/3 seats** for Muslims in Central Legislature.
- **No bill if 3/4 members** of a community oppose it (communal veto).
- **Sindh** to be separated; **NWFP** reforms.
- No territorial changes in Bengal, Punjab, NWFP that would reduce their Muslim-majority status.

Lahore Session - Poorna Swaraj (December 1929)

- **President:** Jawaharlal Nehru.
- **Nehru Report declared lapsed;** 'Swaraj' in Congress constitution henceforth means '**Poorna Swaraj**' (**Complete Independence**).
- **December 31, 1929 - midnight:** Nehru hoisted the Tricolour on the banks of **River Ravi** amidst slogans of 'Inquilab Zindabad', 'Vande Mataram', 'Poorna Swaraj'.
- **January 26, 1930:** Declared first '**Poorna Swaraj Day**' (**Independence Day**) - to be celebrated annually on this date. (Reason January 26 was chosen as Republic Day in 1950.)
- **CWC authorised Gandhi** to launch Civil Disobedience Movement.

KEY QUOTE

- Jawaharlal Nehru at Lahore: "I am a socialist and a republican, and I am no believer in kings and princes, or in the order which produces the modern kings of industry."

CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT (1930)**Gandhi's 11-Point Demands (January 31, 1930)**

- Final ultimatum to Viceroy Lord Irwin + PM Ramsay MacDonald. Presented through journal *Young India*.
- Key demands: Reduce military + civil service salaries by **50%**; Liquor Ban; release political prisoners; lower rupee-sterling ratio to **1 shilling 4 pence**; tariff protection for Indian textiles; reduce land revenue by **50%**; **abolish Salt Tax**.
- British government rejected all demands.
- CWC meeting at Sabarmati, February 14, 1930 - formally decided to launch Civil Disobedience Movement.

KEY QUOTE

- Gandhi to Viceroy Irwin: "I asked for bread and in return received a stone. The days of waiting are now over."

Dandi March - Salt Satyagraha

- **March 12, 1930:** Gandhi + **78 chosen followers** began march from **Sabarmati Ashram, Ahmedabad**.

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- **April 5, 1930:** Arrived at coastal village of **Dandi, Gujarat** after 24 days - **240 miles (≈375 km)**.
- **April 6, 1930:** Gandhi picked up a handful of salt - **Salt Law broken**. Civil Disobedience Movement officially launched.
- **Subhas Chandra Bose:** Compared Dandi March to Napoleon's march from Elba to Paris and Mussolini's 'March on Rome'.
- **Government crackdown:** Declared INC and all its committees **illegal organisations**.
- **TIME Magazine (1930):** Named Mahatma Gandhi 'Man of the Year'.

Regional Spread of Civil Disobedience

Region	Leader	Form of Protest
Tamil Nadu	C. Rajagopalachari	Salt march: Trichinopoly → Vedaranyam
Malabar (Kerala)	K. Kelappan (hero of Vaikom Satyagraha)	Salt march: Calicut → Payyanur
Andhra Pradesh	-	'Shibirams' - military-style salt satyagraha headquarters across districts
Dharasana (Gujarat)	Sarojini Naidu, Manilal Gandhi, Imam Saheb	Dharasana Salt Works raid; brutal police lathi charge; documented by American journalist Webb Miller
Assam	-	March from Sylhet to Noakhali coast to break salt law
NWFP	Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan ('Frontier Gandhi')	'Khudai Khidmatgar' (Red Shirts / Lal Kurti) - non-violent volunteer corps; journal: Pakhtoon; Garhwal Regiment REFUSED to fire on unarmed protesters
Manipur / Nagaland	Gaidinliu (16-yr-old Naga girl)	Led tribes in supporting movement; arrested; life sentence; met Nehru 1937 ('Daughter of the Hills'); title 'Rani'

NOTE

- During Dharasana incident, Gandhi was imprisoned in Yerwada Jail, Pune - interviewed by British journalist George Slocombe. Composed 'Songs from Prison' during imprisonment.
- Deepavali Declaration (1929): Viceroy Lord Irwin stated ultimate goal of India's constitutional progress = Dominion Status

THE LAST PHASE OF THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT

First Round Table Conference (Nov 1930 – Jan 1931)

Aspect	Detail
Dates	12 Nov 1930 – 19 Jan 1931
Venue	London
Chairman	British PM Ramsay MacDonald
Delegates	89 total
Significance	First conference where Indians were treated as equals to British rulers

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Key Representatives

- **Hindu Mahasabha:** M.R. Jayakar, B.S. Moonje
- **Liberals:** C.Y. Chintamani, T.B. Sapru
- **Muslim League:** Aga Khan, M.A. Jinnah, Muhammad Shafi, Fazlul Haq
- **Sikhs:** Sardar Sampuran Singh
- **Depressed Classes:** Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
- **Princely States:** 16 Maharajas/Princes

Congress BOYCOTTED the First RTC

- INC completely boycotted - did NOT participate
- Muslim League demanded separate electorate for Muslims
- Ambedkar demanded separate electorate for Depressed Classes
- No major decisions - lack of unity among delegates
- Consensus only on: All-India Federation + dyarchy at Centre

Gandhi-Irwin Pact / Delhi Pact (5 March 1931)

Aspect	Detail
Date Signed	5 March 1931
Also Known As	Delhi Pact
Mediators	Tej Bahadur Sapru & M.R. Jayakar
Talks Started	17 February 1931 (Delhi)
Famous Quote by Naidu	"Meeting of two Mahatmas"
K.M. Munshi called it	"Epoch-making event" (Yug Pravartak Ghatna)

Terms - Government's Concessions (Lord Irwin)

- Release all political prisoners not convicted of violence
- Allow coastal Indians to make salt for personal use
- Permit peaceful picketing of liquor & foreign cloth shops
- Return confiscated properties of Satyagrahis
- Withdraw all emergency ordinances

Terms - Congress's Concessions (Gandhi)

- **Suspend the Civil Disobedience Movement** immediately
- Participate in the upcoming **Second Round Table Conference**
- Stop political boycott of British goods

The Bhagat Singh Controversy

- Left-wing leaders & youth were angry - Gandhi failed to commute death sentences
- Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev & Rajguru hanged at Lahore - 23 March 1931
- This caused intense backlash against Gandhi within the Congress

Karachi Session of Congress (March 1931)

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Aspect	Detail
President	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
Reception for Gandhi	Black flags by angry youth over Bhagat Singh hanging
Gandhi's famous statement	"Gandhi may die, but Gandhism will live forever"
Bose's observation	Karachi = pinnacle of Gandhi's popularity
British view (Campbell-Johnson)	Called Gandhi's gains a "consolation prize"

Historic Firsts at Karachi Session

- Officially ratified the Gandhi-Irwin Pact
- Reaffirmed Poorna Swaraj as ultimate goal
- FIRST TIME Congress passed resolutions on Fundamental Rights
- FIRST TIME Congress passed a National Economic Program

Second Round Table Conference (Sep–Dec 1931)

Dates	7 Sep – 1 Dec 1931
Congress Representative	Gandhi - SOLE official representative of INC
British PM	Ramsay MacDonald
Secretary of State	Samuel Hoare (right-wing reactionary)
Viceroy	Lord Willingdon (new)
Gandhi's Ship	S.S. Rajputana
Gandhi's Companions	Mahadev Desai, Malaviya, Devdas Gandhi, G.D. Birla, Mira Behn, Sarojini Naidu
Deadlock Cause	Ambedkar demanded separate electorate for Dalits; Gandhi fiercely opposed
Winston Churchill's insult	Called Gandhi a "Half-naked Fakir" (Ardh-nagna Fakir)
Gandhi's return to India	28 Dec 1931 - empty-handed but flag not dishonored

After the Second RTC

- Gandhi sought meeting with Viceroy Willingdon - Viceroy refused
- Gandhi announced resumption of Civil Disobedience Movement

Second Civil Disobedience Movement (Jan 1932 – Apr 1934)

- Jan 1932: CWC decided to restart Civil Disobedience Movement
- Trigger: Great Depression → agricultural prices crashed → unbearable land revenue
- **Government preemptive strike** - arrested Gandhi, Nehru, Patel, Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan overnight
- Congress declared **illegal organization** - properties confiscated
- Over **1 lakh (100,000)** people arrested during this phase

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- Movement suspended by Gandhi in **April 1934** due to mass repression

Communal Award (16 August 1932)

Aspect	Detail
Announced by	British PM Ramsay MacDonald
Date	16 August 1932
Also called	Sampradayik Panchaat
Key Feature	Separate Electorates for all minority communities
Trick clause	Classified Depressed Classes as a SEPARATE minority from Hindus
Motive	Classic 'Divide and Rule' - split Dalits from Hindus permanently

POONA PACT, HARIJAN MOVEMENT & THIRD RTC**Poona Pact (September 1932)**

Gandhi's Fast Location	Yerwada Jail, Pune
Fast Started	20 September 1932
Purpose	Oppose separate electorate for Dalits under Communal Award
Tagore's support	"Supreme sacrifice for unity and social integrity of India"
Key Mediators	Malaviya, Rajendra Prasad, Purushottam Das Tandon, C. Rajagopalachari
Signatories	Dr. B.R. Ambedkar (Depressed Classes) + Madan Mohan Malaviya (caste Hindus)
Note	Gandhi himself did NOT sign the pact

Key Terms of the Poona Pact

- Separate Electorate for Dalits: COMPLETELY ABOLISHED
- Reserved seats in Provincial Legislatures: increased from 71 → 147 (some sources say 148)
- In Central Legislature: 18% seats reserved for Depressed Classes

Harijan Upliftment Campaign

- Gandhi coined the name '**Harijan**' (Children of God) for Depressed Classes
- Established '**Harijan Sevak Sangh**' after Poona Pact
- Sep 1932: Founded '**All India Anti-Untouchability League**' + weekly journal '**Harijan**'
- May 8 & Aug 16, 1933: Undertook penance fasts for historical mistreatment of untouchables
- **Harijan Yatra**: 7 Nov 1933 from Wardha → ~9 months → nearly **20,000 km** across India
- Opposition: Orthodox Hindus showed black flags, disrupted meetings, distributed pamphlets

Third Round Table Conference (Nov–Dec 1932)

Dates	17 Nov – 24 Dec 1932
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Congress	BOYCOTTED - did NOT participate
Outcome	White Paper (Shwet Patra) issued on 24 Dec 1932
Review Committee	Joint Select Committee under Lord Linlithgow
Final Result	Led directly to Government of India Act, 1935
Bill introduced by	Secretary of State Samuel Hoare
Royal Assent	August 1935

CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY & PROVINCIAL ELECTIONS**Congress Socialist Party - CSP (1934)**

Founded	1934 in Bombay
Founders	Jayaprakash Narayan, Acharya Narendra Dev, Minoo Masani
Other Members	Ashok Mehta, Achyut Patwardhan, Dr. Rammanohar Lohia
General Secretary	Jayaprakash Narayan
First All-India Conference	October 1934, Bombay
Bihar Conference	Patna, May 1934
Ideology	Democratic Socialism - worked WITHIN Congress
Opposed	Communist ideology of 'Dictatorship of the Proletariat'
Meerut Thesis (1936)	Nationalism is a necessary step to achieve Socialism

Provincial Elections & Formation of Ministries (1937)

- Decision to contest: Lucknow (1936) & Faizpur (1936-37) sessions under Nehru's presidency
- Elections: Early 1937 - Congress swept rival parties
- **Absolute majority in 5 provinces**; largest party in Bombay, Assam, NWFP
- Deprived of majority in: **Bengal, Punjab, Sindh**
- Congress govts formed (July 1937): Madras, UP, CP, Bihar, Bombay, Orissa + later NWFP & Assam = **8 provinces**

Non-Congress Governments (1937)

- Bengal: Coalition - Krishak Praja Party + Muslim League
- Punjab: Coalition - Unionist Party + Muslim League
- NOTE: Under 1935 Act, Chief Ministers were called 'Prime Ministers' (Pradhan Mantri)

Provincial Prime Ministers (1937)

Province	Prime Minister
Madras	C. Rajagopalachari
Bihar	Shri Krishna Sinha

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Orissa	B. Das
Central Provinces	N.B. Khare (later Ravishankar Shukla)
United Provinces (UP)	Govind Ballabh Pant
Bombay	B.G. Kher
Assam	Mohd. Saadullah (later Gopinath Bordoloi)
NWFP	Dr. Khan Sahib
Sindh	Allah Bakhsh
Bengal	Fazlul Haq
Punjab	Sikandar Hayat Khan

Key Events During Congress Ministry Tenure

- 28-month rule - proved Congress could govern effectively
- National Planning Committee (1938, Haripura Session): Chaired by Jawaharlal Nehru
- Haripura Session presided by Subhas Chandra Bose
- Parliamentary Sub-Committee (control board): Patel + Abul Kalam Azad + Rajendra Prasad
- Viceroy Linlithgow unilaterally declared India part of WW2 without consulting Indians
- Congress protest: ALL Congress ministries resigned
- Muslim League celebrated 22 Dec 1939 as 'Day of Deliverance' (Mukti Diwas)

TRIPURI CRISIS, INC INTERNAL CONFLICT & WORLD WAR II**Tripuri Crisis (1939)**

Haripura 1938	Bose unanimously elected Congress President (1st time)
Tripuri 1939	Bose vs Pattabhi Sitaramayya - Gandhi's endorsed candidate
Result	Bose won; Gandhi called it 'his own defeat'
Deadlock	Bose to consult Gandhi for Working Committee - Gandhi refused to advise
Bose Resigned	April 1939
Successor	Dr. Rajendra Prasad
Forward Bloc	Founded by Subhas Chandra Bose in 1939 - radical left-wing faction

August Offer (8 August 1940)

Announced by	Viceroy Lord Linlithgow
Context	Congress's Ramgarh demand (Mar 1940) - form Provisional National Govt for war cooperation

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Explicitly rejected	Congress's demand for interim national government
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Key Provisions

- Establish representative Constitution-making body AFTER the war
- Set up a War Advisory Council
- Expand Viceroy's Executive Council with more Indians
- **Minority Veto:** Power not to be transferred if denied by large minorities (nod to Muslim League)

August Offer: Rejected by All

- Congress: Completely rejected
- Muslim League: Also rejected (no explicit Pakistan guarantee)

Muslim League & Demand for Pakistan

- **Muhammad Iqbal** propounded the 'Two-Nation Theory' at Allahabad Session (1930)
- **Chaudhary Rahmat Ali** coined 'PAKISTAN' (1933–35) - Cambridge student
- PAKISTAN = Punjab, Afghan Province (NWFP), Kashmir, Sindh, Baluchistan
- **Lahore Resolution (23 March 1940):** Formal demand for separate Pakistan - presided by Jinnah
- Partial recognition in **Cripps Proposals 1942** (provinces could opt out)
- **Pakistan Day** celebrated: 23 March 1943

Individual Satyagraha (17 October 1940)

Launched from	Pavnar Ashram, Maharashtra
1st Satyagrahi	Acharya Vinoba Bhave - 17 October 1940
2nd Satyagrahi 3rd Satyagrahi	Jawaharlal Nehru Brahma Datt
Phases	2 phases - 2nd phase began Jan 1941
Arrests	~25,000 satyagrahis jailed
Also known as	'Delhi Chalo Movement' (Delhi Chalo Andolan)
Aim	Prove India was NOT willingly supporting British war effort

CRIPPS MISSION & QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT**Cripps Mission (March 1942)**

Announced by	Winston Churchill - 11 March 1942
Mission arrived	23 March 1942
Representative	Sir Stafford Cripps (single-man mission)
Trigger	Japan's growing power - pressure from USA, Australia, China on Britain

Key Proposals

- Grant **Dominion Status** after WW2 ends

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- Create Indian Union post-war with full Dominion status + right to secede from Commonwealth
- Constituent Assembly established after war - elected reps + nominated Princely States reps
- **Opt-Out Clause:** Any province could reject constitution and remain independent (groundwork for Pakistan)
- Minority protection treaty required
- **Defense Ministry:** To remain firmly under British control during war

Famous Reactions to Cripps Mission

- Gandhi: Called it a "Post-Dated Cheque" - on a crashing bank
- Nehru: "When I read these proposals, I was deeply disappointed."
- Congress rejected: Empty future promises, not real transfer of power
- Muslim League rejected: No separate electorate, no clear Pakistan

Quit India Movement - The August Revolution (Aug 1942)

Also called	Bharat Chhodo Andolan / August Revolution
Trigger	Complete failure of Cripps Mission
CWC Wardha Meeting	14 July 1942 - approved the struggle
Moderates who resigned from CWC	C. Rajagopalachari & Bhulabhai Desai
AICC Ratification	Gowalia Tank Maidan, Bombay - 8 August 1942
Gandhi's Mantra	"Do or Die" (Karo ya Maro)
Gandhi's ultimatum to Congress	"I will raise a movement bigger than Congress from the sand of this country"

Resolutions at Gowalia Tank (8 Aug 1942)

- Immediate end to British rule in India
- Free India will defend itself against all fascist/imperialist powers
- Provisional government established immediately after British leave
- Mass struggle on non-violent lines - widest possible scale
- **Gandhi declared official leader** of the Quit India Movement

Gandhi's Specific Instructions to Each Group

- Government Servants: Don't resign - openly declare allegiance to Congress
- Soldiers: Don't leave army - refuse to fire on countrymen
- Students: Leave studies ONLY if you can stay firm until independence
- Peasants: Pay Zamindars if anti-govt; stop rent if pro-govt
- Princes: Support masses, accept sovereignty of the people

Operation Zero Hour & Spread of the Movement

- **9 Aug 1942 - Operation Zero Hour:** British crackdown before movement could begin
- ALL top leaders arrested overnight including Gandhi, Nehru, Patel
- Congress declared illegal, properties confiscated

Arrests & Prisons

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- **Gandhi:** Aga Khan Palace, Pune - with Sarojini Naidu & Kasturba Gandhi
- **Congress Working Committee members:** Ahmednagar Fort Jail
- **Dr. Rajendra Prasad:** Bankipur Jail, Patna
- **Jayaprakash Narayan:** Hazaribagh Central Jail (later escaped!)
- JP formed '**Azad Dasta**' guerrilla group for underground resistance

Parallel Governments Established

- Ballia (UP): Led by Chittu Pandey
- Satara (Maharashtra): Led by Y.B. Chavan & Nana Patil - LONGEST surviving (till 1944–45)
- Satara Govt: King of Aundh State drafted its constitution
- Tamluk, Midnapore (Bengal): 'Jatiya Sarkar' (Dec 1942 – Sep 1944) - had 'Vidyut Vahini' armed wing
- Talcher (Orissa): Functioned successfully for some time

Underground Movement (Sep 1942 onwards)

- Underground leaders: **JP Narayan, Rammanohar Lohia, Achyut Patwardhan, Aruna Asaf Ali**
- **Usha Mehta** = Pioneer of secret Congress Radio broadcasts
- Others involved: Sucheta Kripalani, Chhotubhai Puranik, Biju Patnaik, R.P. Goenka

Gandhi's Fast & Government Response

- Govt pressured Gandhi to condemn protesters' violence - Gandhi **refused**
- Gandhi's **21-day fast** inside Aga Khan Palace - began **February 1943**
- 3 Council members resigned: M.S. Aney, N.R. Sarkar, H.P. Mody
- Fast ended: **7 March 1943**
- Gandhi released from prison: **6 May 1944** (deteriorating health)
- Tragedies in prison: **Kasturba Gandhi & Mahadev Desai** both died during imprisonment

The 'Rubicon' Code

- Doctors feared Gandhi would die during his fast
- British secretly instructed Bombay govt: If Gandhi dies, send codeword 'RUBICON' to provinces

Significance of Quit India Movement

- Lord Linlithgow's telegram to Churchill: Called it '**the most serious rebellion since 1857**'
- Proved Indians would no longer settle for anything less than complete independence
- Peasant uprising was extraordinarily fierce - attacked govt establishments at night, farmed by day
- **Leaderless and spontaneous** after arrests of all senior leaders
- Proved narrow class interests had disappeared - India united against the real enemy

Who Opposed the Quit India Movement?

- Muslim League (Jinnah): Feared 'Jungle Raj' (Hindu domination) after British leave
- Dec 1943 (Karachi Session): Muslim League coined 'Divide and Quit'
- Liberals (Tej Bahadur Sapru): Called it 'unconsidered and untimely'
- Dr. B.R. Ambedkar: 'Madness to weaken law and order when Japan is at our borders'
- Communist Party officially boycotted (Soviet Russia allied with Britain); but individual communists participated

INA, AZAD HIND FAUJ & SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE

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Azad Hind Fauj (INA) - Key Facts

Bose's Great Escape	1941 - escaped Calcutta house arrest, reached Berlin via Peshawar + Russia
Free India Center	Established in Berlin - sought Hitler's help
INA Originator	Captain Mohan Singh (British Indian Army officer who surrendered to Japan)
INA Founded	1st Division - 1 September 1942
Bose arrived Singapore	2 July 1943 - declared Supreme Commander
Provisional Govt	21 Oct 1943, Singapore - 'Arzi Hukumat-e-Azad Hind'
Recognized by	Germany, Japan and Axis powers
Brigades	Subhas Brigade, Nehru Brigade, Gandhi Brigade
Women's Regiment	Rani Jhansi Regiment - led by Capt. Lakshmi Sehgal
Andaman Islands renamed	Shaheed Dweep
Nicobar Islands renamed	Swaraj Dweep
Flag on Indian soil	Moirang, Manipur - April 1944 - FIRST time liberation army on mainland India
Bose's death	18 August 1945 - plane crash, Taipei (Taiwan)

Immortal Slogans of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose

- "Delhi Chalo" - marching call to INA
- "Give me blood, and I shall give you freedom!" (Tum mujhe khoon do, main tumhe azaadi doonga)
- 6 July 1944: First addressed Gandhi as "Father of the Nation" (Rashtrapita) on Azad Hind Radio

Red Fort / INA Trials (1945)

Charged with	Treason - breaking oath of loyalty to the Crown
Venue	Red Fort, Delhi
INA Defence Committee	Azad Hind Fauj Relief and Enquiry Committee
Chief Defence Counsel	Bhulabhai Desai
Legal Team	Tej Bahadur Sapru, Kailash Nath Katju, Jawaharlal Nehru
Accused (1 Hindu, 1 Muslim, 1 Sikh)	Prem Kumar Sahgal, Shah Nawaz Khan, Sardar Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon
Verdict	Guilty of treason by Court Martial
Outcome	Viceroy Lord Wavell exercised special powers - sentences remitted (pardoned)

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Trigger for pardon	Massive public outrage across India
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WAVELL PLAN, CABINET MISSION & INDEPENDENCE**C.R. Formula / Rajaji Formula (1944)**

- Proposed by **C. Rajagopalachari** (Rajaji) with Gandhi's explicit approval
- Muslim League must support Indian demand for independence
- League to cooperate in forming provincial interim governments
- Post-WW2: Commission demarcate Muslim-majority districts in NE & NW India + plebiscite
- In case of partition: joint agreement on Defence, Commerce, Communications
- All terms binding only after British completely transfer power

Wavell Plan & Shimla Conference (June 1945)

Announced	14 June 1945
Key Provision	All Executive Council members (except Viceroy & Commander-in-Chief) to be Indians
Shimla Conference	June 1945 - 21 Indian political leaders attended
INC representative	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
Muslim League rep	Muhammad Ali Jinnah
Failure Reason	Jinnah demanded ALL Muslim seats exclusively for Muslim League
Gandhi's role	Present in Shimla - but did NOT officially participate

Royal Indian Navy (RIN) Mutiny (18–23 Feb 1946)

- Started: **18 Feb 1946 - 1,100 sailors (ratings)** on **HMIS Talwar**, Bombay
- Grievances: Racial discrimination by British officers + terrible food
- Demand: Release sailor **B.C. Dutt** (arrested for writing 'Quit India' on ship walls)
- Spread to naval bases in Bombay & Karachi
- Civilian general strike across Bombay in support
- 3 flags flown together: **Congress tricolor + Muslim League green + Communist red flag** - rare unity
- Sardar Patel & Jinnah persuaded sailors to surrender
- **Historic declaration:** 'We are surrendering to India, not to Britain'

Significance of RIN Mutiny

- Proved absolute loyalty of armed forces - the pillar of British Empire - had completely eroded
- Exactly 18 months after this event, British rule in India officially ended
- Final death knell for British colonial ambitions

Cabinet Mission (March 1946)

Sent by	British PM Clement Attlee (Labour Party)
Arrived India	24 March 1946
Leader	Lord Pethick-Lawrence (Secretary of State for India)

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Members	Sir Stafford Cripps + A.V. Alexander + Lord Pethick-Lawrence
Key Rejection	Explicitly REJECTED demand for separate Pakistan
Union Subjects	Defense, Foreign Affairs, Communications ONLY
Residual Powers	Fully vested in Provinces

Provincial Groupings Under Cabinet Mission

Group	Provinces
Group A (Hindu Majority)	Madras, Bombay, CP, UP, Bihar, Orissa (6 provinces)
Group B (Muslim Majority)	Punjab, Sindh, NWFP (3 provinces)
Group C	Bengal & Assam

Constituent Assembly Elections (July 1946)

Total Seats (British India)	296
Election Method	Indirect - by provincial legislature members
INC won	208 seats
Muslim League won	73 seats
Others	15 seats

Direct Action Day & Communal Violence

- Muslim League rejected Cabinet Mission Plan: 29 July 1946
- Jinnah declared 16 August 1946 = 'Direct Action Day'
- Horrific violence: Calcutta, Bihar (Hindu vs Muslim riots), Noakhali & Tippera (against Hindus)
- Gandhi walked barefoot through Noakhali - Mountbatten called him 'One Man Boundary Force'

Constituent Assembly - Key Firsts

- First meeting: 9 Dec 1946 - Temp President: Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha
- 11 Dec 1946: Dr. Rajendra Prasad elected permanent President
- Drafting Committee Chairman: Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
- Constitution drafted in: 2 years, 11 months, 18 days
- Muslim League completely boycotted first meeting

Interim Government (1946)

Invited by	Lord Wavell - invited Nehru on 24 August 1946
Oath taken	2 September 1946 - 12-member cabinet
Muslim League joined	October 1946 - 5 representatives - to OBSTRUCT, not cooperate
League's Constituent Assembly boycott	First meeting 9 Dec 1946 - completely boycotted

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Interim Cabinet Portfolios (1946)

Member	Portfolio / Department
Jawaharlal Nehru	Commonwealth Relations & Foreign Affairs
Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel	Home, Information & Broadcasting
Sardar Baldev Singh	Defense
Dr. John Mathai	Industries & Civil Supplies
C. Rajagopalachari	Education & Arts
C.H. Bhabha	Works, Mines & Power
Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Food & Agriculture
Asaf Ali	Railways & Transport
Jagjivan Ram	Labor
- Muslim League Members -	-
Liaquat Ali Khan	Finance
I.I. Chundrigar	Commerce
Jogendra Nath Mandal	Law
Gazanfar Ali Khan	Health
Abdur Rab Nishtar	Posts & Air

Attlee's Declaration (20 February 1947)

- British PM **Clement Attlee** announced: Power to be transferred to Indian hands **no later than June 1948**
- Lord Mountbatten** appointed as new Viceroy - replacing Lord Wavell

Mountbatten Plan / 3rd June Plan (1947)

Mountbatten Arrived	22 March 1947
Conclusion	Partition was the ONLY viable alternative to civil war
Congress acceptance	Helpless acceptance by Nehru & Patel due to League's obstructionism
Patel's famous remark	"Whether Jinnah wants partition or not, we now want partition ourselves"
Gandhi's stance	FIERCELY OPPOSED partition until the very end
Plan announced	3 June 1947
AICC motion moved by	Govind Ballabh Pant (supported by Maulana Azad)

Key Points of the Mountbatten Plan

- Punjab & Bengal: Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority district respectively vote separately on partition
- Two separate Constituent Assemblies for India & Pakistan
- **Referendum in NWFP & Sylhet (Assam):** Which country to join?
- Boundary Commission to draw international borders

Other Plans Related to Partition

- Dickie Bird Plan / Ismay Plan / Balkan Plan: Drafted by Ismay, Abell & Mountbatten
- Nehru immediately rejected Dickie Bird Plan - called it 'Balkanization' of India
- Dickie Bird Plan is also called 'Balkan Plan' due to Nehru's sharp criticism
- Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (Frontier Gandhi) bitterly said 'Congress has thrown their movement to the wolves'
- Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew: Called AICC's approval a 'surrender of nationalism to communalism'

Radcliffe Committee (July 1947)

- Chairman: **Sir Cyril Radcliffe** (British lawyer)
- Members: 2 nominated by INC + 2 by Muslim League
- Task: Draw final boundary lines between India and Pakistan

Indian Independence Act (July 1947)

Royal Assent	18 July 1947
Based on	Provisions of the Mountbatten Plan
Partition Date	15 August 1947 - Two Dominions: INDIA & PAKISTAN
Interim Constitution	Government of India Act, 1935 (until new Constitutions framed)
Princely States	FREE to join India, Pakistan, or remain independent
India's First Governor-General	Lord Mountbatten
India's First Prime Minister	Jawaharlal Nehru
Pakistan's First Governor-General	Muhammad Ali Jinnah (from 14 August 1947)

INTEGRATION OF PRINCELY STATES**Integration of Princely States - Overview**

- **Mastermind:** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel - used diplomacy + threat of military action
- **Instrument of Accession (Vilay Patra):** Legal merger document signed by Princely States
- Prajamandals (People's Societies): Political awakening movement in Princely States (1938–39)
- Three Holdouts after 15 Aug 1947: **Junagadh, Hyderabad, Jammu & Kashmir**

Junagadh

- Location: Saurashtra (Gujarat) coast - surrounded on 3 sides by India
- Muslim Nawab declared accession to Pakistan (15 Aug 1947)
- Mass uprising by overwhelmingly Hindu population
- Nawab fled to Pakistan - Dewan **Shah Nawaz Bhutto** invited India to take control
- **February 1948:** Plebiscite - overwhelmingly voted for India - merged into Indian Union

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Hyderabad

- Largest & wealthiest princely state
- Nov 1947: **Standstill Agreement** signed with India
- **Razakars**: Violent separatist militias - created mass terror
- **Operation Polo (Sep 1948)**: Code-named 'Caterpillar' - Army entered 13 Sep 1948
- **Nov 1948**: Nizam officially accepted merger - retained as titular Rajpramukh

Jammu & Kashmir

- **Maharaja Hari Singh** (Hindu ruler) + Muslim majority population
- **Sheikh Abdullah** (National Conference): Wanted plebiscite to decide merger
- **22 October 1947**: Armed Pathan tribesmen (led by Pakistani officers) invaded Kashmir
- **26 October 1947**: Hari Singh signed **Instrument of Accession** - appointed Sheikh Abdullah head of administration
- Indian Army airlifted - pushed back tribesmen - Pakistan retained parts
- **30 December 1947**: India referred Kashmir to **UN Security Council**
- 1951 UN Resolution: Plebiscite proposed - precondition: Pakistan withdraw from POK - Pakistan refused

Current Update

- Until 5 August 2019: J&K was a State
- After August 2019: Bifurcated into 2 Union Territories - J&K and Ladakh

Integration of European Colonies**French Colonies**

- Territories: **Chandernagore, Pondicherry (Puducherry), Karaikal, Mahe**
- Separate referendums held - **1 Nov 1954**: De facto control by India
- **1962**: French Parliament ratified treaty - complete legal transfer

Portuguese Colonies

- Territories: **Daman & Diu, Dadra & Nagar Haveli, Goa**
- Portugal REFUSED to leave unlike France
- **1954**: Local uprising overthrew Portuguese in Dadra & Nagar Haveli
- **Dec 1961 - Operation Vijay**: Indian Army entered Goa - Portuguese Governor-General surrendered
- Goa, Daman & Diu, Dadra & Nagar Haveli merged as **Union Territories**
- **1987**: Goa elevated to full-fledged State

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Important Books and Authors from Modern India

Author / Writer	Book / Publication
Jawaharlal Nehru	Discovery of India, A Bunch of Old Letters
Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit	The Scope of Happiness
Sarojini Naidu	The Golden Threshold, Songs of India, The Broken Wing
Dr. S. Radhakrishnan	Indian Philosophy
Mahatma Gandhi	Hind Swaraj, Gokhale My Political Guru, My Experiments with Truth, Songs from Prison
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Gita Rahasya
Katherine Mayo	Mother India
Louis Fischer	The Life of Mahatma Gandhi (<i>Note: An American journalist who interviewed Gandhiji in June 1942 and was with him during the Quit India Movement</i>)
Rabindranath Tagore	Gora (Novel), The Crescent Moon, The Post Office, Gitanjali (English Edition 1912)
Michael Madhusudan Dutt	The Captive Ladie
Frank Moraes	Jawaharlal Nehru: A Biography
Bhagat Singh	An Introduction to the Dreamland (<i>Written at the request of Lala Ram Saran Das</i>)
Surendranath Banerjee	A Nation in Making
Sri Aurobindo	Foundations of Indian Culture, The Life Divine

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Author / Writer	Book / Publication
Ram Manohar Lohia	Guilty Men of India's Partition
Subhas Chandra Bose	The Indian Struggle
Bankim Chandra Chatterjee	Anand Math, Durgesh Nandini
Muhammad Iqbal	Tarana-e-Hind
Durga Das	India from Curzon to Nehru and After
V.D. Savarkar	The Indian War of Independence, 1857
Larry Collins & Dominique Lapierre	Freedom at Midnight
Dinabandhu Mitra	Nil Darpan
Lala Har Dayal	Hints for Self Culture
Valentine Chirol	Indian Unrest
R.C. Dutt	The Economic History of India
Aurobindo Ghosh	Bhawani Mandir
Bipan Chandra	The Rise and Growth of Economic Nationalism in India
Rafiq Zakaria	The Man Who Divided India
Surendranath Sen	Eighteen Fifty-Seven

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Author / Writer	Book / Publication
Lala Lajpat Rai	Unhappy India, The Story of My Deportation
Sachindranath Sanyal	Bandi Jiwan
Rajendra Prasad	India Divided
Dr. B.R. Ambedkar	Pakistan or the Partition of India, Annihilation of Caste, Riddles in Hinduism
Bhagwati Charan Vohra	The Philosophy of the Bomb
Dayanand Saraswati	Satyarth Prakash
Dadabhai Naoroji	Poverty and Un-British Rule in India
Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	India Wins Freedom

Newspapers and Magazines Published in British India

Newspaper / Magazine	Language	Year & Place	Founder / Editor
Bengal Gazette	English	1780, Calcutta	James Augustus Hicky (<i>India's first newspaper</i>)
Samvad Kaumudi	Bengali	1821	Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Mirat-ul-Akhbar	Persian	1822, Calcutta	Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Bangadoot	English, Bengali, Hindi, Persian	1822, Calcutta	Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Dwarkanath Tagore
Udant Martand	Hindi	1826, Calcutta	Jugal Kishore (<i>First weekly newspaper in Hindi</i>)
Darpan	Marathi	1832, Bombay	Bal Shastri (<i>First Marathi newspaper</i>)
Rast Goftar	Gujarati	1851, Bombay	Dadabhai Naoroji (<i>Some sources mention 1854</i>)
Hindoo Patriot	English	1853	Harish Chandra Mukherjee, Girish Chandra Ghosh
Som Prakash	Bengali	1859, Calcutta	Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
Native Opinion	English	1864, Bombay	V.N. Mandlik
The Pioneer	English	1865, Allahabad	George Allen (<i>Some sources: Julian Robinson</i>)
Kavivachan Sudha	Hindi	1867, U.P.	Bhartendu Harishchandra

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Newspaper / Magazine	Language	Year & Place	Founder / Editor
Amrita Bazar Patrika	Bengali (<i>English from 1878</i>)	1868, Calcutta	Motilal Ghosh, Shishir Kumar Ghosh
Harishchandra Magazine	Hindi	1872-73, U.P.	Bhartendu Harishchandra
Hindi Pradeep	Hindi	1877, U.P.	Balkrishna Bhatt
The Hindu	English	1878, Madras	Vir Raghavacharya, G. Subramania Iyer
Bharat Mitra	Hindi	1878, Calcutta	Balmukund Gupta, Ambika Prasad Bajpai
The Bengalee	English	1879, Calcutta	Surendranath Banerjee
Kesari	Marathi	1881, Pune	Bal Gangadhar Tilak
Mahratta	English	1881, Pune	Bal Gangadhar Tilak
The Tribune	English	1881, Lahore	Dyal Singh Majithia
Hindustan Review	English	1899, Delhi	Sachchidananda Sinha
The Indian Sociologist	English	1905-14, 1920-22, London → Paris → Geneva	Shyamji Krishna Varma
Comrade	English	1911, Calcutta	Muhammad Ali
Al Hilal	Urdu	1912, Calcutta	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

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Newspaper / Magazine	Language	Year & Place	Founder / Editor
Hamdard	Urdu	1913	Muhammad Ali
Pratap	Hindi	1913, Kanpur	Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi
Ghadar	Urdu	1913, San Francisco	Lala Har Dayal
Ghadar	Punjabi	1913, San Francisco	Kartar Singh
Commonweal	English	1914	Annie Besant
Young India	English	1919, Ahmedabad	Mahatma Gandhi
Navjivan	Gujarati, Hindi	1919, Ahmedabad	Mahatma Gandhi
The Independent	English	1919, Allahabad	Motilal Nehru
Hindustan Times	English	1924, Delhi (or Bombay)	K.M. Panikkar
Harijan	English, Hindi, Gujarati	1933	Mahatma Gandhi
National Herald	English	1938, Lucknow (HQ - Delhi)	Jawaharlal Nehru
Al Balagh	Urdu	Calcutta (Year not specified)	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

GOVERNOR GENERALS & VICEROYS OF INDIA**Governors of Bengal**

Governor	Important Events During Tenure
Robert Clive (1757-60 and 1765-67)	• Battle of Plassey (1757) • Father of the Dual Government in Bengal • Appointed Deputy Diwans (Bengal region): Muhammad Reza Khan (Bengal), Raja Shitab Rai (Bihar), Rai Durlabh (Odisha) • White Mutiny • Treaties of Allahabad (1765) (with Nawab Shuja-ud-Daula of Awadh and Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II) • Given the title of 'Umra' by Salabat Jung and Alamgir II • Clive established army centers: Allahabad, Munger, Bankipur
Henry Vansittart (1760-64)	Battle of Buxar (1764).
Harry Verelst (1767-69)	The First Anglo-Mysore War (1767–1769)
John Cartier (1769-72)	Famine in Bengal (1770).
Warren Hastings (1772-74)	• Last Governor of Bengal • Ended the Dual Government in Bengal • Established one Faujdari (Criminal) and one Diwani (Civil) court in each district (1772)

GOVERNORS GENERAL OF BENGAL (1773–1833)

📌 **NOTE:** Warren Hastings = 1st GG of Bengal. Lord William Bentinck = 1st GG of India. Lord Canning = 1st Viceroy of India.

WARREN HASTINGS (1773–1785)

Key Title	1st Governor General of Bengal (via Regulating Act of 1773); was Governor of Bengal since 1772
Supreme Court	Supreme Court at Fort William established - 1774
Act of 1781	Divided jurisdiction between Governor-General-in-Council and Supreme Court at Calcutta
Pitt's India Act	1784

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Asiatic Society (1784)	Founded by William Jones on 15 January 1784 at Fort William in Kolkata.
Impeachment	Strained relations with Chait Singh (Maharaja of Benaras) → impeachment in England

REFORMATIVE ACTIONS	REPRESSIVE ACTIONS
Established Diwani & Fauzdari Adalats at district level; Sadar Diwani & Nizamat Adalats at Calcutta.	Rohilla War - 1774.
Abolished dual government established by Robert Clive.	First Maratha War - 1775–82.
Divided Bengal into districts; appointed Collectors & revenue officials.	Second Mysore War - 1780–84.
Translation of Sanskrit code to English (1776) - 'Code of Gentoo Laws'.	Treaty of Salbai - 1782.

LORD CORNWALLIS (1786–1793)

Famous title	'Father of Civil Services in India' - Europeanisation of administrative machinery
Cornwallis Code (1793)	FIRST person to codify laws in India
Permanent Settlement	Introduced Permanent Settlement of Bengal - 1793
District Judge post	Created post of district judge; separated revenue admin from civil jurisdiction
3rd Mysore War	1790–92 → Treaty of Seringapatam (1792)

SIR JOHN SHORE (1793–1798)

1st Charter Act	Charter Act of 1793 introduced
Battle of Kharda	Between Nizam and Marathas - 1795

LORD WELLESLEY (1798–1805)

Original Name	Richard Colley Wellesley, 1st Marquess Wellesley
Fort William College	Established at Calcutta - 1800 (for training civil servants)
Madras Presidency	Formed during his tenure - 1801
Subsidiary Alliance	Started 1798 - FIRST alliance with Nizam of Hyderabad (Nizam Ali) - 1798
4th Mysore War	1799 - death of Tipu Sultan
Treaty of Bassein	With Marathas (1802) → Second Maratha War 1803–05 (defeated Scindia, Bhosle, Holkar)
Territories annexed	Tanjore (1799) · Surat (1800) · Carnatic (1801)

SIR GEORGE BARLOW (1805–1807)BCW Head office: 8th Floor Kashi Palace, Dakbanglow Chauraha, Patna-1www.bpsconceptwallah.com

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Vellore Mutiny	1806 - happened during his tenure
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LORD MINTO I (1807–1813)

Treaty of Amritsar	With Ranjit Singh - 1809
Charter Act	Charter Act of 1813 was passed

LORD HASTINGS (1813–1823)

Policy	Adopted policy of intervention and war
Pindaris	Strife 1817–18 → complete destruction of Pindari Clan
Bombay Presidency	Created - 1818
Revenue systems	Ryotwari System by Thomas Munro (Governor of Madras) - 1820; Mahalwari System by Holt Mackenzie in North India - 1822
Third Maratha War	1817–19 → dissolution of Maratha Confederacy
Anglo-Nepal War	1814–16 → Treaty of Sagauli (1816)
Treaty with Sindhia	1817

LORD AMHERST (1823–1828)

Sanskrit College	Established at Calcutta - 1824
First Burmese War	1824–26 → Treaty of Yandabo (1826) → acquired Malay Peninsula territories
Bharatpur	Captured - 1826

GOVERNORS GENERAL OF INDIA (1833–1858)

Title changed from 'Governor General of Bengal' to 'Governor General of India' by Charter Act of 1833.

LORD WILLIAM BENTINCK (1828–1835)

Key Titles	'Most liberal and enlightened GG of India' · 'Father of modern western education in India'
Two roles	GG of Bengal till 1833 → FIRST GG of India (1833–1835)
Sati abolished	1829 - abolished Sati and other cruel rites
Charter Act of 1833	No Indian subject debarred from office on account of religion, birth, descent or colour
Macaulay's Minutes	Resolution of 1835 - English as official language / medium of education
Suppression of Thugi	1830
Cornwallis's courts	Abolished provincial courts of appeal & circuit; appointed Commissioners of Revenue & Circuit
Annexations	Mysore (1831) · Coorg (1834) · Central Cachar (1834)

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Ranjeet Singh	Treaty of 'perpetual friendship' - 1831
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LORD METCALFE (1835–1836)

Key Title	'Liberator of Press in India'
Press reforms	New press law removing restrictions on press; repealed Licensing Regulation of 1823
Calcutta Public Library	Established - 1836

LORD AUCKLAND (1836–1842)

Death of Ranjit Singh	1839 - happened during his tenure
Bank of Bombay	Established 1840 → later became Imperial Bank of India → now SBI
Ended Afghan War	Brought First Afghan War to end
Annexed Sindh	1843

LORD ELLENBOROUGH (1842–1844)

Reform	Abolished Slavery - 1843
First Afghan War	1838–42 - great blow to British prestige in India
Annexation of Sindh	1843
War with Gwalior	1843

LORD HARDINGE I (1844–1848)

Reforms	Abolished female infanticide and human sacrifice
Roorkee Engineering College	Established - 1847 (first engineering college in Asia)
1st Anglo-Sikh War	1845–46 → Treaty of Lahore (1846)
Employment preference	Preferred English-educated in government employment

LORD DALHOUSIE (1848–1856)

Original Name	James Andrew Brown Ramsay
Railways	Railway Minute of 1853 · First passenger train: Bombay–Thane - 1853
Telegraph	4,000 miles of telegraph lines (Calcutta↔Bombay, Madras, Peshawar)
Post	Post Office Act, 1854
Ganges Canal	Declared open - 1854
Public Works Dept	Separate PWD established in every province
Wood's Despatch	'Wood's Educational Despatch' 1854 - Anglo-vernacular schools + govt colleges (Charles Wood = President, Board of Control)
Widow Remarriage	Widow Remarriage Act - 1856

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Female infanticide	Completely banned; banned Human Sacrifice in Central Province, Odisha, Maharashtra
2nd Anglo-Sikh War	1848–49 → Annexation of Punjab (1849)
2nd Anglo-Burmese War	1852 → Annexation of Lower Burma / Pegu
Santhal Rebellion	1855 - happened during his tenure

VICEROYS OF INDIA (1858–1947)

Title changed to 'Viceroy' by Government of India Act, 1858. Lord Canning was the FIRST Viceroy (also last GG of India).

ALL VICEROYS AT A GLANCE

Viceroy	Tenure	Facts
Lord Canning	1856–1862	• First Viceroy (also last Governor-General of India) • Revolt of 1857 during his tenure • GOI Act, 1858 • Indian Council Act, 1861 • Introduction of Budget System and Portfolio System • Establishment of 3 Universities (1857): Calcutta, Madras, Bombay • Formation of Imperial Civil Services • Establishment of Archaeological Survey of India (1861) by Alexander Cunningham
Lord Elgin I	1862–1863	• Establishment of High Courts at Calcutta, Bombay and Madras • Wahabi Movement was suppressed
Lord John Lawrence	1864–1869	• Establishment of Shimla as summer capital (1863) • Allahabad High Court was set up in 1866 • Bhutan War (1865): British defeated Bhutan and annexed Assam and Bengal Duars • Tabernacle of New Dispensation was set up by Keshub Chandra Sen
Lord Mayo	1869–1872	• He was assassinated during his tenure • Started financial decentralisation • Sedition Act (1870) to tackle the Wahabi movement • Opened Rajkot College (Kathiawar) and Mayo College (Ajmer) for political training of Indian princes • Establishment of Statistical Survey of India and Department of Agriculture and Commerce • Introduction of state railways
Lord Northbrook	1872–1876	• Jyotiba Phule launched Satyashodhak Samaj (1873) • Prince of Wales visited India (1875) • Trial of Gaekwar of Baroda

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		• Kuka Movement in Punjab • He resigned because of Afghanistan issue
Lord Lytton	1876–1880	• Under Royal Titles Act (1876), Queen Victoria assumed the title of 'Kaiser-i-Hind' (Queen Empress of India) • Famine Commission (1878) under Richard Strachey • 1st Delhi Durbar (1877) • Deccan Agrarian Relief Act (1876) • Famine of 1876–78 • Decreased ICS age from 21 to 19 years • Vernacular Press Act (1878) • Arms Act (1878) • Second Afghan War (1878–80)
Lord Ripon	1880–1884	• Ilbert Bill controversy (1883–84) • Rendition of Mysore • Known as Father of Local Self-Government in India • Repealed Vernacular Press Act (1882) • First Factory Act (1881) • Government Resolution on Local Self-Government (1882) • First complete Census conducted • Hunter Commission (1882)
Lord Dufferin	1884–1888	• Third Burmese War (1885–86) • Bengal Tenancy Act (1885) • Formation of Indian National Congress (INC)
Lord Lansdowne	1888–1894	• Set up of Durand Commission (1893) to define Durand Line (India–Afghanistan boundary) • Factory Act (1891) • Age of Consent Act (1891) (prohibited marriage of girls below 12 years) • Categorisation of Civil Services into imperial, provisional and subordinate • Indian Councils Act (1892)
Lord Elgin II	1894–1899	• Indian Famine (1896–97); Lyal Commission appointed • Santhal and Munda Uprisings under Birsa Munda • Plague in Bombay (1897) and assassination of two British officials by the Chapekar brothers
Lord Curzon	1899–1905	• Indian Famine (1899–1900); Famine Commission (Macdonell) • Creation of North-West Frontier Province (1901) • Curzon–Kitchener controversy • 2nd Delhi Durbar (1903) • Swadeshi Movement against Partition of Bengal • Official Secrets Act (1904) • Partition of Bengal (1905) • Younghusband Mission to Tibet (1904) • Calcutta Corporation Act (1899) • Police Commission (1902) under Sir Andrew Frazer

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		• Universities Commission (1902) and Indian Universities Act (1904) • PUSA Agricultural Institute (1903) • Establishment of Department of Commerce and Industry • Ancient Monuments Preservation Act (1904)
Lord Minto II	1905–1910	• Popularisation of anti-partition and Swadeshi Movement • Split in Congress (Surat Session, 1907) • Formation of Muslim League (1906) • Jamsetji Tata established TISCO (1907) • Morley–Minto Reforms (1909) / Indian Councils Act (1909) – separate electorates • Seditious Meetings Act (1909) • Indian Press Act (1910)
Lord Hardinge II	1910–1916	• Creation of Bengal Presidency (1911) • Transfer of capital from Calcutta to Delhi (1911) • Establishment of Hindu Mahasabha (1915) by Madan Mohan Malaviya • Delhi Durbar III (1911) – Coronation of King George V • Creation of McMahon Line (1914) • Ghadar Mutiny (1915) • Arrival of Gandhiji to India (1915) • A bomb was thrown at him near Chandni Chowk but he escaped unhurt
Lord Chelmsford	1916–1921	• Rowlatt Act (1919) opposed by Rowlatt Satyagraha • Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919) • Montagu's August Declaration (1917) and GOI Act (1919) • Foundation of Women's University at Poona (1916) and Saddler Commission (1917) • Appointment of S.P. Sinha as Governor of Bihar; Imperial Bank of India (1921) • Home Rule Movement (1916) by Annie Besant and Tilak • Lucknow Session (1916) and reunion of moderates & extremists • Lucknow Pact (1916) (Congress–Muslim League) • Foundation of Sabarmati Ashram (1916) • Champaran (1917), Kheda (1918) and Ahmedabad Satyagraha (1918) • Non-Cooperation and Khilafat Movements • Death of Bal Gangadhar Tilak (1920)
Lord Reading	1921–1926	• Repeal of Press Act (1910) and Rowlatt Act (1919) • Criminal Law Amendment Act and abolition of cotton excise • Lee Commission (1923) for public services • Decision for ICS exam in Delhi & London (1923) • Chauri Chaura incident (1922) and withdrawal of Non-

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		Cooperation Movement • Moplah Rebellion (1921) in Kerala • Rabindra Nath Tagore founded Visva Bharati (1921) • Formation of Swaraj Party (1922) • Communal riots in Multan, Amritsar, Delhi, Aligarh, Arvi and Calcutta • Kakori Train Robbery (1925) • Formation of RSS (1925) • Murder of Swami Shraddhanand (1926)
Lord Irwin	1926–1931	• Appointment of Harcourt Butler Indian States Commission (1927) • Simon Commission (1928) and its boycott; death of Lala Lajpat Rai • Murder of Saunders and Assembly Bomb Case (1929) • Bomb accident in train in Delhi (1929) • Lahore Conspiracy Case (1929); death of Jatin Das • Lahore Session (1929) and Purna Swaraj Resolution • Irwin Declaration (1929) • Dandi March (1930) – Civil Disobedience Movement • Gandhi–Irwin Pact (1931) • Execution of Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev (1931)
Lord Willingdon	1931–1936	• Second Round Table Conference (1931) – failure; resumption of Civil Disobedience Movement • Communal Award (1932) – separate electorates • Gandhi's fast unto death (1932) → Poona Pact (1932) • Third Round Table Conference (1932) • GOI Act (1935) • Establishment of All India Kisan Sabha (1936) • Congress Socialist Party (1934) • Burma separated (1935) • Reserve Bank of India (RBI) established
Lord Linlithgow	1936–1944	• Imperialists used force to crush the Quit India Movement • Bengal Famine (1943) during World War II • First general elections (1936–37) – Congress majority • August Offer (1940) • Cripps Mission (1942) – rejected by Congress • Resignation of Congress ministries (1939) • Subhash Chandra Bose elected Congress President (1938); later formed Forward Bloc (1939) • Lahore Resolution (1940) – demand for separate Muslim state • Winston Churchill became PM of England (1940) • Bose's escape (1941) and formation of INA • Quit India Resolution (1942) → August Revolution (1942) • 'Divide and Quit' (1944) by Muslim League

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Lord Wavell	1944–1947	• Elections to Constituent Assembly (1946); formation of Interim Government (Sept 1946) • Announcement of end of British rule by Clement Attlee (Feb 20, 1947) • CR Formula (1944) and failure of Gandhi–Jinnah talks • End of Second World War (1945) • Direct Action Day (Aug 16) by Muslim League • Wavell Plan and Shimla Conference • Cabinet Mission (1946) proposals accepted by Congress • INA trials and suppression of Royal Indian Navy Mutiny
Lord Mountbatten	1947–1948	• June 3 Plan (1947) or Mountbatten Plan (1947) announced • Indian Independence Bill (1947) passed • Appointment of Boundary Commissions under Sir Cyril Radcliffe (Bengal & Punjab) • Became 1st Governor-General of Dominion of India (1947–50)

Important Indian National Congress Sessions

Year	Place	President	Significance / Major Events
1885	Bombay	Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee	- First session held at Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College with 72 delegates (reformers, journalists, lawyers). - Initially named 'Indian National Union', changed to 'Indian National Congress' on Dadabhai Naoroji's suggestion.
1886	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	- Merger of INC and the National Conference. - Decided to set up Provincial Congress Committees. - Viceroy Lord Dufferin invited members to a 'Garden Party'.
1887	Madras	Badruddin Tyabji	- First Muslim President of the INC. - Appeal made to Muslims to join the INC to promote unity. - Session operations handed over to a committee of delegates.
1888	Allahabad	George Yule	- First English/European President. - Session took place despite opposition from the Governor of Allahabad, Auckland Colvin. - Lala Lajpat Rai gave a speech in Hindi for the first time.
1889	Bombay	Sir William Wedderburn	- INC's British Committee was founded in Britain. - Decision made to send a delegation to England.
1890	Calcutta	Pheroza Shah Mehta	Kadambini Ganguly, the first female graduate of Calcutta University, addressed the Congress.
1891	Nagpur	P. Ananda Charlu	-
1892	Allahabad	Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee	Congress strongly criticized the Indian Councils Act of 1892.
1893	Lahore	Dadabhai Naoroji	-
1894	Madras	Alfred Webb	-

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Year	Place	President	Significance / Major Events
1895	Pune	Surendranath Banerjee	Significant increase in the number of attendees.
1896	Calcutta	Rahimatullah M. Sayani	'Vande Mataram' was sung for the first time (by Rabindranath Tagore). - Passed a resolution blaming the British for the devastating famine in India.
1897	Amraoti	C. Sankaran Nair	Congress slammed the British for the arrest of Bal Gangadhar Tilak.
1898	Madras	Ananda Mohan Bose	-
1899	Lucknow	Romesh Chunder Dutt	Demanded the British government stop the 'drain of wealth' from India to England.
1900	Lahore	N.G. Chandavarkar	-
1901	Calcutta	Dinshaw Eduljee Wacha	Mahatma Gandhi's first appearance on an INC platform; pleaded for backing against racial exploitation in South Africa.
1902	Ahmedabad	Surendranath Banerjee	-
1903	Madras	Lal Mohan Ghosh	-
1904	Bombay	Sir Henry Cotton	Protested Lord Curzon's misuse of Indian revenues in Tibet and his plan to partition Bengal.
1905	Banaras	Gopal Krishna Gokhale	- Adopted the Swadeshi resolution and supported the boycott of foreign goods. - Strong criticism of the Partition of Bengal.
1906	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	Declared 'Swaraj' (Self-rule) as the aim of the Congress for the first time from the platform.

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Year	Place	President	Significance / Major Events
1907	Surat	Rash Behari Ghosh	First major split in the Congress (between Moderates and Extremists); session was suspended.
1908	Madras	Rash Behari Ghosh	-
1909	Lahore	Madan Mohan Malaviya	Opposed the Indian Councils Act of 1909's proposal for separate electorates based on religion.
1910	Allahabad	Sir William Wedderburn	-
1911	Calcutta	Bishan Narayan Dar	'Jana Gana Mana' was sung for the first time.
1912	Bankipore	Raghunath Mudholkar	-
1913	Karachi	Nawab Syed Mohammed Bahadur	-
1914	Madras	Bhupendra Nath Bose	Demanded that Indians be allowed higher positions in the army.
1915	Bombay	Satyendra Prasanna Sinha	- Congress constitution was changed to readmit Extremists. - Lord Willingdon (Governor of Bombay) participated.
1916	Lucknow	Ambica Charan Mazumdar	- Unification of the Moderates and Extremists. - Lucknow Pact between Congress and Muslim League (communal electoral system accepted). - Tilak gave the slogan: "<i>Swaraj is my birthright, and I shall have it.</i>"
1917	Calcutta	Annie Besant	First Woman President of the INC.
1918	Delhi	Madan Mohan Malaviya	-

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Year	Place	President	Significance / Major Events
1918 (Special)	Bombay	Syed Hasan Imam	Expressed disappointment with the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms; called for a Declaration of Rights.
1919	Amritsar	Motilal Nehru	- Strong condemnation of and sympathy for victims of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre. - Bal Gangadhar Tilak's last Congress session.
1920 (Special)	Calcutta	Lala Lajpat Rai	INC approved the Non-Cooperation Movement (NCM).
1920	Nagpur	C. Vijayaraghavachariar	- Intensified the NCM and emphasized non-violent means. - Congress declared its policy towards princely states for the first time.
1921	Ahmedabad	Hakim Ajmal Khan (<i>Acting for C.R. Das</i>)	Gandhiji was declared the sole executive authority of the Congress.
1922	Gaya	C.R. Das	Intense debate on council entry led to C.R. Das and others breaking away to form the Swaraj Party.
1923 (Special)	Delhi	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	Decided to permit members to run for office in the upcoming elections.
1924	Belgaum	Mahatma Gandhi	The <i>only</i> INC session presided over by Mahatma Gandhi.
1925	Kanpur	Sarojini Naidu	First Indian Woman President.
1926	Guwahati	S. Srinivasa Iyengar	-
1927	Madras	M.A. Ansari	- Demand for complete independence made. - Resolved to boycott the Simon Commission.
1928	Calcutta	Motilal Nehru	First All India Youth Congress formed.

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Year	Place	President	Significance / Major Events
			Adopted the Nehru Report's suggestion to demand Dominion Status within two years.
1929	Lahore	Jawaharlal Nehru	Declared <i>Purna Swaraj</i> (Complete Independence) as its ultimate goal.
1931	Karachi	Vallabhbhai Patel	- Passed resolutions on Fundamental Rights and the National Economic Program. - Endorsed the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.
1933	Calcutta	Nellie Sengupta	third female president of the Indian National Congress
1934	Bombay	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Wearing Khadi was established as a mandatory rule for elected members.
1936	Lucknow	Jawaharlal Nehru	Nehru urged Congressmen to adopt Socialism, describing it as the key to solving India's problems.
1937	Faizpur	Jawaharlal Nehru	First Congress Session held in a rural area/village.
1938	Haripura	Subhas Chandra Bose	- Rejected the federal structure of the GoI Act 1935. - National Planning Committee formed under Nehru's chairmanship. - Bose advocated for introducing the Roman script for Hindi.
1939	Tripuri	Subhas Chandra Bose	Due to a dispute with Gandhiji over the working committee formation, Bose resigned. Dr. Rajendra Prasad assumed the presidency.
1940	Ramgarh	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	- Objected to India being labeled a belligerent nation in WWII. (Note: Azad remained President for 6 consecutive years due to the war).

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Year	Place	President	Significance / Major Events
1946	Meerut	Acharya J.B. Kripalani	Last INC session before Independence (He was the President at the time of Independence).
1948	Jaipur	Pattabhi Sitaramayya	First session of the Congress after independence.
1950	Nasik	Purushottam Das Tandon	Second session of the Congress after independence.